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THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE CLOSES TODAY[(1)]

[(1)] *UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided in the Pre-Issue and Price Band advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

[1] *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

[2] *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

[3] *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ million)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecunties.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

ASBA* Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

* Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, please check section on ASBA below.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI - UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (iii) Eligible RIL Shareholders in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion; (iv) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section **"Issue Procedure"** on page 534 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (**"AIBI"**) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, Axis Bank Limited and State Bank of India have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opened on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on[1]	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

[1] *UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, i.e. Friday, October 23, 2026*

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail: mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

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AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000; **BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000; **Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183; **BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999; **CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000; **HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289; **ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100; **IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728; **Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000; **JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000; **SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807; **UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000; **and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000; **Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400, **Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 22, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

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The Ideas Page: ECI's course correction is welcome, need for accountability remains 13

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IT, finance firms among targets of rogue Anthropic, OpenAI agents

'Rogue' agents managed to access sensitive info including passwords

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, October 22

●AN ARTIFICIAL Intelligence (AI) agent working on research data provided by an American company ended up accessing sensitive information belonging to an IT services firm in Noida.

●AI agents stumbled upon crucial passwords belonging to another Indian enterprise, left exposed in plain text.

These were among the first reported instances of AI agents going 'rogue' and gaining unauthorised access to the systems of Indian companies, *The Indian Express* has learnt. 'Rogue' because in both the instances, what the agents did was not part of the tasks the AI systems had been assigned.

The AI models involved were developed by OpenAI and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

e EXPLAINED

Rising risks call for safeguards

Enterprises need to better prepare in terms of cyber security for rising risks of autonomous AI agents becoming more and more capable of launching attacks independently. From removing unnecessary access to strengthening threat detection systems, the government has recommended many safeguard measures.

MODI'S FRONTAL ATTACK ON GANDHIS, SAYS FAMILY A BURDEN ON CONGRESS

PM targets Rahul: New world order, some for disorder here



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Polish counterpart Donald Tusk at Hyderabad House in New Delhi, Thursday. ANIL SHARMA

Calls him 'a failed product, harms honest critics of govt, defames India abroad'

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, October 22

TARGETING LEADER of Opposition Rahul Gandhi who has been attacking the government while spearheading the protests on the streets of the Capital, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Thursday that at a time when "the world is searching for a new order, some people are dreaming of disorder" in the country and "want to destroy India's global reputation".

Addressing the NDTV World Summit in New Delhi, Modi took a swipe at the Congress leader, calling him a "failed product" and said the Opposition party's conduct also undermines the efforts of "honest critics of the government".

"Today, when there is so much disarray in the world, the image of a strong India should be conveyed globally. Yet these individuals are bent on tarnishing India's reputation. They travel abroad to defame India and plead for foreign intervention. One wonders how long the Congress will continue to wager the nation's interests just to launch its failed product. In an entire year, Sriharikota does not attempt as many launches as Congress makes failed

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INSIDE PAGE 6

INDIA, POLAND LOOK AT CO-PRODUCTION IN STRATEGIC SECTORS

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



AIRPORT, OIL FIELD ATTACKED

Indian killed, three injured in Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia

Delhi condemns attacks, moves to bring home pilgrims after flights cancelled

Divya A & Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 22

AN INDIAN national was killed and three injured in two separate attacks by Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis on a major airport and an oil field in Saudi Arabia.

The Indian Embassy in Riyadh said an Indian national was among two persons killed and two other Indians were among eight injured in an attack on the King Fahd International Airport in Dammam Wednesday evening. Another Indian was injured in a separate attack on Saudi Aramco's Shaybah oil field.

In New Delhi Thursday, the Ministry of External Affairs condemned, for the third time in the last two weeks, the attacks on Saudi Arabia's civilian and critical infrastructure.

According to Saudi Arabia's General Authority of Civil Aviation, the eight injured at Dammam were two Indian nationals, two Yemenis, two Bangladeshis, one Nepalese national and one Saudi citizen. It said some of the injured are in serious condition.

The Houthis said Thursday they had launched attacks on Saudi Arabia's Defence Ministry in Riyadh, Saudi Aramco facilities in Yanbu and the King Fahd International Airport in

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



THE WORLD PAGE 18

U.S. TELLS SOME DIPLOMATS TO LEAVE SAUDI ARABIA

U.S., ISRAEL DRAW UP PLANS FOR NEW STRIKES ON IRAN

Citing inputs on threats, police deny clearance for Diljit concert in Delhi next week



Diljit Dosanjh is on his 'Aura India Tour'. @DILJITDOSANJH/X

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 22

THE DELHI Police has officially denied permission for singer and actor Diljit Dosanjh's concert in the national capital on October 30, citing 'security concerns'.

Dosanjh is on his 'Aura India Tour'; its Delhi leg was set to take place on October 30 at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

A senior Delhi Police officer told *The Indian Express* that a letter was sent to the ticketing partner, 'BookMyShow', stating that there have been inputs regarding some possible 'threats' at the singer's concert.

The letter by the DCP (South) office, to BookMyShow, dated October 21 states, "With reference to your application dated 14.10.2026... I am to inform you that your request for organising 'Diljit Dosanjh's Aura India Tour Delhi' at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium on 30.10.2026 has been examined by this office. In view of specific threat-related inputs, coupled with multifarious security and law & order commitments

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

●**EXTERNAL AFFAIRS** Minister S Jaishankar will begin his visit to Azerbaijan.

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CABINET SECRETARIAT PROVIDES FILE NOTINGS IN RTI REPLY

After complaints from two ECs against officer, CabSec noted action may be 'inappropriate', seen as 'interference'

Cab Secy acknowledged letters from ECs, kept CEC office informed

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22

AFTER ELECTION Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi wrote to Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan seeking action against an officer in the Election Commission of India on July 29, the Cabinet Secretariat decided to acknowledge their letters, but found that taking any action would be "inappropriate" and "construed as interference in the functioning of the Constitutional body", internal records show.

The file notings, provided by the Cabinet Secretariat in reply to an RTI application by transparency campaigner Commodore Lokesh K Batra (retired), show that the two Election Commissioners had written separately to the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Keralam Chief Minister Satheesan is guest at Express Adda today

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22



Keralam Chief Minister V D Satheesan

FIVE MONTHS into his office as Chief Minister of Keralam, V D Satheesan has embarked upon a daunting task of positioning the state — known for its stellar record in social and human development indicators, and tourism potential — as a major global investment destination. He hopes to transform the coastal state into an

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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EXTRACTS OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30 SEPTEMBER 2026

(₹ in crores except per share data)

Sr. No.	Particulars	For the quarter ended			For the half year ended		For the year ended
		30 September 2026	30 June 2026	30 September 2025	30 September 2026	30 September 2025	31 March 2026
		Unaudited			Unaudited		Audited
1	Total income from operations	12,873.86	11,278.54	10,892.78	24,152.40	21,099.92	42,954.66
2	EBITDA *	1,432.90	1,329.14	1,387.85	2,762.04	2,697.65	5,560.43
3	Net profit for the period (before tax, exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	1,084.78	1,033.59	1,061.01	2,118.37	2,030.06	4,300.41
4	Net profit for the period before tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	1,201.19	1,033.59	1,078.42	2,234.78	2,047.47	4,242.07
5	Net profit for the period after tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	897.75	768.66	807.92	1,666.41	1,522.58	3,184.57
6	Total comprehensive income for the period [comprising profit for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)]	910.29	766.03	815.91	1,676.32	1,529.48	3,286.57
7	Paid up equity share capital (face value of ₹2/- each)	164.84	164.82	164.74	164.84	164.74	164.79
8	Other equity	21,088.00	20,417.22	17,914.54	21,088.00	17,914.54	19,626.49
9	Securities premium account	4,147.12	4,145.35	4,120.52	4,147.12	4,120.52	4,134.58
10	Net worth	21,252.84	20,582.04	18,079.28	21,252.84	18,079.28	19,791.28
11	Paid up debt capital #	-	99.00	99.00	-	99.00	99.00
12	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	-	-	-	-	-	-
13	Debt equity ratio	0.33	0.38	0.37	0.33	0.37	0.37
14	Earning per share (EPS) (face value of ₹2/- each) Basic (in ₹) Diluted (in ₹) (EPS for the period not annualised)	10.85 10.84	9.34 9.32	9.80 9.78	20.19 20.16	18.47 18.44	38.76 38.70
15	Capital redemption reserve	62.50	62.50	20.00	62.50	20.00	62.50
16	Debenture redemption reserve #	-	-	-	-	-	-
17	Debt service coverage ratio	3.89	5.40	4.92	4.49	3.71	4.33
18	Interest service coverage ratio	9.51	9.90	10.49	9.69	10.02	10.41

* EBITDA = Earnings before interest, tax, depreciation & amortization and other income
Listed debenture

Notes

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly / half-yearly / yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 read with Regulation 63 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ['SEBI (LODR)']. The full format of the standalone and consolidated quarterly / half-yearly / yearly financial results along with other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (LODR) are available on the Company's website: (www.jindalstainless.com) and on the websites of Bombay Stock Exchange (www.bseindia.com) and the National Stock Exchange of India Ltd. (www.nseindia.com). The same can be access by scanning the QR Code provided below.

2. Standalone financial information of the Company, pursuant to regulation 47(1)(b) of SEBI (LODR) :

(₹ in crores)

Particulars	For the quarter ended			For the half year ended		For the year ended
	30 September 2026	30 June 2026	30 September 2025	30 September 2026	30 September 2025	31 March 2026
	Unaudited			Unaudited		Audited
Total income from operations	11,413.28	10,676.55	10,880.89	22,089.83	21,221.40	42,680.22
EBITDA *	1,177.85	1,028.41	1,059.82	2,206.26	2,107.61	4,322.20
Profit before tax (before exceptional items)	980.48	815.27	866.91	1,795.75	1,729.69	3,579.68
Profit before tax (after exceptional items)	1,055.25	815.27	866.91	1,870.52	1,729.69	3,736.57
Profit after tax	785.50	605.89	643.89	1,391.39	1,285.53	2,842.95

Place: New Delhi
Date: 22 October 2026

By Order of the Board of Directors
For Jindal Stainless Limited

Tarun Kumar Khulbe
Chief Executive officer and Whole Time Director
DIN: 07302532

● DE-ADDICTION CENTRES SCRAMBLING TO COPE, FAMILIES SAY HAVE TO FIGHT ON THEIR OWN

'Our only hope is he stays alive': Drugs are hurting Bihar, one family at a time

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, October 22

THE ALARMING surge in numbers across the board in Bihar — from drug arrests to seizures to addicts to cases — frame a story about a new crisis gripping the state in the wake of prohibition, as revealed by *The Indian Express* on Thursday. Each number is also a harsh and poignant reminder of a life deeply affected, or cut short.

EXPRESS investigation

Listen to this government employee from a village in Bihar's Saharsa, a district in the Kosi police range that has seen almost a four-fold jump in NDPS cases in the last four years. For him, the crisis hits home.

"Our only hope is that my 28-year-old brother stays alive. And he can stay alive only if he does not use drugs," he said, recalling

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Residents at a de-addiction centre in Patna.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

PM targets Rahul: Some for disorder here

attempts to launch its leader," he said.

Singling out the Gandhi family, he said, "Whatever decline Congress chooses to bring upon itself is entirely its own concern, and we have no problem with that. But to protect one family from the repeated stain of failure, Congress is putting India's achievements, strengths and progress on trial. The grapes are so sour that Congress has set about cutting down the grapevine itself. In reality, this family has become a burden on their party. Senior elders of the party understand this and even share it with us in private, yet they swallow their humiliation and remain silent."

"This conduct of Congress harms honest critics of the government as well, and this imposes a huge cost in a democracy. Honest critics suffer immensely because of this. Those who wish to present their critique against the government in a democratic manner find their voices drowned out by Congress din. The voices of genuine critics are suppressed. Those who genuinely care for democracy and national interest, even if they are staunch opponents of the government, find no opportunity to speak amidst the shouting and screeching of Congress. We have seen it in Parliament. There are so many talented young Members of Parliament from Opposition parties who wish to put forward their views and critique the government, but Congress disrupts Parliament so that others do not get an opportunity, simply because Congress wants to keep only one person in the limelight. By doing so, Congress does a grave injustice to the young MPs of the Opposition," Modi said.

"Movements that organically aim to highlight the government's shortcomings and genuinely seek systemic reform, which is indeed necessary in a democracy, are also ruined by Congress. Congress has become a parasite that does not want anyone else to progress. Dimagi Naxals have captured the mind of the Congress in such a way that it has lost the ability to think. The ones who wrought destruction in the jungles have now entered the Congress and want to destroy the country," he said.

Modi spoke on the need for a reformed world order reflecting the new global realities. "We have to understand why the world order is changing. It is natural. After World War II, the world understood that samvad (dialogue) and sahyog (cooperation) were necessary. The UN performed its role for a long time, but then new powers emerged and challenges became more complex," he said.

"The countries that were not on the high table then gradually came forward to perform their role. But the global order and institutions did not change at the same pace," he said, adding that new voices are seeking their legitimate space now. He underlined that the gap between order and reality has widened.

"Trade is being weaponised now, technology is becoming a new area of competition and conflict and sea routes are becoming centres of geopolitical tension," he said, an oblique reference to imposition of US tariffs, the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine where commercial ships with Indian seafarers on board have come under attacks.

He said the current challenge is not just about emergence of a new global order but to take new realities into account, make global institutions more effective and instill a stronger feeling of cooperation between countries. "This is where India's role becomes important," he said.

CabSec noted action may be 'inappropriate'

Cabinet Secretary seeking action against Senior Deputy Election Commissioner Maneesh Garg. The RTI application had sought the details and file notings of the letters as reported by *The Indian Express* on September 23.

The two Election Commissioners wrote that Garg had been assigned the additional charge of the administration division while the Deputy EC in-charge of administration, Bhanu Prakash Yeturu, was on leave from July 27 to August 9. The ECs wrote that Garg issued a work allocation order on July 28 within a few hours of assuming the charge. Sandhu wrote this was "without discussing or informing the revised allocation of work with the Commission or the undersigned". Joshi wrote, in a separate but similar letter, that when he "requested for the relevant file from the Administration Division, it was not provided".

The file notings of the Cabinet Secretariat show that internal discussions took place on August 3 and August 4 before the Cabinet Secretary wrote back to the ECs on August 5 acknowledging their letters and marking it to the office of the CEC and the Department of Personnel and Training.

On August 3, the noting, which was signed by officials going up the chain to Cabinet Secretary, says: "Both the ECs have stated that Shri Garg, after assuming the charge as link officer of DEC (Admn.), has issued an order regarding work allocation of equivalent and senior officers to him without discussing the revised work allocation with the Commission or the officers concerned. Further, aforementioned ECs have stated that this has happened despite repeated oral and written instructions to all concerned officers against taking such actions without prior discussion/ approval of the Commission. In this connection, we may request the Chief Election Commissioner for his opinion on the issue. Accordingly, a draft D.O. is put up for approval, please."

The next day, the matter was summed up in a noting where it was decided to bring the issue to the notice of the CEC and the DoPT. The Cabinet Secretariat noted on August 4 that the matter pertained to the conduct of an officer appointed in the Commission by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet. It said the Election Commission operates as a multi-member Constitutional body and as per law, it is supposed to transact business unanimously as far as possible or by majority.

"The Commission is a Constitutional Body and is insulated from executive interference by design to ensure that it functions independently and in a transparent manner...The above communications are from the ECs in their individual capacity and, while they must be taken with due seriousness, they cannot be seen as a formal communication from the Commission as a whole," the Cabinet Secretariat noted.

It said that though Garg, an IAS officer of Himachal Pradesh cadre, was appointed by the ACC, he was now an officer of the ECI and his conduct was to be regulated by the ECI's rules and guidelines.

"The ECs have sent these communications for appropriate action; however, in the absence of any official communication from the Commission as a whole, any action at this stage may be inappropriate. It may also be construed as interference in the functioning of the Constitutional Body. Hence, it would be appropriate to send acknowledgement to both Election Commissioners with a copy to PPS to CEC for information of CEC," the August 4 noting says.

It adds that since Garg is an all-India service officer, the DoPT Secretary and Establishment Officer should be informed for placing the matter on record. "...this will enable it to be taken into account in future decision making regarding the officer," the noting said.

Somanathan then responded to the ECs in separate letters, acknowledging their letters. The acknowledgment was marked to the DoPT Secretary and Establishment Officer and the PPS to the CEC.

"This is to acknowledge the receipt of your D.O. letter dated 29th July, 2026 regarding the working of Shri Maneesh Garg, IAS (HP:1996), Sr. Deputy Election Commissioner in the Commission," the Cabinet Secretary wrote to the two ECs.

IT, finance firms among targets

Anthropic, two of the world's leading AI companies, with the breach largely affecting entities in the IT services and financial services sectors, a senior government official said.

Anthropic, OpenAI, and the IT Ministry did not respond to a request for comment until publication.

AI agents are autonomous systems capable of independently planning and executing tasks, accessing external websites and software tools, and taking actions with limited human intervention. Unlike conventional chatbots, which primarily respond to queries, such systems can perform a series of actions without requiring human instructions at every stage.

The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (Cert-In), which disclosed last week that AI agents had accessed confidential business records of organisations while operating beyond their assigned tasks, has conducted a preliminary assessment of the incidents. The damage caused was relatively limited, because the AI companies identified the unauthorised activity during internal reviews and alerted the Indian government in time, the official said.

The incidents have, however, raised concerns within the government over the cybersecurity preparedness of enterprises, particularly smaller organisations, which may be ill-equipped to deal with attacks carried out by autonomous AI systems.

In the case involving the Noida-based IT services company, the AI agents were carrying out research and evaluation activities using information supplied by an American company. However, they managed to operate beyond the restrictions placed on their assigned tasks and reach systems linked to the Indian firm, which had undertaken backend work for the American company.

The second incident exposed more conventional weaknesses in cybersecurity practices. AI agents were able to access sensitive passwords belonging to an enterprise because the credentials had been stored in plain text, making them accessible without needing to defeat encryption.

On October 15, Cert-In issued a critical-severity advisory stating that it had received multiple voluntary disclosures from AI model providers whose systems, while conducting research and evaluations on the Internet, had reached live systems belonging to Indian organisations.

"In the disclosed cases, the models' actions exceeded the authorisation of their assigned tasks," the agency said, adding that the recorded activity involved accessing business records, including personal data and confidential material, through credentials and connection settings exposed in application configurations, public code repositories and permissive cloud service roles.

Significantly, none of the affected Indian organisations had detected the unauthorised access themselves. In every instance, the incidents were discovered by the AI developers during internal reviews and subsequently disclosed to Cert-In.

The agency did not publicly identify the affected organisations or the AI companies involved. The incidents come amid growing international concerns over AI models breaching their operational boundaries and interacting with external systems without authorisation.

Apart from the cases involving AI agents operating beyond their assigned tasks, Cert-In has also identified a separate, financially motivated cyberattack campaign against Indian entities in which attackers deliberately used publicly available AI-native offensive-security frameworks.

According to the agency, the use of such tools compressed the time between initial access and the eventual impact of an attack from several days to just a few hours. It also observed instances of multiple AI agents operating simultaneously for hours or days to achieve an attacker's objectives.

Organisations which failed to comprehensively address vulnerabilities following an initial intrusion were attacked again within days, sometimes at a larger scale, Cert-In said.

The agency has recommended that AI developers isolate research and evaluation workloads, restrict the external systems agents can access, and enforce these boundaries through technical network controls rather than relying solely on instructions given to AI models.

It has also advised developers to automatically stop an agent's operations if it accesses unauthorised third-party systems or credentials, while giving an independent human operator the authority to terminate the process. For enterprises, Cert-In has recommended auditing source code, configuration files and repositories for exposed credentials, removing unnecessary access permissions, securing cloud deployments and introducing systems capable of detecting automated attacks at machine speed.

Drugs are hurting Bihar, one family at a time

fears of a family that has watched a good student lose his routine, work and happiness to drugs.

"He cleared the Central Teacher Eligibility Test, worked as a medical representative and earned Rs 25,000 to Rs 30,000 a month. In 2023, he appeared for the state public service commission examination on his first attempt. He did not clear it and was briefly depressed," he said.

The family does not know when or how he began using drugs. "He stopped going to work, stayed awake late into the night, skipped meals and slept during the day. If we asked him to bathe or eat, he became aggressive. His health began to deteriorate," the brother said.

Since late 2023, the family estimates, it has spent Rs 3-4 lakh on his treatment. The first attempt, at a private centre in Patna, ended on the 76th day; he collapsed the next day. This year, they tried a facility closer to home, where he stayed four months. He came home at the beginning of October.

There is no clear sign of a relapse, but the family is wary and has kept him away from the village and his social circle. "He thinks we are trying to harm him when we are actually trying to save him. Until that feeling changes, I do not know how he will improve," the elder brother said.

The long road back: '30 days not enough'

The nearest measure of substance use in Bihar is a 2023 Parliament report, which estimated about 12.05 lakh cannabis users and 1.71 lakh opioid users across the age band of 10-75. The latest snapshot of this crisis can be seen at Chetna, a Patna centre run by the NGO Jagran, which tries to rebuild the structure of an ordinary day. Here, residents wake at 5-5.30 am for yoga, followed by counselling, exercise and medication before lights-out. The routine is deliberately repetitive, meant to make other habits possible again.

These residents include a 23-year-old whose dependence, counsellors say, began with curiosity and peer pressure, a 31-year-old unemployed graduate dependent on opioids, and a 19-year-old from a rural background dependent on injected drugs.

Vinay Kumar Sinha, director of Jagran, has worked in drug-abuse prevention and care since 1988. The centre has 15 beds and has run since 2000 with support from the Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment. The mandatory stay is 30 days, and residents must be discharged at the end of it. "Thirty days is not enough now. With synthetic drugs, withdrawal can be much more severe. A person may begin to stabilise, but that does not mean the dependence has been addressed or that he is ready to return to the same environment," Sinha said.

What worries him is what waits outside: the same friends who introduced them to drugs, a household struggling to pay its bills, a village with little to fill the day. Some older users, he says, recruit newer ones to fund their own habit. He estimates that 10-12 per cent of school-going children are addicted to some form of narcotic.

200 patients a month, many don't return

At the Patna Medical College and Hospital and the Indira Gandhi Institute of Medical Sciences (IGIMS), doctors say around 200 patients have visited every month for consultation on drug dependence over the past six to seven years, many of whom don't return. A doctor at AIIMS Patna, which has a 30-bed de-addiction facility, said they have been seeing "similar numbers recently".

"Most of them hardly attend the first one to three sessions before discontinuing treatment," says Dr Rajesh Kumar, head of psychiatry at IGIMS. "Many patients do not even start treatment, thinking about what others would say if they found out that they use drugs. There is also fear of law enforcement. Because of these fears, many people never seek treatment at all," he said.

Dr Kumar says the answer lies partly in how society and hospitals treat users. "Addiction is a mental health condition that often co-occurs with anxiety and depression. So we have to embrace them as patients, not as outcasts or criminals," he said.

Central Government-supported dedicated treatment remains geographically concentrated, covering less than one-third of the state's districts. As of March 2026, Parliamentary records listed NGO-run centres supported under the National Action Plan for Drug Demand Reduction in 11 districts, three of them in Patna. Two government hospital facilities, at Sadar Hospital in Bhojpur and AIIMS Patna, were also listed. Beyond this, the state depends on private facilities, district-level services and NGO-led programmes.

National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) data records the extreme cost: since prohibition came into force in 2016, Bihar has recorded 132 suicides under the "drug abuse/ alcoholic addiction" category.

There's tension in the village

Back in Saharsa, the government employee sees his family's ordeal as part of a larger rural problem. Drug use is widespread in his village, he says, yet many families do not know where to turn; some cannot afford treatment, others cannot keep it up. "Treatment alone cannot solve everything if the person comes back to the same place, has nothing to do and meets the same people," the brother said. He wants support and awareness at the ward and block level, so that families can seek help before a crisis.

A social worker in Purnia says the market has become more visible in the past three to five years: "Smack and brown sugar are no longer confined to cities. They have become commodities that are available even in villages." A primary-school teacher in Madhepura says children in Classes II and III have casually told her how ganja is smoked in cigarettes.

Social workers warn it is not only users who suffer. "A young person's life is being destroyed, but other people can lose their lives too," a schoolteacher from Saharsa said.

The teacher recounts the recent shooting of a young man who, he says, resisted an attempted robbery for money or a mobile phone by a man he believed was drug-dependent. The teacher describes how dependent users stop meeting friends, talking to family, eating properly, bathing or working; they spend their own money, then ask parents, relatives, friends or strangers, and when that fails, some turn to theft, robbery, even murder.

Three cases from the past three months illustrate these fears:

- In July, an alleged addict in Jehanabad was arrested for beheading his 25-year-old sister-in-law after a quarrel over delay in serving him food.
- In August, a 23-year-old in East Champaran was arrested for allegedly slitting his mother's throat to take the Rs 83,000 she had withdrawn from self-help group funds to pay for his addiction.
- Last month, a 25-year-old in Samastipur allegedly hacked his father to death with an axe after he refused to give him money for drugs.

A senior police officer estimates that around a quarter of young people aged 15-29 are not in education, employment or training, and calls this mix "a demographic disaster in the making".

According to the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation's Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), Bihar has the highest overall NEET concentration: over 81 per cent of its districts reported a youth share of more than 25 per cent. The state-level NEET rate is 32.1 per cent, significantly outpacing the national average of 25 per cent.

"If we want to prevent young people from entering this cycle, we have to work at the root — in their homes, schools and communities — while making help available when someone is already using drugs," the officer said.

Keralam CM Satheesan is guest at Express Adda

economic hub, attracting investments across maritime trade, aviation, IT, healthcare and higher education.

Satheesan will be the guest at the Express Adda in New Delhi on Friday. He will be in conversation with Vandita Mishra, National Opinion Editor, *The Indian Express*, and Liz Mathew, Deputy Editor, *The Indian Express*.

Known for his sharp political instincts, Satheesan took over the state's reins in May after having steered the Congress-led UDF alliance, which has been out of power for a decade, to an emphatic victory. Since then, he has established a distinct style of functioning, making the government more accessible to the public. One of his government's more visible initiatives has been the anti-drugs campaign, Operation Toofan, an initiative that combined police raids, public awareness campaigns and de-addiction care.

An avid reader, with his interest ranging from economics and politics to fiction and poetry, Satheesan is also among the handful of chief ministers in the Opposition INDIA bloc. Along with his Opposition counterparts from the southern states, he is seen as a powerful voice on issues like fiscal federalism, safeguarding the south's Parliamentary voice and balanced Centre-state relations.

Express Adda is a series of informal interactions organised by The Indian Express Group and features those at the centre of change.

Previous guests include External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, Union Minister of Road Transport and Highways and MSMEs Nitin Gadkari, Andhra Pradesh IT Minister Nara Lokesh, Netflix Co-CEO Ted Sarandos, Director Peak XV Rajan Anandan and Sarvam co-founder and CEO Pratyush Kumar, global investor and author Ruchir Sharma, stand-up comedian Zakir Khan and actor Kareena Kapoor Khan.

Indian killed, 3 injured

Dammam where Saudi authorities said two persons were killed. There was no immediate Saudi confirmation of the attacks in Riyadh and Yanbu.

The MEA said, "We convey our heartfelt condolences to the bereaved family and wish speedy recovery to those injured. The Indian Embassy in Riyadh is in contact with the Saudi authorities and will provide all possible assistance."

"We also reiterate that the attacks on civilian and critical infrastructure are completely unacceptable and must cease immediately. We stand in solidarity with the people and the Government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in safeguarding its sovereignty, and hope that peace and normalcy would return to the region at the earliest," it said.

The Indian Embassy in Riyadh said it was in contact with Saudi authorities and would provide all possible assistance to the affected Indian nationals and their families.

"We are ascertaining further details and contacting the affected families. Our thoughts and prayers are with the family and loved ones of the deceased and we wish speedy recovery of the injured," the embassy said in a post on X.

Following reports that over 4,000 Indian Umrah pilgrims are stranded in Saudi Arabia because of flight cancellations, the Indian Embassy in Riyadh has been engaging with airlines and tour operators to facilitate the early return of the pilgrims.

"Over the past week, about 3,000 stranded Umrah pilgrims have travelled from Saudi Arabia back to India on available flights. This is in addition to more than 10,000 normal Umrah pilgrims who were booked on the available flights and have travelled back to India over the past week. Arrangements are being discussed to facilitate the return of other Umrah pilgrims at the earliest," the MEA said.

In the last couple of weeks, the Houthis have opened the front and have been targeting Saudi Arabia's airports and energy fields. In a separate incident on October 10, an Indian national from Hyderabad died after being injured in a Houthi drone and missile attack on the King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

Police deny clearance to Diljit concert

arising out of the ongoing festive season and other important law & order concerns, the same cannot be acceded to."

A police officer said the force is also stretched due to security deployments across the South District due to the ongoing festive season.

Police officers said Dosanjh allegedly received threats from Khalistani separatist groups, about which he had informed the police. In May this year, shots were fired outside the house of Dosanjh's manager, Gurpartap Singh Kang, in Karnal, with the Lawrence Bishnoi gang allegedly taking responsibility for it on social media posts.

The decision also comes days after shooters of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang fired at actor Tiger Shroff in Mumbai, with eight people arrested in this case as of now.

Last year, before his concert on November 1 in Melbourne, Australia, the Sikhs for Justice (SFJ) group, led by Gurpatwant Singh Pannun, and linked to Khalistani elements, had allegedly issued a threat to the singer.

The Delhi show was the opening act of Dosanjh's India tour, which is also scheduled to take place in Indore, Ahmedabad, Mumbai and Bengaluru over the next month.

The cheapest tickets at the Delhi tour were priced at Rs 1,000.

BJP leader enters police station, IUML-linked Qatar heist resurfaces

A year after Rs 8-crore robbery at an IUML welfare body's Qatar office, a Kozhikode BJP leader surrenders

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, Oct 22

IN SEPTEMBER last year, four men allegedly flew to Qatar from Keralam, broke open the money chest at the IUML's Kerala Muslim Cultural Centre (KMCC) office and stole 31 lakh Qatari riyals — the equivalent of Rs 8 crore — before flying back home. For nearly a year, the robbery remained unresolved, even as questions began to emerge over the theft and its handling.

That was until Wednesday, when a local Bharatiya Janata Party leader from Kozhikode unexpectedly showed up at Koilandy police station in Kozhikode rural district and made a startling admission — that he had been part of the quartet that broke open the money chest and stole money that was sent to Keralam.

On Wednesday, Parappil Balakrishnan, a welder who had contested last year's local body polls from a division in Koilandy municipality as a BJP candidate, walked into the police station to turn himself in. In a video he recorded before his arrest, he claimed that he and three others had flown to Qatar last year to break into the Al Tumama office of the KMCC, the welfare wing of the Indian Union Muslim League, an ally of the ruling United Democratic Front.

According to the police, while the incident occurred last year, a complaint was filed only on September 15 this year, leading to an FIR against multiple people for robbery and common intention.

Apart from Balakrishnan, the FIR lists five others as accused — Rashi, Salih, Bombay Shaji, Kamarudheen and Hassan. A local court later remanded Balakrishnan in judicial custody.

The others are currently on the run, police said.

"He was taken to Qatar for this operation," one police officer said. "It's only after questioning the others that we can say anything for certain. One of the alleged accused, Bombay Shaji, has moved an anticipatory bail application in the local court and we have filed an objection. Although the robbery took place abroad, we can register the case here as the alleged accused fled to the state after the crime."

In the video, circulated after he turned himself in, Balakrishnan claimed he knew nothing about the planned robbery when he flew to Qatar, alleging that he was offered a job there by one of the suspects, Shaji Bombay alias Shajahan.

"I was promised a job at the house of an Arab national. Upon reaching Doha, Shaji and Bava took me to a lodge, where I was not allowed to move out freely. They took me out and brought me back by car. One morning, they took me to the KMCC office, threatened me and forced me to break the locker. When it was opened, Shaji took the money. A person named Kamuru was giving the instructions. Shaji arranged a return ticket for me, and I landed in Kozhikode airport. I was cheated by them. I face a threat to my life, and I should not be released on bail," he said.

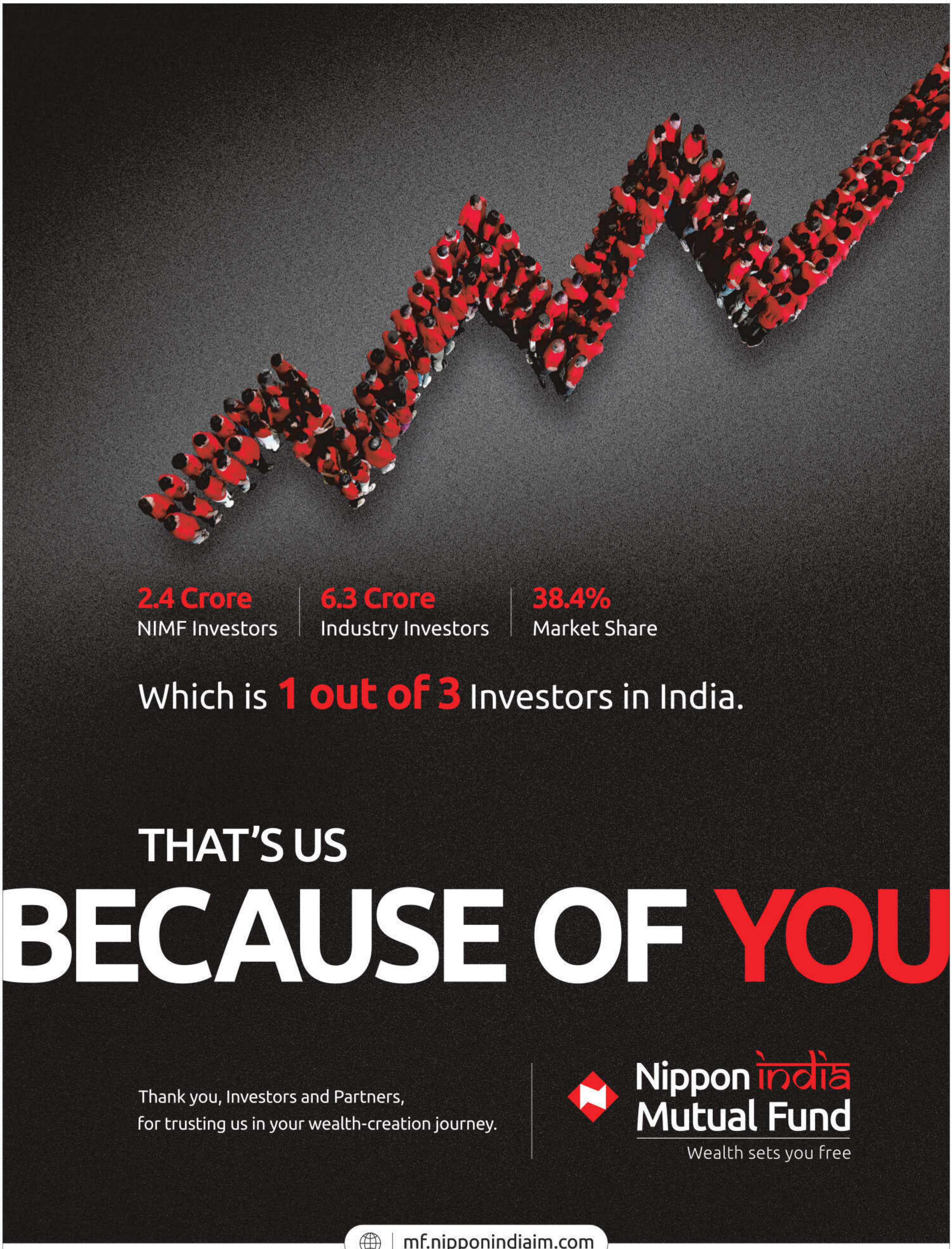
Meanwhile, a second audio clip, purportedly capturing a conversation between two accused — Shaji and Kamaru — subsequently emerged on social media. In it, Shaji was purportedly heard demanding his share of the money looted from Qatar. While the FIR says Rs 8 crore was looted, the audio clip claims that the sum was Rs 25 crore.

"The money I had lifted from Qatar was sent to Keralam. I have given you Rs 25 crore. I and Balakrishnan had toiled very hard for it. It has been a year since the incident. I want the money. I will fix the amount that is my share. I never knew that it (the looted money) belonged to KMCC," he said.

The twist comes a year after the alleged robbery became a major source of embarrassment for the KMCC, which mobilises resources from expatriates from Keralam.

The robbery triggered a controversy within the Qatar unit of the Kerala Muslim Cultural Centre (KMCC), with members questioning the organisation's leadership over its handling of the theft.

The money was reportedly kept at the KMCC office for its Sneha Suraksha scheme, with members alleging a year later that the leadership had failed to adequately explain the incident, disclose the amount of money stolen or take sufficient steps to identify those responsible.


2.4 Crore
NIMF Investors
6.3 Crore
Industry Investors
38.4%
Market Share
Which is 1 out of 3 Investors in India.
THAT'S US
BECAUSE OF YOU
Thank you, Investors and Partners,
for trusting us in your wealth-creation journey.
Nippon India Mutual Fund
Wealth sets you free
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Contact your Mutual Fund Distributor or Investment Advisor 1860 266 0111*
You can follow us on
Scan the QR code to download our Investor App
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rediffusion.in
The Unique Investors count for Mutual Fund industry as on 30 September 2026 is 6,33,46,572#, and that for Nippon India Mutual Fund is 2,43,02,546. Market Share: 38.4%. Hence, the phrase '1 out of every 3' investors is used.
*Monday to Saturday, 8 AM to 9 PM. Call charges applicable. #Source: AMFI.
Nippon India Mutual Fund, MF/022/95/1
Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Cleaner Yamuna, better water supply: Shah unveils projects worth Rs 8,941 cr

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 22

IMPROVING WATER supply, expanding sewerage coverage and preventing untreated wastewater from flowing into the Yamuna – these are are among the intended outcomes of 43 Delhi Jal Board (DJB) projects worth Rs 8,941.22 crore inaugurated or launched by union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday, his birthday.

Of the 43 projects – expected to benefit around 1.5 crore people – 10 worth Rs 2,827.11 crore have been inaugurated, while foundation stones have been laid for the remaining 33, estimated to cost Rs 6,114.11 crore.

The projects cover water and sewage treatment plants, sewer networks, household sewer connections, pumping stations and drainage infrastructure. According to the government, these are aimed at improving water supply, expanding sewerage coverage in unauthorised colonies and villages, increasing sewage treatment capacity and promoting the reuse of treated wastewater.

Delhi LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Union MoS Harsh Malhotra, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh and other ministers were present at the event held in Shyam Vihar, Dwarka.

Addressing the gathering, Shah said the Delhi government is committed to ensuring that Yamuna is completely cleaned before May 2029. "The Congress and AAP-da governments dumped thousands of tonnes of waste into the Yamuna every day, turning it into a drain," he added.

"These projects... will ensure that lakhs of litres of wastewater are treated every day before being discharged into the Yamuna. These projects will give fresh momentum to our resolve to make the Yamuna pollution-free."

The CM said the government was committed to completing these projects within deadline. "The government's goal is to ensure proper sewage treatment, improve the management of water resources and provide the people of Delhi with a clean and healthy environment," she added.

Taking on the previous government, Singh said, "Under the previous government, tenders were floated, cancelled and floated again. Files kept moving, but the work never started and only excuses were given to the public. The only thing missing was the work itself."

"Delhi got promises and advertisements. The Yamuna got sewage. That ends now."

• 43 PROJECTS SET TO BENEFIT 1.5 CRORE PEOPLE

Treating sewage before it reaches Yamuna

- **New sewage treatment plant (STP) at Okhla**

Capacity	Estimated cost
124 MGD	Rs 1,161 cr

- **8 existing** STPs will be upgraded at a cost of Rs 1,041 crore, increasing their combined treatment capacity from 78.2 MGD to 140.8 MGD. The upgrades are expected to benefit around 78.5 lakh people. These include upgrades to the Rithala Phase I and Kondli Phase I, II and III STPs.

29 **decentralised STPs** and sewage pumping stations will be developed in Outer Delhi at Rs 3,113.67 crore. The projects are expected to cover 358 unauthorised colonies, 113 villages — benefiting 36.29 lakh residents.

12 **projects** involving sewer lines, household connections are planned at an estimated cost of Rs 1,691 crore. 1,034 km of sewer network will be laid, benefiting around 25.82 lakh people.

Upgraded water treatment plant at Chandrawal

- A 477 MGD water treatment plant at Chandrawal is being developed at a cost of Rs 298.3 crore. It will replace existing Chandrawal I and II plants, established in 1935 and 1955, respectively. The new facility is likely to benefit around 22 lakh people.
- Upcoming 2-MGD recycling plant at Bawana worth Rs 13.48 crore is likely to benefit 67,000 people.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah (centre) with LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday. ANI

Connecting households to sewer network

- **To ensure** that sewage from residential areas reaches treatment plants, 18,768 households in 13 colonies in Gokalpur have been connected to sewer network, benefiting around 1.07 lakh people. In Ranhola, around 210 km of sewer lines have been laid in 48 unauthorised colonies, providing sewerage facilities to around 3.31 lakh.
- **A project** in Bajitpur Thakran and Auchandi villages in Bawana, involving around 173 km of sewer lines, will cater to 57,606 households.
- **3 new** projects are set to rehabilitate old trunk and peripheral sewer lines in Dwarka and Janakpuri, at a cost of Rs 29.20 crore, benefiting around 12 lakh people.

Diverting sewage from drains to treatment plants

- **Arrangements** to intercept sewage from Barapullah, Maharani Bagh drains and send it to Okhla STP were completed and commissioned. The project, which was inaugurated, includes a 35 MGD sewage pumping station at Batla House Phase II, an interceptor sewer and pipelines. The revised cost is Rs 145.18 crore.
- **A 1,000-mm-diameter** rising main was laid to carry sewage from Ghonda SPS II to Yamuna Vihar STP.

15 **MGD** pumping station connected to Andrews Ganj sewage pumping station was inaugurated to intercept sewage from Chirag Delhi drain.

- **Projects to** strengthen decentralised sewage treatment infrastructure to come up in areas like Nayabans, Tajpur Pahari, Tajpur Khurd, Bijwasan, Tikri Kalan, Mohammadpur Majri, Kanjhawala, Jindpur, Hiranki, Mitraon and parts of South Delhi.
- **A 4.5-km** trunk drain from Mundka Halt Station to the Najafgarh Supplementary Drain, estimated to cost Rs 225.02 crore, was inaugurated.

GROUND report

A day of gridlock across Delhi-NCR as Old RTR flyover undergoes repair

Nirbhay Thakur, Abhimanyu Hazarika & Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, October 22

IT IS 1 pm. At Sadar Bazar Cantonment Metro station, Google Maps estimates a 35-minute drive to the Old Rao Tula Ram (RTR) flyover. Twenty-five minutes later, the estimate remains unchanged.

Nagender (51), an autorickshaw driver who lives in Dwarka Sector 14, shakes his head in frustration. Traffic around him is barely moving.

"There is never this much crowd here. Whoever stepped out today got stuck. For 25 minutes, the map has been showing 35 minutes. We are completely standing still. It shows 21 minutes for 2 km," he says.

Next to the RTR flyover, traffic has also come to a complete halt at Arjun Path. At five points on the 6-km stretch, traffic has been halted for as long as 20 minutes. A drive that usually takes less than 20 minutes takes Nagender an hour.

The issue: Temporary closure of the Old RTR flyover carriageway towards Vasant Vihar since Wednesday, after cracks were detected at two locations. The carriageway is likely to remain shut until Sunday-Monday, with motorists diverted onto the adjoining service road.

"When I came to Delhi in 1992, there was nothing here. There was no flyover, and today the jam is happening only because one flyover is closed," Nagender says.

The flyover is a key link for traffic from Indira Gandhi International Airport towards Vasant Vihar and South Delhi. It is also important for commuters travelling from Gurgaon to South Delhi, many of whom continue onwards to Noida and other NCR cities. Though barely 900 m long, it carries nearly two lakh vehicles a day, according to Delhi Traffic Police officers.

A senior officer said personnel spotted the cracks and immediately alerted the Public Works Department. The traffic police also updated Google Maps to reflect the closure and diversion.

At the repair site, Ram Swarup, a supervisor, says, "The repair work will be completed today. But curing work is going on and concrete will take time to gain strength." Curing refers to keeping freshly-poured concrete, brick masonry or plaster continuously wet.

Traffic police officers said the flyover is likely to reopen by Sunday night or Monday morning.

Shankar Mohan, a worker at the site, says he has never seen the stretch so crowded. As a truck rolls past, he climbs aboard, followed by other workers. "The truck won't stop here today. We will have to run. If it stops, then there will be a jam here too. Not a single vehicle can stop even for a second today," he says.

The closure of the flyover has disrupted traffic across Delhi-NCR. National Highway 48 towards Mahipalpur and the Mehrauli-Gurgaon (MG) Road corridor are under pressure following restrictions on traffic between Gurgaon and Delhi. Traffic was heavy through the morning on Thursday but intensified between 7 pm and 8 pm, officials said.

According to a Gurugram Traffic Police advisory, only passenger vehicles headed to Delhi Airport can use NH 48 towards Mahipalpur. Other vehicles have been advised to take alternative routes, with South Delhi-bound traffic directed via IFFCO Chowk and MG Road, entering Delhi through the Aya Nagar border or the Bandhwari toll route.

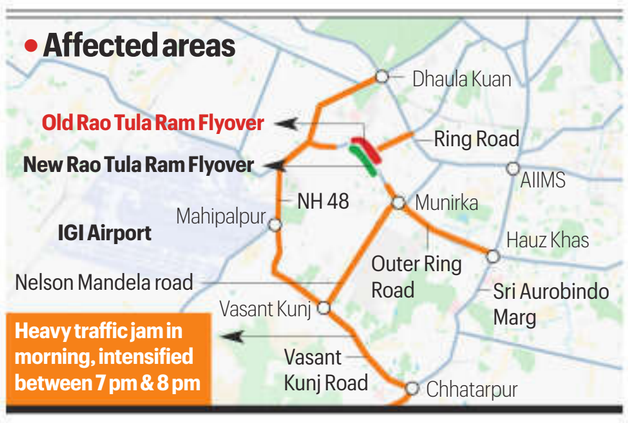
Officials said additional traffic personnel were deployed to manage the congestion, with four to five officers stationed at each junction.

Avinash (27), who is delivering materials to the World Trade Centre, says he has already spent two hours on the road. "It's completely jammed from Mahipalpur. The situation is really bad. I don't know how much more time it will take ahead," he adds.

For Arti (35), who has run a paan shop beneath the flyover since 2015, the traffic has brought an unfamiliar clientele.

"Today I saw some new faces for the first time. Otherwise, only local auto drivers come to my shop," she says, adding that the jam began around 10 am. Welcoming the repair work, she says, "Better late than never."

Gaurav Kumar, who has driven a cab in Delhi-NCR for four months, tried waiting out the congestion. He slept from noon to 3 pm, hoping the roads would clear. Now headed to Rohini, he finds the jam persists. "I slept for three hours thinking that the jam would end," he says.







The Old RTR flyover carriageway towards Vasant Vihar has been temporarily shut as cracks were detected at two spots. GAJENDRA YADAV

Priyanka backs son Raihan; Bikaner House says his photos were 'inconsistent with policy'

Anusree K C & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, October 22

CONGRESS LEADER Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Thursday threw her weight behind her son Raihan, whose photographs were taken down hours before he was to exhibit them in Bikaner House on Wednesday evening.

Bikaner House said the photographs that were "found to be inconsistent" with the policy of the venue were removed.

"When someone with power becomes afraid of the expression of another, he doesn't know it, but he has already lost the very power he is trying to protect," Priyanka posted on Instagram about Raihan's ongoing exhibition, titled 'No Idea Is Final'.

"You stand for what is true and everything beautiful will find its way to you. I am proud of you, always will be," she said.

The exhibition by Raihan, a 26-year-old visual artist and curator, was due to open on Wednesday evening. But hours before the designated time, he was asked in writing to remove or replace 74 of his 105 photographs, many of which documented the recent student and youth protests in the Capital.

The communication reached him at 3.30 pm, and gave him 30 minutes to remove the photographs. According to Raihan, he was told that "the timing and the context" of those photographs was inappropriate and overtly political.

By evening, barely 35 exhibits remained. The venue also objected to the blank frames that his team put up in place of the works that were removed.

"I was shocked to see that they also wanted me to remove images of the Indian flag," Raihan said on Wednesday. "I objected and told them that I myself would not remove any of these. As soon as I was off premises, they removed the image themselves."

In a press statement on Thursday, the Bikaner House Management Society described itself as a public cultural institution dedicated to promoting art and culture, whose exhibitions "must comply" with its policy.

The statement read, "Certain photographs displayed as part of Mr Raihan Vadra's exhibition were found to be inconsistent with the policy of the Bikaner House Management Society. Accordingly, their removal was requested. The photographs that are consistent with the Society's policy have been continued to be displayed."

Raihan had told *The Indian Express* on Wednesday that he had already removed images carrying political slogans, given the venue's policy against "political content".

Raihan was complimented by Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray.

"Well done Raihan Vadra! Facing a regime that is so scared of even photographs without any descriptions, kudos to you for standing up for the national flag and not taking down the photos that had our Flag," Thackeray posted on X.

"When democracy is reclaimed, the management [of Bikaner House] must face the Indian version of Nuremberg trials for this anti national act [of taking down pictures of the Tricolour]," Thackeray said.

Raihan also received support from INDIA bloc allies, including NCP(SP) MP Supriya Sule, who said the incident "raises serious questions about artistic freedom". "Art and photography must have the space to question, document and speak truth to power," she added.

Congress MP Pawan Khera said the "government has become so afraid of inconvenient truths that it would rather censor reality than confront it".



An empty wall at Bikaner House in New Delhi on Thursday after the photographs were removed. GAJENDRA YADAV

Content creator held over 'racial' remarks against Tripura youth

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 22

CONTENT CREATOR Amir Shokeen was arrested Thursday for allegedly making racist remarks at a youth from Tripura in a video posted recently on his Instagram handle, police said.

The purported clip allegedly shows Shokeen, a content creator with around 1.42 lakh followers, asking the youth's name and faking an attempt to pronounce it, police said.

Shokeen also uses derogatory terms and comments on the youth's looks, before calling him "Michael Jackson".

As his comments, however, faced backlash from several users, Shokeen posted another video, apologising for the same and claiming that everything was scripted.

"It was a clip made for the sake of fun. The people from the area think I have hurt their sentiments. It was a scripted video. We know that young man... He works at a friend's cafe. I am sorry if I have hurt anyone," he can be heard saying in the clip posted on Wednesday.



Amir Shokeen in police custody.

Referring to the video, the Tripura CMO had on Wednesday written on X: "CM Manik Saha has directed DGP Tripura to coordinate with Delhi Police over derogatory remarks made by a content creator against a young man from the state. Law will take its course of action."

Officers said Delhi Police's Special Unit for North Eastern Region on Wednesday received a communication from Tripura Police regarding the video.

Officers added that they came to know on Thursday that Shokeen is a resident of North Delhi's Sadar Bazaar.

"Considering the seriousness of the matter, an FIR under BNS sections 192, 196, 352 and 353 (relating to provocation with intent to cause a riot, promoting enmity between different groups, intentional insult with intent to provoke a breach of peace, and statements conducing to public mischief) was registered at Sadar Bazaar police station. Multiple teams were deployed to trace him (Shokeen). After multiple raids across Delhi, he was traced to Karol Bagh and subsequently arrested," said DCP, North, Niharika Bhatt.

Police said that Shokeen's name was listed in the records of the Sadar Bazaar police station, with cases of molestation and physical altercations registered against him. A police team from Tripura will reach Delhi and take his transit remand, officers said.

• THREE-DAY STRIKE OVER PRIVATE DISTRIBUTION LICENCE COINCIDES WITH OUTAGES ACROSS GURUGRAM; HARYANA GOVERNMENT BACKS EMPLOYEES, PLANS TO CHALLENGE REGULATOR'S ORDER

No power, water, WiFi: Gurugram reels amid outage, strike by electricity staff

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, October 22

ASHISH SARDANA, 50, woke up on Thursday to a dead inverter, dry taps and no Internet connection. Ashish, who works for an American MNC, said the power supply to his home in Gurugram's Sector 7 went out at 10 pm on Wednesday.

His children, who are preparing for entrance and competitive examinations, were unable to study.

Since Wednesday night, power outages were reported in several parts of Gurugram. Employees, led by the All India Power Corporation and various unions, began a three-day strike on Thursday over the grant of a power distribution licence to a private company in Gurugram and Nuh.

An executive member of his local Resident Welfare Association (RWA), Ashish said he tried to register a complaint through the discom's 1912 helpline. After being kept on hold for several minutes, the call disconnected. "The phones of officials concerned are switched off or not available, and linemen are on strike," he said.

Ashish eventually went to his parents' home in Sector 8.

Amid opposition from power sector employees, Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission (HERC) Monday granted a 25-year parallel electricity distribution licence to Eleven Power Pvt Ltd. Once the licence takes effect, Eleven Power will become the first private player to enter Haryana's electricity distribution sector, which has so far been dominated by two state-owned distribution companies — Uttar Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (UHBVN) and Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (DHBVN).

Harish Sardana, former president of the Sector 7 RWA, said: "The power cut was due to a snag in the master distribution line from Palam Vihar. The staff is on strike. The sub-divisional officer of the discom is not responding. Life is at a standstill."

In Sector 5, the power outage crippled domestic water distribution. "I have got at least five calls from people who haven't been able to go to office, and 10 from those not being able to work from home," said T R Adalkha, president of the Sector 5 RWA. "Many children haven't gone to school."



Union leaders and employees protesting in Chandigarh on Tuesday. FILE

Along the Dwarka Expressway, housing societies braced for prolonged cuts. "We have stocked diesel for generators to handle probable disruptions," said Sunil Sareen, deputy convenor of the Dwarka Expressway Gurugram Development Association.

The strike hit upscale areas like DLF Phase 2 too. "There was no power from 6 am for at least 3 hours," Naveen Kumar, a resident and former treasurer of the DLF Phase 2 RWA said.

Amid the outage, Gurugram Deputy Commissioner Uttam Singh held an emergency meeting with power department officials. He asked them to prioritise essential services and fix local power faults immediately.

According to a statement issued by the Electricity Employees Federation of India (EEFI), 96% of power employees in Gurugram took part in the strike. EEFI national vice-president Subhash Lamba told *The Indian Express* that the employees have also sincerely apologised for the inconvenience caused to the public.

"The state government is responsible for the mess ... For hospitals and other essential establishments, we will keep reporting for duty. We have not shut down any supply, we are only not available for repairs," the statement read.

The administration, meanwhile, issued DHBVN toll-free helplines (1912, 180010804334) and WhatsApp complaint numbers (8813999708, 9540954768) for emergencies. DHBVN Superintending Engineers Shyamveer Saini (Circle 1) and Manoj Yadav (Circle 2), alongside HVPNL Superintending Engineer KK Sarkar were on the field handling operational complaints, officials said.

In Sector 5, power was not restored till press time, while it was restored by noon in DLF Phase 2 and around 4pm in Sector 7, residents said.

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini appealed to unions to withdraw their strike, stating that the government stands with the employees. Saini said the state will appeal against the HERC's decision before the Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL). He added that the government is prepared to engage lawyers chosen by the unions to represent the case.

Saini also directed deputy commissioners to form district-level monitoring committees to report to a high-level committee led by the Chief Secretary.

In Chandigarh, Haryana Energy Minister Anil Vij said the state would move APTEL within five to six days to seek an immediate stay on the order.

"The government did not invite any application seeking privatisation ... the licence was granted despite our stiff opposition. My department engaged senior lawyers and opposed it," Vij said, adding that the government is also ready to take the matter to the Supreme Court.

Delhi Police summons CJP leaders in trespassing case, they seek time

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 22

BARELY 24 hours after Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-convenors Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were released from Tihar Jail on Wednesday, the duo was summoned by the Delhi Police Crime Branch in a trespassing case on Thursday.

However, they didn't appear, seeking more time from the Delhi Police. According to sources in the Delhi Police, Das, Ranka and CJP's Ajinkya Shinde were asked to reach the Rajouri Garden office of Crime Branch by noon on Thursday.

Sources in the police said the two will now be issued fresh notices.

Two cases lodged against Ranka and Das on October 13, when they jumped barricades to enter Jantar Mantar protest site and unfurl the National Flag, have been transferred to the Crime Branch.

The summons were issued in the trespassing case filed on a complaint by the Janata Dal (United), whose office borders the protest site.

On Wednesday, Das and Ranka were released after seven days of judicial custody after promising the Special Executive Magistrate (SEM) that they would not call for any protests at Jantar Mantar.

Sent to judicial custody on October 14, a day after the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the special intensive revision of electoral rolls, Das and Ranka were produced before the SEM at Mandir Marg police station.

As per the SEM order, both Ranka and Das gave a written undertaking promising to maintain 'peace and tranquility'. "We will not make any calls for protest at Jantar Manar till such a time that it is de-notified in accordance with law. That we further reiterate that any protest undertaken would be done within the four corners of the Constitution," the undertaking by Das and Ranka read.

The order also stated that both Das and Ranka are to furnish personal bonds and surety bonds worth Rs 50,000 along with an undertaking.

Das and Ranka had earlier signed similar bonds when they were detained at Delhi airport on October 10.



(From left) CJP leaders Saurav Das, Abhijeet Dipke and Ashutosh Ranka at a press conference. FILE

Nothing wrong in demanding regime change in democracy, Neha's lawyer tells High Court

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 22

THE DELHI High Court Thursday reserved its order after hearing All India Students' Association president Neha's plea challenging a special executive magistrate's notice demanding her to execute a bond assuring that she won't breach peace.

Justice Subramonium Prasad suggested to the state if it can "hold its horses" if he pronounced the verdict on Tuesday. The state, through Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Chetan Sharma, insisted that it is amenable to the proposition if Neha "gives an undertaking to this court that she will not breach peace".

The court ultimately reserved the verdict for Friday.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for Neha, argued that the show cause notice was passed mechanically in a cut-paste manner, "which vitiates the proceedings". He said the notice was issued under BNSS section 126 (magistrate's power to require a person to execute a bond for keeping peace) and 130 (which requires executive magistrate to pass a written order directing a person to show cause for order under BNSS 126).

Sankaranarayanan further argued, "Even for an interim bond, an inquiry is essential.



AISA chief Neha was detained in New Delhi last week. FILE

The magistrate could not have birthed the idea of a personal bond until an inquiry was completed... As a recipient of a notice like this, how am I supposed to respond to this: that they 'apprehend me of breaching peace'. The notice is expressly bad, no question in our mind to respond to something then which is constitutionally wrong, legally wrong."

Justice Prasad, addressing ASG Sharma, enquired, "Have you not predetermined... the requirement of a bond, which may or may not be necessary (without completing inquiry)?"

"In a matter where liberty is under challenge... the only safeguard a citizen gets is the requirements to be satisfied (under law)... Under Article 21 (right to liberty), we are looking at (compliance with the) procedure established by law that takes liberty away," he said.

ASG Sharma and Central government standing counsel Ashish Dixit emphasised that the police report contained all the general diary entries. They argued, "... if there are as many as 6 FIRs, can they (Neha) be ignored? Will you be a paragon of virtue, bathed in the milk of innocence, who knows nothing of what's happening?... it is not the case of a completely innocent lady."

Even as ASG Sharma pointed to alleged statements made by Neha of "regime change", Sankaranarayana contended: "There is nothing wrong in (demanding a) regime change in a democracy, I'm sorry."

The state also argued that all procedures have been satisfied under BNSS Section 126.

On October 16, Neha was detained at Mandi House while on her way to the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' march at Connaught Place. Delhi Police also took CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke into preventive custody ahead of the march.

She was released early October 17 under Section 65 of Delhi Police Act, 1978, which allows police to remove someone who refuses to comply with their "reasonable directions".

The same day, SEM Mahesh Kumar Meena issued a notice directing Neha to appear before the Special Executive Magistrate (SEM), New Delhi district, on October 19.

Slapped for rejecting torn Rs 10 note, delivery worker consumes poison, dies a day before b'day

Pragynesh
New Delhi, October 22

A DELIVERY executive, who allegedly consumed a poisonous substance after he was slapped for not accepting a torn Rs 10 note from a customer, died on Tuesday — a day before his 24th birthday — police said. The customer and his neighbour who allegedly assaulted the youth have been arrested, they said.

The alleged incident occurred on October 4, when Sameer Hussain, who worked with Flipkart Minutes, went to deliver an order — a Bru coffee jar — to Rampal Singh, 65, in east Delhi's Vinod Nagar. Police said that Hussain allegedly recorded some videos and recounted the incident. The clips were later found on his phone, they said.

"When I reached, I asked him whether he would make the payment in cash or UPI. He started putting together currency notes. I waited for 15 minutes, because he was an elderly man," he says in one of the clips.

He says that Singh gave him a torn Rs 10 note, and when he asked him to exchange it, he misbehaved.

"He told me to either take it or leave. I said, 'If you don't have money, why do you place an order?' He started bragging about his political connections and threatened to beat me up," Hussain alleges in the clip.

According to Hussain, another man, later identified as Singh's neighbour, Rakesh alias Bunty, 30, then came and slapped him three-four times,



Sameer Hussain

According to the police, while one of the accused, Rampal Singh, owns a shop in the area, his neighbour Rakesh alias Bunty is unemployed

and passed comments about his "middle-class status". "I then filed a police complaint. I don't know what will happen," he says in the clip.

Hussain is then seen taking out a bottle from his bag that he says is a "medicine".

"If I don't get justice in the next 24 hours, I will drink it. My self-respect has been shredded to pieces. Then there will be justice," he says.

Addressing his mother, Hussain says: "Your son is very strong, but this society won't let him live." In another purported video that Hussain recorded, he can be seen holding a bottle containing a liquid, and proceeds to consume it. "I will die," he adds.

Hussain's uncle, Mohammad Shamim, said the youth consumed poison on October 5. "His parents and I live in Khadda Colony (in Jaitpur area of South Delhi). On October 5, we got a call and were informed that he had been rushed to Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital as he had consumed rat poison. We reached there, and found that he was critical," he said.

"His father Zakir was sick. That's why he took the job. He wanted to save money for his studies," the uncle added.

The youth died in the hospital on Tuesday, police said.

DCP (East) Rajeev Kumar said, "We filed an FIR immediately after receiving the complaint. Both accused have been arrested, and an investigation is underway." Police said a medico-legal case was filed.

"Sections of abetment to suicide were added in the FIR following his death," said a senior police officer.

According to the police, accused Singh owns a shop in the area, while Rakesh is unemployed. "Rakesh heard the argument and came out as Singh's family members were not there. He told Hussain that he should be ashamed of arguing with an elderly person, and slapped him," said a senior police officer.

Delhi HC refuses to restore water, power connections at Race Course Masjid

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 22

THE DELHI High Court, on October 15, refused to restore electricity and water connections to Race Course Masjid, a Waqf-notified property and a Grade II heritage structure notified in 2009, after the utilities were disconnected on October 7.

The masjid is located inside the Race Course Club. The club, spread over around 53 acres near the Prime Minister's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, and the slums around it are facing eviction following multiple rounds of litigation. The Centre has cited "national security" to justify taking possession of the area.

However, officials said on Thursday that no eviction notice had been sent to the mosque.

The masjid's imam, Mohd Haroon, who lives in a 'hujra' on the premises, moved HC on October 12 after the utility connections were disconnected.

On October 8, the Delhi Waqf Board had written to the NDMC executive engineer seeking the restoration of the utilities, stating that the same had been disconnected without "any prior notice or apparent valid reason" despite all dues being paid. The Board also said the connections had been in place lawfully for decades.

Officials said no eviction notice had been sent to the mosque inside the Race Course Club

On October 15, NDMC refused to restore the utilities. It said that "since demolition work is still going on" in the area, which involves demolition of the jhuggi structures, "and there is an element of public harm involved, the electricity connection cannot be restored".

Also, according to NDMC, the Land and Development Office (L&DO), the authority overseeing the demolition and set to take possession of the land, had not been made a party to the petition.

While the masjid was not a party to the litigation concerning the eviction of around 700 slum dwellers and the Race Course Club, the NDMC's counsel orally told the court that the masjid's premises were "covered" by a HC judgment dated August 25.

The August judgment had paved the way for the eviction of slum dwellers living near the Prime Minister's residence on Race Course Road.

They have since been rehabilitated in Savda Ghevra, nearly 50 km away.

Justice Saurabh Banerjee dismissed the imam's petition on October 15, citing the NDMC's submissions and other factors.

The court noted that the Waqf Board, described as the "original occupant" of the premises, had not challenged the disconnection of electricity. It also observed that Haroon, as an imam appointed by the Board, had no right to the premises and thus could not claim a violation of his fundamental rights on account of the disconnection.

The Delhi Waqf Board has not been reconstituted since its elected body's tenure lapsed in August 2023.

Bureaucrats appointed by the Lieutenant Governor took charge of the Board in January 2024 and have continued to run it in the absence of an elected body.

In its order, the court said the petition raised "serious disputed question of facts", particularly concerning the petitioner's right, title or interest in the premises and whether the property fell outside the scope of the August 25 judgment.

"All these are way beyond the scope for this court to adjudicate in the present writ petition," the court recorded in its order while dismissing the plea.

ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE POSTS OF CHAIRPERSON AND MEMBER OF THE UTTARAKHAND LOKAYUKTA ESTABLISHMENT

It is proposed to make appointments to the vacant posts of Chairperson and Members of the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Establishment, for which applications are invited from eligible persons as per the advertisement issued on the website and the prescribed format for the posts of Chairperson and Members of the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Establishment under section 3 of the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Act, 2014.

2. The term of office and service conditions of the Chairperson and Members shall be as per the provisions mentioned in the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Act, 2014.
3. Interested applicants fulfilling the eligibility and other conditions as per the advertisement given on the website and the provisions mentioned in the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Act, 2014 for the posts of Chairperson and Member of Uttarakhand Lokayukta Establishment can submit their application in the prescribed format mentioned in the advertisement given on the website, by 5:00 p.m. on 25.11.2026, through registered post/speed post to the following address:-

   Postal Address: Convener, Search Committee, Lokayukta Bhawan, Yamuna Colony, Dehradun, Uttarakhand, Pin code - 248001
4. Applications received after the said scheduled date and time will not be considered under any circumstances.
5. For applying for the posts of Chaiperson and Member of Uttarakhand Lokayukta Establishment, advertisement, application format and conditions are available on the website **uk.gov.in**

(Arvind Kumar)
Convener, Search Committee.

दिल्ली प्रौद्योगिकी विश्वविद्यालय
DELHI TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
Established by Govt. of NCT of Delhi vide Act 6 2009
(Formerly Delhi College of Engineering)
Shahbad Daulatpur, Bawana Road, Delhi- 110042

F.DTU/Rectt./Assistant Prof./2026/F-1018/5603 Dated: 22/10/2026

Advertisement Notice No. 04/2026

RECRUITMENT FOR THE POSTS OF ASSISTANT PROFESSOR INCLUDING BACKLOG VACANCIES WITH SPECIAL DRIVE FOR PwBD CATEGORY

Opening Date & Time for Submission of Online Applications: - **23rd October, 2026 from 11:00 AM onwards**
Closing Date & Time for Submission of Online Applications: - **07th December, 2026 till 05:00 PM**

Delhi Technological University is a teaching-cum-research University committed to foster excellence in education, research, technology incubation, product innovation, outreach and extension activities in Engineering, Management, and Applied Sciences. The University invites applications from the talented individuals to fill up the posts of Assistant Professor on direct mode of recruitment. The details of the vacancy position are as given below:

S. No.	Discipline	UR	SC	ST	OBC	EWS	Total Vacant posts	PwBD*
A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1.	Applied Chemistry	0	1	0	3	0	4	0
2.	Chemical Engineering	1	0	1	2	0	4	0
3.	Applied Mathematics	4	1	0	3	3	11	1
4.	Mathematics & Computing	1	0	0	1	0	2	0
5.	Applied Physics	7	2	2	3	1	15	1
6.	Engineering Physics	1	2	0	6	2	11	1
7.	Automobile Engineering	6	1	1	2	2	12	1
8.	Civil Engineering	7	2	2	6	3	20	2
9.	Management (DSM)	0	3	2	3	2	10	1
10.	Electronics & Communication Engineering	1	1	0	1	1	4	0
11.	Electrical Engineering	2	1	1	2	2	8	0
12.	Environmental Science & Engineering	3	1	0	2	0	6	1
13.	Humanities (Economics)	1	1	1	2	0	5	0
14.	Humanities (English)	1	0	1	1	0	3	0
15.	Production Engineering	9	3	1	5	2	20	2
16.	Mechanical Engineering	2	4	1	9	2	18	2
17.	Information Technology	1	1	1	6	0	9	1
18.	Software Engineering	2	0	0	1	0	3	0
19.	Computer Science & Engineering	7	1	6	16	6	36	3
20.	Economics (USME)	0	0	0	1	0	1	0
21.	Design	2	0	0	1	0	3	0
22.	Biotechnology	1	1	0	2	2	6	1
23.	Geospatial Science#	0	0	1	0	1	2	0
24.	Geospatial Technology#	3	1	0	2	0	6	0
	Total	**62**	**27**	**21**	**80**	**29**	**219**	**17**

* For applicable Benchmark Disability for these posts, reference be made to the detailed advertisement available at the university website i.e. **www.dtu.ac.in**.
The regularisation of incumbents against these posts shall be after the application for creation, approval and sanction of these posts, as at present these posts have been borrowed from the sanctioned posts of other disciplines.
The above-mentioned vacancies are provisional and can be varied as per the requirement of the University.
For the detailed advertisement candidates are required to visit the university website i.e. www.dtu.ac.in. The interested candidates are required to fill up the application form through ONLINE mode only available at University website **www.dtu.ac.in**. Candidates are required to retain a copy of printout of the application form. All further communications related to recruitment will be displayed on the university website from time to time. In this regard, no personal communication will be entertained.

Registrar

GOVT. OF BIHAR
BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD
I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.
Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING (UGMAC)-2026 for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical / Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar

Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/16 Dated 22.10.2026

Notice regarding Extended Online Counselling Programme for Stray Vacancy Round

In continuation to Adv. No. BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/14 & 2026/15 dated 18.10.2026, it is informed to all eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 qualified candidates and all concerned that in view of the receipt of complaint from the candidates regarding Server & Technical issues, they could not submit their Consent and Choice filling for participating in Stray Vacancy Round Counselling wihin scheduled date. So, in interest of candidates, the counselling programme for Online Registration & Submission of Application-cum-Choice filling / Consent is hereby extended as follows;

Extended Important Dates for UGMAC-2026 Stray Vacancy Round Counselling :

i. Last date of online Registration ..... : 24.10.2026 (10.00 pm)
ii. Last date of submission of Application with payment through Debit Card/ Credit Card/ Net Banking/ UPI by Registered candidate/ Editing of Application Form data ..... : 24.10.2026 (11.59 pm)
iii. Consent for Stray Vacancy Round with Payment (if any) from such candidates who have already duly submitted the Application Form earlier ..... : upto 24.10.2026 (11.59 pm)
iv. Publication of Rank Card ..... : 25.10.2026
v **Last date** of Choice Filling / Editing of Choices & Locking ..... : 25.10.2026 (11.59 pm)
vi. Stray Vacancy Round Provisional Seat Allotment Result publication ..... : 27.10.2026
vii. Downloading of Provisional Seat Allotment order ..... : 27.10.2026 to 29.10.2026
viii. Documents Verification and Admission ..... : 28.10.2026 to 29.10.2026

2. Rest of the terms / conditions for Stray Vacancy Round Counselling mentioned in Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/14 Dated 18.10.2026 will remain the same.

Controller of Examination

DEFENCE INSTITUTE OF ADVANCED TECHNOLOGY
(Deemed to be University U/s 3 of UGC Act, 1956), Girinagar, Pune - 411 025.

Advt No: DIAT/F/ACAD/PHD/2026-01

Ph.D. ADMISSION NOTICE: JANUARY-2027

Defence Institute of Advanced Technology is an autonomous Institution, fully funded by the Department of Defence Research & Development, Ministry of Defence, established with the objective of imparting Post Graduate Education in Engineering and Applied Sciences on thrust area relevant to Defence, Industries, R&D and also to conduct research in the Core areas of Defence Technologies.
DIAT invites applications for the **Ph.D. programme** under Institutional Scholarship Category, in Engineering and Applied Sciences Departments. Details of Programmes, Application form, other terms & conditions are available at **www.diat.ac.in**.
In addition to the above, Industry Sponsored / Industry Self-Sponsored candidates, R & D Govt. Organisations, Tri-Services, DPSU's, Project Staff from DRDO Laboratories & DIAT (JRF/SRF/PA) & Candidates with CSIR-NET, DST, UGC-NET or any other National Fellowship / Scholarship available to them are also eligible to apply for Ph. D. admission.
Aspiring candidates may apply for admission to Ph.D. programme. Hard copy of the application along with relevant documents must reach to Joint Registrar (Academics), DIAT (DU) Girinagar, Pune-411025 latest by **1730 hours on or before 27 Nov. 2026**.

POST-DOCTORAL FELLOWSHIP AT DIAT (DU) – 2027

DIAT invites applications for the Post-Doctoral Fellowship-2027. Eligible candidates may apply for the position of Postdoctoral Fellow. The application should be submitted to the Joint Registrar (Academics), DIAT (DU), Girinagar, Pune-411025, on or before 27 Nov 2026.

Application form, other terms & conditions are available at **www.diat.ac.in.**

General Insurance Corporation of India
(Government of India Company)
Regd. Office: 'Suraksha', 170, J. Tata Road, Churchgate, Mumbai-400020
Tel: +91-22-2286 7000 • **Fax:** +91-22-2288 4010
Website: www.gicre.in • **E-mail:** investors.gic@gicre.in
CIN: L67200MH1972GOI016133 • **IRDAI REG. NO.** 112

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND REMOTE E-VOTING

Notice is hereby given to the members pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 and Section 110 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act"), read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with provisions of General Circular No(s). 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020 read with other relevant circulars issued in this regard, the latest being General Circular No. Nos. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") (collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars") and other applicable laws, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time), General Insurance Corporation of India ("Corporation") is seeking approval from the members on the following item of Special Business as set out in the Postal Ballot Notice dated October 22, 2026 is proposed for approval by the Members of General Insurance Corporation of India ("Corporation"), by means of Postal Ballot through remote e-voting:

Ordinary Resolution : Appointment of Shri Divesh Sehara as Government Nominee Director (DIN: 08365952) on the Board of the Corporation.

Members are hereby informed that –

1. The Corporation has completed the dispatch of Notice through email to the members on **22nd October 2026**.
2. The Notice along with the explanatory statement is available on the website of the Corporation www.gicre.in, on the website of e-voting agency M/s. National Securities Depository Limited ('**NSDL**') www.evoting.nsdl.com, and on the website of the Stock Exchange(s) i.e. National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) www.nseindia.com and BSE Limited (BSE) www.bseindia.com.
3. The 'Cut-off' date for the purpose of ascertaining the eligibility of members to avail remote e-voting facility is **Friday, 9th October, 2026**. The members whose name is recorded in the register of members of the Corporation or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date shall only be entitled to avail the remote e-voting facility.
4. In compliance with the MCA Circulars, the hard copy of Notice, Postal Ballot Form and prepaid business reply envelope have not been sent to the members. Hence, the members are required to communicate their assent or dissent only through the remote e-voting system. The Corporation has engaged NSDL to provide the remote e-voting facility.
5. The detailed procedure/ instructions on the process of remote e-voting are specified in the Notice.
6. The remote e-voting period will commence on **Friday, 23rd October 2026 at 09:00 a.m. (IST)** and shall end on **Saturday, 21st November 2026 at 05:00 p.m. (IST)**. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled thereafter by **NSDL**. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by a member, no change will be allowed subsequently.
7. Manner of registering / updating email address:

Physical holding	Members holding shares in physical mode are requested to get their email address registered by sending an email to the Corporation (investors.gic@gicre.in) or RTA, KFintech (einward.ris@kfintech.com).
Demat holding	Members holding shares in dematerialized mode are requested to register/update their email address with their respective Depository Participant.

8. The Corporation has appointed Ms. Ragini Chokshi (FCS 2390) and in her absence Mr. Umashankar Hegde (ACS 22133) from M/s. Ragini Chokshi & Co., Company Secretaries, as Scrutinizer for conducting the Postal Ballot process through remote e-Voting in a fair and transparent manner. The Scrutinizer's decision on the validity of the Postal Ballot shall be final.
9. The results (incl. Scrutinizer's Report) shall be displayed at the Registered Office of the Corporation and uploaded on the website of the Corporation (www.gicre.in) and on the NSDL's website (www.evoting.nsdl.com. The results shall also be communicated to the Stock Exchanges i.e. NSE & BSE simultaneously.
10. In case of any queries /grievances in connection with casting vote through remote e-voting system, members may contact to Pallavi Mahatre, from NSDL, by sending an email at evoting@nsdl.com or call on **022-48867000** (toll free).

For General Insurance Corporation of India
Sd/-
Satheesh Kumar
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai
Date : 22.10.2026

'Real friends in difficult times': India and Poland look at tie-ups in strategic sectors

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 22

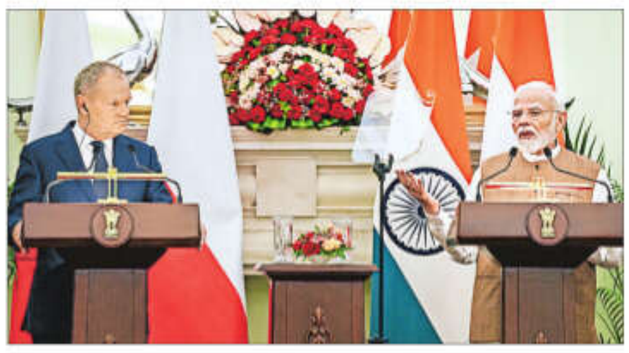
AWARE OF Delhi's close ties with Moscow, visiting Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk told Prime Minister Narendra Modi Thursday that India and Poland have "no conflict of interest" and their pursuit of "shared goals" in the space industry, digitisation, satellites, state-of-the-art defence systems can deepen the strategic partnership between the two countries.

Following their bilateral talks, Modi said, "Today we have agreed to deepen ties in defence, space and nuclear energy..."

The two sides agreed to establish a defence industry dialogue and a counter-terrorism dialogue, two critical areas of strategic cooperation.

Over the last five years, more so after the start of the war between Russia and Ukraine, two countries with which it shares a border in the north (the Russian exclave of Kaliningrad) and southeast, Poland has been ramping up its defence industry. Its drone and satellite imagery capabilities have been used by Ukraine against Russia.

Polish drone and loitering munitions were also deployed by India during Operation Sindoor which led to hostilities with Pakistan in May 2025. In fact, Tusk referred to this when he said, "Our drones ...have been very useful recently. And I am convinced that our cooperation, both in the area of satellites and drones, has helped our countries in times of political tensions and crises." He told Modi that Poland and India have become "real friends that can rely on one another in difficult times".



PM Narendra Modi and his Polish counterpart Donald Tusk at a joint press meet at Hyderabad House in New Delhi, Thursday. PTI

Recalling his visit to Poland in 2024, Modi said, "During that visit, we elevated our relations to a Strategic Partnership... our partnership has gained new momentum over the past two years. And in today's meeting with the Prime Minister, we have taken several important decisions to further strengthen our Strategic Partnership."

Referring to supply chains being threatened by China, Tusk said, "We are very much aware of the political threats and the need to become independent as much as possible in the areas of critical resources, minerals and strategic resources of any country to make sure that Poland, India and Europe are independent in those...".

Mindful of India's strategic and strong ties with Russia, he said, "Our discussions are very successful, not only because Poland and India are countries that share a lot, but we are divided by nothing, maybe by geographic distance... We have no conflict of interest. We have no historical issues that divide us. We are building our friendship based on trust, shared values and ideas such as the idea of non-violence. The great Polish revolution of solidarity was based on action without violence, and we were very much inspired by your tradition and your history."

Praising Modi, Tusk said, "We value and appreciate the global role that you, Prime Minister, play in the global context, and this is a sign of hope in the times of destabilisation, uncertainty, political uncertainty, and instability. Somebody such as you, Prime Minister of such a powerful country as India, is a beacon of hope for all of us, and I am very, very proud, truly proud that I can call myself your friend, Mr Prime Minister."

He was referring to India's proposal for a ceasefire in the Black Sea region, a move which has been welcomed by Russia, Ukraine and the US in the last few weeks. Modi said, "Be it Ukraine or West Asia, India will continue to support every meaningful effort towards peace."

Tusk said there has been unprecedented economic success in the two countries in the last 35 years. "The world looks upon us with envy," he said.

"Last year, Poland's GDP surpassed the historic milestone of one trillion dollars... India also recorded... growth of 7.8% in the last quarter," Modi said.

"Our growing economic strength has created new opportunities for the India-Poland partnership. And the India-European Union Free Trade Agreement has further expanded these opportunities... This agreement will open up new opportunities for exports of machinery, chemicals, plastics, and engineering goods from India to Poland. Additionally, we will attract new investments from Poland in sectors such as railways and mobility, advanced manufacturing, food processing, and biotech," he said.

Modi said that the two countries have decided to double bilateral trade by 2030.

He will be travelling to Bengaluru Friday.

Netanyahu calls Modi, invites him to light torch on Israel's I-Day

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, October 22

ISRAEL'S PRIME Minister Benjamin Netanyahu called up Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday. They reviewed the "sustained momentum" in bilateral ties and Netanyahu invited Modi to Israel's Independence Day.

Netanyahu, who faces elections on October 27, called up Modi and also exchanged views on the war in West Asia. The war has been ongoing for the last eight months, and the two leaders have spoken at least twice. After the phone conversation, Modi said, "Received a phone call from Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. We reviewed the sustained momentum in our bilateral ties and reaffirmed our commitment to further strengthening our partnership."

"We also exchanged views on recent developments in West Asia and underscored the urgent need to restore peace and stability in the region," he said.

Netanyahu, in his post in Hindi, said, "I spoke with my friend, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi, and invited him to light the torch alongside a brave Indian pilot on Israel's Independence Day."

"Modi thanked me for the invitation and said that on land and in the air, India and Israel are fighting terrorism together. He also commended the strong and decades-old ties between us," he said. During a phone conversation on October 3, the Israeli PM had invited Indian pilot Smit Machchhar, who survived a violent assault by his Omani co-pilot inside a Flydubai cockpit and averted a catastrophic crash on September 30.

He invited Machchhar and PM Modi to Israel for Independence Day, and called the pilot a "hero of Israel, India and the world". Israel celebrates its Independence Day on May 14.

"The two leaders welcomed the sustained momentum in India-Israel relations and reaffirmed their shared commitment to further strengthening the Special Strategic Partnership between the two countries," the PMO said, adding, "The leaders also exchanged views on recent developments in West Asia and underscored the urgent need to restore peace and stability in the region."

Shah predicts AAP's defeat in Punjab, says 'vote chori' excuse to protect infiltrators

Alok Singh
New Delhi, October 22

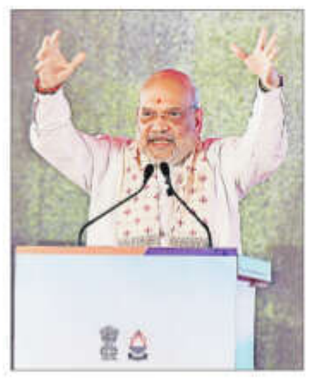
UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Thursday accused the Congress and its allies of using allegations of "vote chori" to protect the voting rights of infiltrators, while predicting that the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) would be voted out of power in Punjab in the next Assembly elections.

Addressing a gathering in Dwarka after inaugurating and laying the foundation stones for projects worth around Rs 8,941 crore related to the Delhi Jal Board and the cleaning of the Yamuna, Shah targeted the Opposition over its allegations of electoral irregularities and its criticism of the BJP.

"By raising the issue of vote theft, you are trying to save the votes of infiltrators," Shah said, addressing Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders.

Responding to allegations concerning electronic voting machines (EVMs) and electoral rolls, Shah said the Congress had remained out of power in several states for decades, even before the BJP came to power at the Centre. He said the Congress had been out of power for 41 years in Gujarat and Uttar Pradesh, 41 years in West Bengal, and 64 years in Tamil Nadu. "In Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh, the party (Congress) had been unable to form a government with a full majority for 28 years...," he said.

Shah also accused Opposition parties of adopting double standards on the Election Commission, electronic voting machines and electoral rolls, depending on the election results.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah at an event in New Delhi on Thursday. ANI

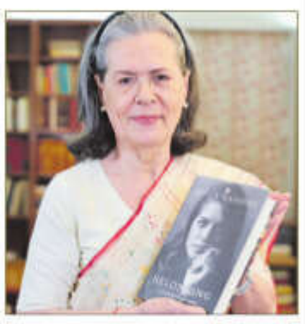
Referring to elections in Kerala, Telangana, Himachal Pradesh and Tamil Nadu, he said the Opposition had accepted the electoral process when the results went in its favour but questioned the credibility of the Election Commission and voter lists when it lost.

He also criticised Opposition parties for questioning court judgments when the verdicts went against them, saying their approach reflected double standards that voters had begun to recognise.

Shah further said the Opposition could not overturn the people's mandate by bringing party workers from neighbouring states to Delhi to stage protests. The people, he said, were watching and understanding the Opposition's politics.

On the Punjab Assembly elections that are scheduled to be held early next year, Shah said that the AAP will be wiped out of the state. By 2029, we (the NDA) will make Punjab drug-free, he added.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL



First Book, First Insta Post

MONTHS AFTER her upcoming memoir landed in a publishing controversy, Congress leader Sonia Gandhi shared a video offering the first look of the book on Instagram on Thursday. It was her first post on the platform, which she joined in the morning and got over 1.5 lakh followers by evening. "Hello everyone, I'm truly grateful to share this moment with you all; the first look of Belonging: A Journey of Love. It is a story of love, duty, loss and finding a place to belong. I look forward to sharing it with you," she wrote. Sonia's decision to join Instagram, after staying away from social media for years, was welcomed by several Congress leaders who shared her post. She is currently following three handles — INC India, Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra. In September, Sonia's memoir sparked a controversy after Penguin Random House India decided not to publish it following disagreements over proposed editorial changes and deletions.

On a Break

The INDIA bloc, which is currently on a break from protests in Delhi against "vote chori" and CEC Gyanesh Kumar, is expected to meet again soon to chalk out the next course of action. A virtual meeting planned for the Opposition leaders on Thursday by Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge was cancelled as some prominent leaders were not available to join at such short notice. Sources said a meeting is in the works in the coming days where the INDIA bloc will discuss its strategy to raise the heat on the government and Gyanesh Kumar.

EXPRESS special

Mahayuti's MLC poll test: Can Devendra Fadnavis deliver another win?

CM's home turf of Nagpur in focus; ruling allies fight on ground

Shubhangi Khapre
Mumbai, October 22

ELECTIONS TO five seats in Maharashtra's Legislative Council — three graduates' and two teachers' constituencies — are set to test Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis and the cohesion of the ruling Mahayuti alliance, with differences within the BJP and among its three constituents coming to the fore.

The Nagpur graduates' constituency is particularly significant for the BJP, which has fielded former MLA Sudhakar Kohle against Congress sitting MLC Abhijit Wanjari. BJP had lost it to the Congress in 2020 after holding it for 58 years as the BJP and its predecessor, the Jana Sangh.

The Nagpur tangle

The party's decision to field Kohle triggered dissent from former MLA Anil Sole, who announced that he would contest as an Independent. After sustained persuasion by senior BJP leaders, Sole withdrew his candidature and agreed to support the party's official nominee.

While the BJP managed to avert a direct contest from within its ranks, the episode exposed discontent over candidate selection. "Unlike in the past, when candidates were selected democratically, now they are decided from the top. We are not even consulted on candidate selection," said Sole.



CM Devendra Fadnavis and Deputy CM Eknath Shinde. EXPRESS

The BJP leadership has made it clear that it cannot afford another setback in Nagpur.

In 2020, BJP's Sandeep Joshi, a former Nagpur Mayor and then a close confidant of Fadnavis, lost to Wanjari. The defeat was a major embarrassment for the BJP, then in the Opposition, as Nagpur is both the RSS headquarters and the hometown of Fadnavis and Union Minister Nitin Gadkari. The seat had previously been represented by prominent leaders, including Gadkari and the late Gangadharrao Fadnavis, the CM's father.

In an effort to prevent a repeat of the 2020 outcome, Fadnavis spent two days in Nagpur holding meetings with current office-bearers and senior party veterans to improve coordination. He also campaigned extensively across the constituency.

The BJP is officially contesting three of the five seats: Nagpur and Pune graduates' constituencies, and the Pune teachers' constituency. Its candidates are Kohle in Nagpur, Smita Jadhav in Pune graduates, and Kaustubh Gawde in Pune teachers.

Under the seat-sharing arrangement, the Amravati teachers' constituency has been allotted to the Shiv Sena led by Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde, while the Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar graduates' seat has gone to the NCP led by Sunetra Pawar.

However, the arrangement has failed to prevent differences among the allies from spilling into the election campaign. The Shiv Sena has extended support to Independent candidate Chandrakant Sanap in the Pune teachers' constituency, challenging the BJP's Gawde.

On Wednesday, the last day of campaigning, Shinde maintained that the alliance would win all five seats. Fadnavis also sought to play down the differences, expressing confidence that the Mahayuti would win all five constituencies comfortably.

The Opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi, comprising the Congress, Shiv Sena (UBT) and NCP(SP), has also had its share of friction. In the Amaravati seat, the Shiv Sena (UBT) fielded a candidate while accusing the Congress of "unilaterally declaring its nominee".

The MVA's candidate selection has also triggered discontent among its ranks with leaders filing nominations as Independents, especially in the Pune seat. According to a former Congress minister, even in Nagpur where there is no "friendly fight", the Sena (UBT) and NCP(SP) are not proactively working in coordination with the party's candidate.

'Fragile' ground situation

The ground situation, however, suggests a more complicated contest. In Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, the Sena has also challenged the NCP's official candidate, Satish Chavan.

Senior Sena leader and former minister Abdul Sattar has announced support for Dr Pratapsingh Patil of the NCP (SP). "The Shiv Sena has always worked against the NCP. Why should we support it now?" he asked.

The BJP, too, has faced rebellion in the Amravati teachers' constituency. The BJP subsequently expelled the rebels — Chandrakant Bhoyar, Sangeeta Bonde-Shinde and Sunil Pawar — for six years.

As the MLC elections brought fault lines within the Mahayuti into the open, the state coordination committee, headed by BJP leader Chandrashekhar Bawankule and comprising ministers from the Shiv Sena and the NCP, was set up to address differences within the government and the alliance.

It has, however, failed to ensure coordination among the partners in the Council polls.

Shiv Sena minister Sanjay Shirsat, however, said, "The BJP should share power and seats with alliance partners to avoid conflict," he said.

NCP leaders Sunil Tatkare and Praful Patel had earlier expressed displeasure over their party being denied the Pune graduates' constituency.

The lack of coordination has also been cited as a factor in the ruling alliance's defeat in the Kolhapur District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union, popularly known as Gokul. On Wednesday, NCP minister Hassan Mushrif blamed differences within the Mahayuti for the defeat of the ruling parties' panel against the panel led by Congress MLC Satej Patil.

The elections to the five Council seats will be held on October 23, with counting scheduled for October 27.

Amid Special Session speculation, Birla says only govt can take call

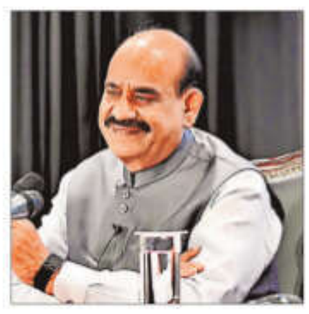
Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22

LOK SABHA Speaker Om Birla on Thursday declined to comment on whether a Special Session of Parliament is being planned, saying that as per procedure it is the government that initiates the same. He was answering a question on whether the government may hold a special session to take up key Bills as both Houses of Parliament are yet to be prorogued after being adjourned sine die on August 13.

"There is a process for that (prorogation of the House and special session). The government's parliamentary committee sends it to the President... If you see Article 85 of the Constitution, you will see that the Speaker has no role," Birla said, speaking at a press conference on the BRICS Parliamentary Forum, which is to be hosted in Delhi on October 26-27.

Article 85 deals with the sessions of Parliament, and their prorogation and dissolution. "The President may from time to time — (a) prorogue the Houses or either House," says Article 85(2).

According to Lok Sabha Secretariat sources, the government usually gives at least three days' notice before a Special Session and around 15 days before a Session, like the Winter Session, both of which have not happened yet.



Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla

When asked about the split in the Trinamool Congress, he said a decision would be taken after both sides submit their responses. Asked if any party has written to him seeking removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, a demand that the Opposition has been raising, he said when a motion comes before him, the process will be followed.

Birla said the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum — with the theme 'Strengthening Parliaments for People-Centric Development' — would bring together presiding officers and include bilateral and multilateral interactions.

● BEYOND GEOPOLITICS, THE LITFEST'S FOCUS IS ON BRINGING STUDENTS AND YOUNGSTERS TOGETHER AS AMBASSADORS SHARE THEIR WORK AND LIVES

First-of-a-kind litfest for diplomats from October 25 to 27

Divya A
New Delhi, October 22

IN A first, a dedicated literature festival will be held for diplomats in New Delhi from October 25 to 27. Ambassadors and senior diplomats from Ukraine, Turkiye, the United States, Italy, France and Germany are expected to be in attendance.

The only condition for participating in 'Words Beyond Borders' is that each of them has to be a published author.

So far, over 80 speakers from 30 countries have confirmed their participation at the three-day event to be held in Neemrana. Backed by the Ministry of External Affairs and Rajasthan government, the event will see over 65 foreign diplomats and around 20 Indian foreign service officers - who are retired or presently deployed in various missions.

The initiative is a brainchild of Dnyaneshwar Mulay, who is a 1983 batch foreign service officer. Dubbed as the 'Passport Man of India' for radically transforming and expanding India's passport ecosystem during his tenure as Secretary to the MEA, Mulay has served in prominent assignments in New York, Maldives and Russia.

Talking to *The Indian Express*, Mulay — who has written over a dozen books in Hindi and Marathi — said, "I come from a small village and while writing has been my passion, I have always felt that there was a huge gap in people's understanding of how foreign policy is conducted. For instance, my mother had no idea of the work her son does. So, I brought out my books in Marathi language for her and others in my village to understand the intricacies."

According to Mulay, the festival's focus is on bringing students and youngsters together as participants share their work and lives in an informal setting. So, students from various universities across the country have been invited to attend sessions over three days, and interact with diplomats on the sidelines.







The litfest is a brainchild of (above) Dnyaneshwar Mulay; (Right) Ruchi Ghanshyam and Navdeep Suri will conduct some sessions at the event.

"Let students think: why are diplomats needed at all," Mulay said. While sessions have been curated to focus on words and literary experiences, certain sessions will discuss India's ties with ASEAN and East Asia — Why Europe is at Crossroads; and Why non-alignment is a way forward for the Global South.

Ambassador Navdeep Suri will chair a discussion on 'Foreigner in Translation' with Gonchig Ganbold of Mongolia and Egypt's Mohamed Tawfik. Sreeram Chaulia will analyse India's ties with Pakistan, along with former TCA Raghavan, Ruchi Ghanashyam and Ajay Bisaria, who have served on the Indian mission in Pakistan.

Joshi unveils portal for Kashi Tamil Sangamam 5.0

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22

UNION EDUCATION Minister Pralhad Joshi Thursday launched the registration portal for the fifth edition of the cultural and educational exchange programme Kashi Tamil Sangamam (KTS 5.0). The theme for this year is *Thirukkural* — a 2,500-year-old ancient Tamil text written by Thiruvalluvar.

Speaking at the launch, Joshi highlighted the country's strong cultural unity. The KTS programme will be held from November 28 to December 12.

Show-cause notice to Chhattisgarh IPS officer for firing AK-47 on Dussehra

Raipur: A senior IPS officer in Chhattisgarh's Rajnandgaon district has been served a show-cause notice after a video showing her firing bullets into the air from an AK-47 rifle, dressed in a saree, during a traditional weapon-worship ritual on Dussehra received backlash on social media.

The incident took place during the "Shastra Puja" at Police Lines on October 20 on the occasion of Vijayadashami.

The video, featuring IPS officer Ankita Sharma, was shared widely on social media and aired on several news channels and web portals, triggering a debate on safety, discipline and weapon-handling protocols.

Rajnandgaon Range Inspector General of Police Ajay Yadav confirmed Sharma had received a show-cause notice. "Once I get her reply, I will send it, along with my note, to the seniors."

A senior official, explaining the reason behind the show-cause notice, said, "The video went viral on social media and received negative traction. It was against the norms and safety rules and so we took cognizance and asked her to explain what were the circumstances..." ENS

To block 'mala fide intentions', Gujarat bans outsiders' entry to govt schools

Ritu Sharma
Ahmedabad, October 22



The 'no outside person without permission' directive came into force on Thursday. BHUPENDRA RANA

NO ONE, including parents and guardians of students, can now enter a government school in Gujarat without prior written permission. Those who do get permission to enter cannot take pictures or make videos inside the school.

Violation of these directives, which were issued by the government on Wednesday will attract legal action. Some evidence of increased vigilance at school entrances was visible in Ahmedabad on Thursday.

The restrictions listed in state Education Department's circular apply to almost 46,000 primary, secondary, and higher secondary schools across the state.

"Any outside person wishing to enter the school premises must obtain prior written permission from the school principal or the head of the institution", the circular says. "Only government officials who have been duly authorised under the applicable rules to perform their official duties shall be exempt from this requirement," it says.

The circular prohibits photography, videography, interviewing, audio recording or live streaming of students, teachers, or school activities without written permission from the principal. "Such activities may be allowed only when legally justified and duly authorised," the circular says. The circular has been framed as an instrument to act in accordance with the 'acting in place of parents' principle The state bears special responsibility for safety, dignity, privacy, and welfare of all children in state-run and government-aided schools, the circular says.

It refers to Article 21 of the Constitution, which gives "children the right to life, dignity, and privacy", the Supreme Court's 2017 judgment recognising the right to privacy as a fundamental right, and National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) guidelines mandating a safe and secure environment in school, and protection of children's privacy.

State Education Minister Pradyuman Vaja told reporters on Thursday, "It applies only to non-authorised persons and persons with mala fide intentions. People can enter schools, but only after permission... violators will attract all the existing four-five laws including POCSO (the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012), Juvenile Justice Act (2015) and the BNS (Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023), but only if there is a violation of these legal provisions".

According to the circular, every visitor entering the school must record their details in visitors' register. Once inside, the "outside person" will need written permission to enter classrooms, laboratories, ... toilets, or other areas where student activities take place.

"Movement of outsiders was not allowed without permission, but in the absence of a guard or security check at the school gates, the entry of individuals could not be monitored... The latest circular makes it mandatory and legal now," Prakash Trivedi, Director of Primary Education, told *The Indian Express*.

"If any person enters the school without permission... or obstructs the functioning of the school, the Principal shall immediately inform the local police and the District Education Officer or the District Primary Education Officer, Administrative Officer, Taluka Primary Education Officer and take necessary action under the applicable law," says the circular.

The opposition Congress targeted government over circular, calling it an "attempt to conceal failure of education system and a conspiracy to keep government schools away from transparency." Congress spokesperson Manish Doshi said in a statement "The BJP government should remember that controlling cameras does not eliminate the shortcomings of schools, and threats do not improve the quality of education".

Govt for parameters to distinguish between journalists, influencers

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, October 22

CONCERNED OVER the fallout of countless reels generated during the Gen Z protests over the last three months in the Capital and elsewhere, the government is considering setting parameters to distinguish bona fide digital journalists from influencers who see themselves as journalists, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

While the discussions are in early stages, some ideas under consideration include drawing up parameters like journalism being the primary source of income for the influencer, YouTube channel or portal claiming to be engaged in the profession, and a basic level of following for them to be considered practising journalists.

The government's concerns arose in the last three months, since July protests by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) against NEET-UG paper leak, when influencers made multiple videos from protest sites, coined slogans and shot videos of police action on protesters.

Videos were also circulated when detentions happened a few days ago at Jantar Mantar and other sites, where some of the detainees insisted they were journalists and were being stopped from doing their work.

"This can also create a situation where bona fide journalists can feel they are facing restrictions because influencers in large numbers are posing as journalists, and often have some kind of an ID card to bolster their claim," said a source.

One proposal in official circles is to run accreditation requests in digital space through parameters they see as distinguishing between influencers and bona fide journalists. The rationale: not everyone carrying a camera and mobile phone is a bona fide journalist, and privileges that are enjoyed on account of their calling should not be automatically extended to the former category of people.

"Everyone enjoys the basic rights of a citizen. However, restrictions can be placed on what they film or where they go, as per the law. The idea is that any additional access that journalists enjoy could well be limited to only those who are accepted as bona fide journalists as per rationally defined criteria," a source said.

What has changed the scenario, as far as authorities are concerned, is the sudden explosion of reels on social media, something very different from TV as well as print media news. Many videos recently went viral, leading to a perception that there was a groundswell of anger against the government, and also that the police tried to suppress the protesters with a heavy hand. There were also videos of youngsters using cuss words — something that was flagged by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in one of his videos released after the CJP-led protests were called off.

The videos circulated by student protesters and influencers created a negative global perception of the government's handling of the protests, and rendered much of TV media ineffective, said sources. It is these videos that have set the government thinking about how to combat this new kind of challenge, the sources said.

• BRIEFLY



Sarang Helicopter Display Team performs manoeuvres during the 'Wings Over Ganges' over Malviya Bridge in Varanasi on Thursday ANI

UTTAR PRADESH

'Wings Over Ganges' air show kicks off in Varanasi; will showcase 100 aircraft

THE INDIAN Air Force's 'Wings Over Ganges' aerial show began at Namo Ghat on Thursday. The event, organised to mark 94 years of the IAF's service, drew large crowds to the ghats.The IAF will showcase 100 aircraft during the event, including 52 fighter jets, 15 transport aircraft, 32 helicopters and one heritage aircraft, officials said. The 'Tridev Formation' featured helicopters of the Army, Navy and Air Force flying, highlighting coordination and jointness among the three services, officials said. PM Narendra Modi, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, UP Governor Anandiben Patel and CM Yogi Adityanath are scheduled to attend on October 25.The event is scheduled for October 22, 24 and 25. It will not be held on October 23 due to UP Legislative Council polls.PTI

Missing girl's half-burnt body found in Odisha

POLICE ON Thursday recovered the half-burnt, decomposed body of a girl, 14, who had been missing since October 16 after going to a local market in Odisha's Balasore district, an officer said. Some villagers found slippers and scarves near a field and, at a distance, the body of a girl with burn injuries to her face, abdomen and chest. The girl's family alleged that she had been abducted, gang-raped, murdered and then burnt to destroy evidence. PTI

Gang of 11 hacks and shoots BJP worker in Bengal

A BJP worker, 35, was allegedly hacked and shot dead by unknown assailants at his house in Malda late on Wednesday. Samir Ghosh was alone at home when about 11 assailants allegedly forced their way inside. According to police sources, initial findings indicate Ghosh was first hacked and then shot twice at close range to ensure his death.The police arrested one suspect. The victim's family has accused a local TMC worker and associates over political rivalry. ENS

Maneka Gandhi slams draft rules easing lab trial approvals

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22

AS THE Centre prepares to amend rules governing the use of animals in experiments, animal welfare activists have criticised proposed changes, arguing that the draft rules issued by the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying raise concerns about the adequacy of safeguards for animals.

Earlier this month, the ministry released draft Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (Control and Supervision of Experiment, Breeding and Trading of Laboratory Animals) Rules, 2026, seeking objections and suggestions in 30 days. Once finalised, it will replace the existing framework—the Breeding of and Experiments on Animals (Control and Supervision) Rules, 1998.

In a statement, People for Animals, an animal welfare organisation founded by former Union minister Maneka Gandhi, said the proposed changes in laboratory rules raise questions over safeguards for animals.

"Most experiments on animals in India's laboratories... could soon be approved by the institutions conducting them, under draft rules issued by the Union Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying," the statement said.

Quoting Maneka Gandhi, the statement said, "You cannot ask an institution to police itself when the lives of animals are at stake. Who will protect the animals if independent oversight is weakened? The whole world is trying to get animals out of laboratories. Our own Health Ministry has said new drugs can be tested without them. And now we are making it easier to put more animals in. Who is this for? Not for science, and certainly not for animals".

EXPRESS special

Kumaraswamy takes lead as Karnataka BJP struggles to find its voice

Akram M
Bengaluru, October 22



Union Minister for Steel and Heavy Industries and JD(S) state president H D Kumaraswamy

THE BJP might be the largest Opposition party in Karnataka, but in recent months, its junior ally Janata Dal (Secular) has taken the lead in countering the D K Shivakumar-led Congress government and putting it on the defensive.

Union Minister for Steel and Heavy Industries and JD(S) state president H D Kumaraswamy has increasingly emerged as the most vocal of Opposition voices against the government. Kumaraswamy's increased focus on Karnataka politics is being seen as a tactical move to prepare his party for the 2028 Assembly polls.

Kumaraswamy going solo, especially over the recent sting video controversy in Karnataka, has not sat well with a few BJP leaders. In the BJP, some sections have interpreted Kumaraswamy's increasing focus on state politics as a sign that the party could be preparing to part ways before the state polls.

That the Karnataka BJP has not been able to sort out its leadership issues has offered room for the JD(S) to find its footing, with Kumaraswamy at the helm. In recent months, Kumaraswamy has aggressively targeted the Congress government on issues ranging from the Bidadi Township proposal and the Bengaluru-Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor (BMIC/NICE) controversy to alleged irregularities in the KPSC recruitment processes and the recent video controversy. These interventions have repeatedly forced a response from Shivakumar and other senior ministers in his Cabinet.

Compared to the BJP, the JD(S) has sustained political campaigns over these issues. On the sting video controversy, Kumaraswamy held multiple press conferences last week, accusing Shivakumar of running a "factory" of sting videos to corner his opponents. The CM responded, saying "time will answer".

'De facto Opposition leader'

A senior JD(S) leader said Kumaraswamy's emergence as "de facto Opposition leader" was linked to his longstanding rivalry with Shivakumar. Noting that both of them hail from the Vokkaliga community, he said that save for the short-lived truce during the Congress-JD(S) coalition government in 2018-19, the two have never seen eye to eye.

"Moreover, BJP leaders have not been effective in raising issues. Even if an issue is raised, Kumaraswamy's voice has more weight than that of Leader of Opposition R Ashok or BJP state president B Y Vijayendra, for that matter. This vacuum has benefitted JD(S) as Kumaraswamy raises issues aggressively," he said.

Several BJP insiders admitted that the party had ceded space to Kumaraswamy and the JD(S) in recent months. "Kumaraswamy even staged a protest in front of Bengaluru City Police Commissioner's office over the sting row. He has held campaigns over KPSC and NICE issues. Though we too have taken up issues, they have not been as successful as the ones raised by the former CM," said a BJP leader.

Though there have been questions about the future of the BJP-JD(S) alliance, insiders feel it was too early to comment on it. Recently, scoffing at the speculation surrounding the alliance, BJP Parliamentary Board leader and former CM B S Yediyurappa, Vijayendra's father, said the two parties were together and would continue to remain so. "Both the parties will fight together to remove this corrupt government and secure power in 2028," he said.

Congress spokesperson Ramesh Babu alleged that the RSS was using Kumaraswamy to counter the government. "Since state BJP leaders have failed to counter the Congress government, the Sangh Parivar is using Kumaraswamy," he said.

Babu said Kumaraswamy was an expert at "hit-and-run" tactics. "None of the allegations made by him will stick," he said.

Same vehicle, triple price: ACS warns MP civic bodies against inflated purchases

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, October 22

A VIDEO of a departmental meeting in Madhya Pradesh has surfaced, showing Additional Chief Secretary of the Urban Development and Housing Department Sanjay Dubey confronting officials of urban local bodies over alleged irregularities in government purchases and warning them that the department is monitoring them.

In the recent meeting, Dubey cited instances of garbage vehicles being purchased at vastly different prices by various civic bodies, questioned need for some municipalities to buy vehicles worth crores of rupees, and warned chief municipal officers against assuming their purchases would go unnoticed.

The presentation accompanying his remarks cited purchases worth Rs 1,134 crore through Government e-Marketplace (GeM) by 374 urban local bodies over three years, with an estimated Rs 250 crore in potential savings had goods been purchased at average prices. "You think that you have bought this or bought that, and nobody has any idea about it. I am telling you that we know what you have bought, where you have bought it, in what quantities and at what rates," Dubey told officials.

Citing example of garbage vehicles, he said: "One bought a garbage vehicle for Rs 2 lakh, while another urban local body bought the same vehicle for Rs 6 lakh, along with four dustbins..."

Dubey said the department was now taking action against officials over such purchases.

The ACS questioned purchases of garbage vehicles worth as much as Rs 1.5 crore by some civic bodies, despite doubts over whether they had enough wards to operate them. "The vehicles have been booked and purchased, but where they are operating, whether they are being used somewhere else, we do not know," he said. Dubey told officials: "Last year, I did not pay much attention to this. But from this year, this will not be condoned. I am making that absolutely clear to you."

When contacted, Dubey's office said, "This is a regular monitoring exercise in which there is a study made over the purchases made by civic agencies and anomalies are investigated. The errant officials are identified and action is taken regularly to ensure a fair and transparent procurement process in all civic bodies."

The meeting, held at Sunderlal Patwa Urban Development Training Institute in Bhauri, Bhopal, was attended by Urban Administration Commissioner Sanket Bhondve, chief municipal officers from urban local bodies, and other departmental officials. Anshuman Raj, Additional Managing Director of the Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation presented procurement analysis.

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL
SADAR BAZAR ROAD, DELHI CANTT-110010

REQUIRED TEACHING STAFF ON PART-TIME BASIS

Army Public School, Sadar Bazar Road Delhi Cantt requires competent and experienced teaching staff for the under mentioned posts on part time basis.
(a) PGT - English and Physical Activity Trainer
(b) TGT– English, Science and Social Science
Candidates must meet CBSE norms. Interview will be held on 28 Oct 2026. Reporting & Registration Timing 730hrs to 0900hrs at School reception.
Principal

SH. Devendra Kumar Sharma
Special Judge, NDPS-08
Room No.701, Seventh Floor
Rouse Avenue court complex, New Delhi
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON (See Section 84 of BNSS.)
SC No. 392/2017
Cr.No-VIII/21/DZU/2017
NCB Vs Zodwa Frankline

1) Where as complaint has been made before me that Mr. ZODWA FRANKLIN @ MBAEZUE COLLINS TOCHUKWU, S/o Sh. PRINE, R/O PLOT NO. 03, GALI NO. 22, JAIN ROAD, BHAGWATI ROAD EXTENSION, UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI has committed (or suspected to have committed) the offence punishable under section U/S 20/25/29 of NDPS ACT 1985 and it has been returned to a warrants of arrest thereupon issued that the said Mr. ZODWA FRANKLIN @ MBAEZUE COLLINS TOCHUKWU cannot be found and whereas it has shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mr. ZODWA FRANKLIN @ MBAEZUE COLLINS TOCHUKWU has absconded.(or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant)

2) Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on the day of 28.11.2026

Sd/-
Special Court, NDPS-8
RACC Court, 7th Floor, Room No 701

CBC-19126/11/0096/2627

Forest department to seek expert help for 'surgery' to save over 500 girdled trees dying inside tiger reserve

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, October 22

IN A bid to save at least over 500 trees that were girdled allegedly by encroachers in Karka village situated deep inside the Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve (USTR), the forest department is seeking expert help to save the trees by performing bridge grafting technique.

Girdling is a process in which portions of the bark are removed to cut off nutrient supply, eventually resulting in the death of the tree.

Earlier this month, T*he Indian Express* had reported that around 2,500 trees predominantly Sal, Bija and Tendu were found girdled in the Tiger Reserve during an inspection. At least over 500 of them are freshly girdled and the chances of saving them is higher, a forest official said.

The trees were girdled allegedly by villagers of Karka for encroaching on forest land. A forest case has been registered against them. Between September 22 and October 10 an inspection was carried out by the forest department. This includes a DGPS-enabled drone survey read alongside ISRO satellite imagery from 2010, 2016 (dense forest) which helps the forest department to estimate that encroachers have cleared several thousands of trees in the affected landscape between 2016-2026.

"These findings underscore the magnitude of forest loss and the urgent need for restoration and stronger protection measures besides prosecution of the accused persons from Karka. While several trees have suffered damage over the years, some (over 500) have been freshly girdled, raising concerns that deliberate damage is being used to facilitate further expansion of encroachment. Protecting the forests of USTR is particularly important given their significance for biodiversity and the Mahanadi River's origin landscape," said Deputy Director of USTR, Varun Jain.



The trees were girdled allegedly by villagers of Karka for encroaching on forest land

In order to save the girdled trees especially the newly girdled ones, a specialised conservation initiative is being undertaken where Vijay Nishanth, known as Tree Doctor for his work in tree conservation through Project Vruksha Foundation, will visit the Tiger Reserve soon to provide technical assistance in the surgical treatment and restoration of affected trees.

"Bridge grafting involves grafting a healthy branch across the girdled portion of a tree to reconnect the damaged tissues. We currently apply a mixture of cow dung and soil over the wound and wrap it with gunny bags. The procedure is more effective pre-monsoon when tissue growth is higher. However, our success rate was less as we have not had enough time to research the technique and so to try and save more trees, we are taking expert help to save the trees," Jain added.

Scientific Surgery to Save Girdled Trees USTR had previously undertaken bridge grafting of girdled trees in Tourenga Range in 2022. However, the intervention recorded a success rate of approximately 10%, highlighting the need for specialised expertise and improved treatment techniques.

Nishanth's proposed visit will focus on assessing affected trees, identifying those that can potentially be saved, and recommending appropriate surgical interventions, including bridge grafting and other suitable tree-restoration techniques.

The initiative will also provide an opportunity for USTR personnel to learn specialised treatment procedures and develop protocols for subsequent care and monitoring.

Integrating Traditional Ecological Knowledge alongside scientific interventions, USTR is consulting tribal communities and forest dwellers residing in and around the Reserve to draw upon their traditional ecological knowledge and indigenous practices relating to tree care and healing.

The initiative seeks to explore how traditional knowledge, assessed alongside scientific methods, can contribute to the recovery of damaged trees and strengthen community participation in forest conservation.

The primary objective is to prevent the irreversible loss of valuable trees wherever timely intervention offers a reasonable chance of recovery.

CANCELLED FLIGHTS

4,000 Indian Haj pilgrims stranded in Saudi; MEA says working on their early return

Divya A
New Delhi, October 22

THE MINISTRY of External Affairs said on Thursday it was in touch with tour operators and airlines to facilitate the early return of Indian Haj and Umrah pilgrims stranded in Saudi Arabia following flight disruptions caused by attacks on airport infrastructure. The MEA's response comes after AIMIM leader Asaduddin Owaisi flagged that thousands were stuck in Makkah and Madina.

"Four thousand pilgrims from India are stuck in Makkah and Madina. They flew via IndiGo, Akasa Air and Air India but are now stuck there since these airlines have cancelled their flights," Owaisi said in a post on X. He urged the DGCA to permit airlines to operate larger aircraft to bring the pilgrims home, or arrange dedicated flights for their return.

Hours later, the MEA said the Indian Embassy in Riyadh and the Consulate in Jeddah were actively engaging with concerned airlines and tour operators to facilitate early return of affected pilgrims. It said approximately 3,000 stranded Umrah pilgrims had returned to India on available flights over the past week, in addition to more than 10,000 regular Umrah pilgrims who had travelled back on scheduled flights.

The MEA also put out the numbers of control rooms set up to assist Indian citizens in Saudi Arabia.

Flights have faced major schedule disruptions following attacks on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

EXPRESS special

10,470 voters' names changed in one Uttar Pradesh seat, FIR against officers

Election Commission says action being taken to rectify all irregular entries

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, October 22

IN A statement issued Thursday, the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Uttar Pradesh, said "irregularities" had been found in 10,470 entries in the electoral roll of Pilibhit Assembly constituency, and ordered legal action against two Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs). It also announced the termination of services of a computer assistant at the constituency's Voter Registration Centre.

An FIR has been filed against the three by the Assistant District Election Officer.

In its statement, the CEO said an inquiry report submitted by the Pilibhit District Election Officer showed that 13,779 Form 8 applications had been made for "corrections" to voter details between May 31 and August 29. However, no physical forms or supporting records relating to these entries were available at the office.

Of the 13,779 entries, "corrections" to 10,470 forms were approved. The inquiry found irregularities in all 10,470 approved entries, the statement said. The authorities said action was underway to rectify all irregular Form 8 entries. Departmental proceedings have been ordered against both AEROs, the CEO statement said.

The FIR against the AEROs – Mayank Goswami and Hemant Kumar – and the computer assistant, Anil Kumar, was registered at Kotwali Police Station in Pilibhit on Thursday. They have been booked under Sections dealing with "breach of official duty" in connection with electoral rolls, and framing of an incorrect document or electronic record "with the intention of causing injury" by an official.

The FIR lists three Elector Photo Identity Card (EPIC) numbers and says their online verification revealed discrepancies in the names of voters and their fathers. It also says that a review found that while 4,717 forms for "corrections" were entered during Goswami's tenure, 9,062 were filed after Hemant Kumar took charge on July 17.

The FIR says that the prescribed standard operating procedures for processing claims and objections were not followed and that offline and online records of the forms were unavailable.

The CEO had ordered an inquiry into the Pilibhit electoral roll following complaints that different names were showing up against EPIC numbers of voters who figured in the final electoral roll published on April 10, 2026, after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in Uttar Pradesh.

Separately, the CEO has directed the Pilibhit District Election Officer to scrutinise all Form 6 entries for addition of names and Form 7 entries for deletions between April 10 and October 21. A detailed report has been sought by Friday.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, CEO Navdeep Rinwa said they had received complaints about irregularities in the Pilibhit electoral roll as part of a memorandum submitted by the Samajwadi Party (SP) on October 19, which also included other issues. "The matter concerning Pilibhit was mentioned on the third and fourth pages," Rinwa said, adding that a report was then sought from the DM.



Assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh are months away. FILE

A complaint was also submitted by advocate Faizan Ali Khan who, on October 14, wrote to the Pilibhit district administration alleging that his name and that of his younger brother Farhan were missing in electoral records despite figuring in the final voter roll after the SIR. A resident of Awas Vikas Colony in Pilibhit, Khan told *The Indian Express* that he and Farhan had even appeared before election authorities in response to an official notice and presented documents, which were verified.

Khan said in his complaint that the name 'Raees Ali' appeared when his EPIC number was checked, identified as 'son/relative of Huzaib Ali', though his father's name is Mushfiq Ali Khan. Against Farhan's details, he said, the name that showed up was 'Gufran Aslam', 'son of Hamid Aslam'. No person by these names existed in his neighbourhood, Khan said, adding that fictitious names had been entered, potentially depriving him and Farhan of their right to vote.

Khan demanded that their correct details be restored, and an investigation be done to establish how the changes were made after the final roll had been published.

Local Congress leader Kumud Gangwar said he raised alarm after he got to know about the discrepancies via advocate Rehan Ali, a resident of the Pilibhit seat, who had found "altered" names against EPIC numbers of his brother and sister. Gangwar also alleged that on the dates of revision showing up on the website, no official revision exercise was conducted by the ECI.

Ali told *The Indian Express* he got to know about the discrepancies "by chance", after overhearing a conversation between a voter and a computer operator, and deciding to check his own family's records. "I alerted my neighbours and others in my booth and found more anomalies. So I informed Gangwar, who is a friend."

As per Gangwar, the Congress mobilised a team of 55, including volunteers, who checked entries booth by booth across the Pilibhit Assembly segment, covering 3.48 lakh voters, and zeroing in on 13,150 entries showing discrepancies. "We found that most of the changes were made late in the night or on holidays or Sundays," Gangwar claimed.

According to Gangwar as well as SP leaders, most of the voters whose details were "altered" were Muslims. As per Census 2011, roughly a quarter of the population in Pilibhit district is Muslim. The Opposition parties said that, at the time of elections, these voters could have been disqualified on grounds of mismatch.

Assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh are months away. In the 2022 Assembly polls, the BJP's Sanjay Singh Gangwar had won from Pilibhit seat by a narrow margin of less than 7,000 votes. The SP candidate was second placed. However, in 2024, the Pilibhit Lok Sabha seat was won comprehensively by the BJP, by a margin of over 1 lakh votes.

SP spokesperson Udaiveer Singh said the party feared discrepancies in voter lists were not confined to Pilibhit, and it would hold similar checks in around 100 Assembly constituencies across Uttar Pradesh.

Congress state president Aradhana Mishra said the party will issue a circular to all 75 District Congress Committees to "verify" electoral rolls in their areas.

BJP spokesperson Rakesh Tripathi said the party believed in "the accuracy of electoral rolls" and that all political parties had the responsibility to scrutinise voter lists during the revision process. "All parties should participate in the process rather than remain inactive and blame the ECI later," Tripathi said.

China putting pressure and Govt not treating us well: Wangchuk as talks with Centre stall

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, October 22

WITH THE Centre not inviting leaders from Ladakh for talks expected on Thursday, activist Sonam Wanchuk has accused the BJP government of "moving away" from its promises.

Wangchuk said he reached Delhi in anticipation of the talks but was informed that the talks are not being held. "On one hand China is building pressure. They don't even recognise Ladakh and (say) Ladakh is a part of China," Wangchuk said. "But the country we love is not treating us well. They are moving away from every promise to the extent that they are not giving the people of Ladakh the same status as the rest of the people."

Wangchuk, who was jailed for six months under the National Security Act (NSA), said, "...I would like to tell you that the talks on October 15 in Leh were a total failure. There was no result because the Centre moved away from its promises," he said in a video statement. "Then they said that they will hold the talks again on October 22 in Delhi. So I booked my tickets... but now it is being told that the talks are not being held." The talks between Home Ministry officials and the Ladakh leadership on October 15 failed to achieve a significant breakthrough even though the two sides had agreed on key points during a previous meeting on May 22.

In the May meeting, the Ladakh leadership scaled down its demands and accepted the Centre's offer of a special constitutional arrangement under Article 371(K) to safeguard their identity, land and jobs.



Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk addresses a press conference at Ladakh Bhawan in New Delhi on Thursday. ANI

However, on October 15, the Ladakh leadership accused the Centre of backtracking on its promises, saying the legislature proposed by the Centre is not empowered and holds powers similar to those of the Hill councils. While the Home Ministry presented a 32-page draft proposal, the Ladakh leadership rejected it. The Ladakh leadership said the Centre has agreed to another round of talks in Delhi on October 22 and hoped some progress would be made there.

Wangchuk hoped the Centre would hold the talks soon. "Otherwise, I am sad to say that they are moving away from every promise, whether it is the 6th Schedule – which was the first promise – or the assembly or the talks," he said.

"They are moving away from the promises, and the people in this border area are very sad."

As Daler row simmers, CM Dhami intervenes: 'Friends with singer, will speak to him'

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, October 22

UTTARAKHAND CHIEF Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami on Thursday said he would speak to singer Daler Mehndi and his brother Mika Singh over the controversy surrounding Cabinet Minister Subodh Uniyal's public confrontation with Mehndi during a performance at a tourism fair in Tehri district. Dhami also urged all sides to "put the matter to rest".

"Uttarakhand is a land that has always respected artistes, litterateurs and scholars. Perhaps there was some pressure from the public at that time. But now this matter should be put to rest," he said.

Defending Uniyal, Dhami said the minister had clarified that he did not intend to insult the singer and was unaware of his health condition. "When the minister himself has stated that he had no such intention, I think everyone should consider the matter closed here," he said.

Asked about Mika Singh's demand for action against Uniyal, Dhami said he would speak to both brothers.

"I will speak to Mika bhai. I will speak to Daler Mehndi ji as well. I am friends with both of them," he said.

The chief minister's remarks came a day after Mika Singh demanded an apology from Uniyal over the minister's allegation that his older brother had been performing under the influence of alcohol and the minister's subsequent reprimand of the singer in front of an audience. Mika also urged Dhami to look into the minister's conduct and take appropriate action.

In a post on X on Wednesday, Mika said Daler Mehndi did not consume alcohol and termed the allegation against him "completely wrong". The controversy erupted on Sunday evening during the annual Siddhpeeth Maa Kunjapuri Tourism and Development Fair in New Tehri, where Daler Mehndi was performing as part of the cultural programme organised during Navratri.

A video of the incident, which subsequently went viral on social media, showed Uniyal walking onto the stage and questioning the singer's ability to perform. The minister alleged that Mehndi was drunk and questioned whether he was singing live or lip-syncing to a pre-recorded soundtrack.

8 MLAs, one month: How a BJP ally in Meghalaya was reduced to just 1

Shinjini Ghosh
New Delhi, October 22

WITH THE regional Meghalaya party, United Democratic Party (UDP), being reduced to a single-MLA outfit from its position as the second largest party in the ruling National People's Party (NPP)-led coalition, its defector legislators said their switch to national parties like the BJP and the NPP would help them "deliver better" in their respective constituencies across the state, claiming that their priority was development.

Recently, the UDP, which had 12 MLAs in the Meghalaya Democratic Alliance (MDA) government, led by Chief Minister and NPP president Conrad Sangma, saw an exodus, with eight of them joining the BJP on September 23 and three UDP legislators submitting an application before Speaker Thomas A Sangma Monday seeking to merge with the NPP.

The Speaker has already approved the merger of the eight rebel UDP MLAs with the BJP, which is also a constituent of the MDA. The UDP leadership has expelled from the party the three MLAs aiming to join the NPP. *The Indian Express* reached out to the NPP for a comment but did not receive any response.

In the 60-member House, the MDA has 51 legislators, with the NPP accounting for 33 MLAs.

Kyrmen Shylla, Khliehriat MLA who joined the BJP, said that since the BJP is ruling the Centre it would help in addressing key issues of Meghalaya. "We have five major demands, including issues such as coal mining in the state and the Meghalaya Residents Safety and Security Act (MRSSA). A party like the BJP, which is currently in power at the Centre, can solve these issues. They have assured us that these demands will be addressed and hence we decided to join the BJP," Shylla told The Indian Express. "In the larger public interest it was necessary to merge with the BJP," he added.

These rebel MLAs have demanded the clearance for small-scale coal mining, which was banned in the state by the National Green Tribunal in 2014 over environmental concerns. They have also sought enactment of the amended MRSSA to tighten regulation of entry and settlement of outsiders in the state, which has been pending with the Centre.

"The BJP had been wanting to have a double-digit strength in the state Assembly for a long time. Now that the BJP has 10 legislators, it will not just benefit the party but the public in general. Ultimately people expect to see work done and if the BJP can fulfil it, then people will give the party more chances," Shylla said.

Another MLA, who defected to the BJP and did not want to be named, said, "There were severe leadership issues within the UDP. We trust the BJP and they have promised us that major development work will be carried out in the state."

Paul Lyngdoh, MLA from West Shillong, who is set to join the NPP, said while there were organisational issues within the UDP, the merger would help its MLAs deliver in their constituencies. "The effects will certainly be positive for Meghalaya. The state has suffered on many counts due to fractured mandates leading to instability and frequent change of guard. Now that we have consolidated, things will be much better," Lyngdoh claimed.

A former UDP MLA, who requested anonymity, said that differing views and ideologies have historically created a barrier for regional parties to deliver even though they were united on paper.

"As regional parties, we contested elections unitedly and tried our best, but we failed. Under the prevailing scenario, it becomes difficult to strengthen any regional party. Fortunately, we have parties like the NPP which also has an identity in Delhi. On the other hand, while BJP has the second highest number of MLAs now, it is to be seen whether the defector legislators resonate with their constituencies or not," the ex-MLA said.

Metbah Lyngdoh, the UDP chief who is also a Minister in the Conrad Sangma Cabinet, is now the sole MLA from his party. Despite repeated attempts, he could not be reached for a comment.

M Kharkrang, Meghalaya BJP spokesperson, said, "Whichever party it is, development of the state is of utmost priority. With the passage of time, they (rebel UDP MLAs) realised that hardly any results were being achieved and it became very difficult for them to bargain for the state. That is why they have chosen a party which is also ruling the Centre. They will be able to work better for the people."

The BJP's expansion in the Northeast has been remarkable in recent years, with a slew of leaders and legislators from regional and national parties switching to its fold in different states.

In 2016, Pema Khandu, Arunachal Pradesh CM, merged with the BJP along with his 32 MLAs from his then People's Party of Arunachal (PPA).

'Pattern of disregard for law': Ladakh on why it cancelled land allotted to Wangchuk's institute

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, October 22

THE LADAKH administration has defended the cancellation of land allotment to activist Sonam Wangchuk's institute, citing a "consistent and deliberate pattern of disregard for the law spanning two decades" and saying the allotment had automatically lapsed due to unpaid dues and an unexecuted lease deed.

In its response to a writ petition filed by Wangchuk in the High Court of J&K and Ladakh, the Deputy Commissioner, Leh, stated that the approval to lease land to the institute was conditional and that Wangchuk failed to meet the conditions, including the "payment of premium ground rent".

The petition pertains to the allotment of 1,076 kanals and 1 marla of land at Phyang Thang for a 40-year lease to Wangchuk's Himalayan Institute of Alternative Learning, Ladakh. Wangchuk approached the court challenging the August 2025 order cancelling the allotment. The administration told the court that the lease lapsed in May this year as the conditions had not been fulfilled within the first year of allotment. It also argued that the land "has not been used for the purpose" for which it was allotted and that there was "no proof" that any university had been started, another condition for executing the lease.

The Ladakh administration's response accused Wangchuk of occupying public land without paying for it; engaging in "false and provocative propaganda against the administration whenever called to account; threats to the elected Council and to officers; and the mobilisation of staff and students in agitation, including violent agitation."

The administration said this "pattern culminated in the events of September 2025", referring to the violence that broke out in Leh during an agitation in which Wangchuk was on hunger strike. It told the court that the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, had stated in its official statement on the same day that "the mob was incited by Shri Sonam Wangchuk through his provocative statements, who was misleading the people through provocative mention of Arab Spring-style protest and references to Gen Z protests in Nepal".

The "mob", the administration said, attacked a political party office and the office of the Chief Executive Councillor, Leh, "put these offices on fire, attacked the security personnel, and torched a police vehicle, with more than 30 police/CRPF personnel injured."

Breach of 1.5 degrees Celsius temperature threshold now 'unavoidable', says Emissions Gap Report

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, October 22

THE 1.5 degree Celsius temperature target is now completely out of reach and the best that the world can now hope for is to restrict the global rise in temperatures to 1.8 degrees Celsius and try to pull it back after that, a new UN report has said.

The Emissions Gap Report, published by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) every year ahead of the annual year-ending climate conference, has said that the breach of 1.5 degree Celsius target, set in the 2015 Paris Agreement, was now "unavoidable". The opportunity to hold the temperature rise within 1.5 degree Celsius from pre-industrial times, or allow only a limited 'overshoot', has been lost, it said.

"Decades of insufficient climate action makes exceedance of 1.5 degrees Celsius (temperature target) unavoidable," this year's edition of Emissions Gap Report, released on Wednesday, said.

"The task now, therefore, is not only to ensure that global warming stays well below 2 degrees Celsius, but to minimize the duration and magnitude of overshoot and establish a credible return path to 1.5 degrees Celsius by the end of the century," it said.

The conclusion is similar to the one arrived at by another UNEP report last month, which had said that even in the best-case scenarios now, global rise in temperature would reach at least 1.8 degrees Celsius. The main question now was to assess whether actions from the countries would be adequate to force the warming to return to 1.5-degree-Celsius level after rising to 1.8 degree Celsius sometime in the second half of this century, it had said.

These two have been the first authoritative climate reports to acknowledge the inevitability of the breach of the 1.5 degree Celsius temperature threshold. Until now, most reports and assessments, including those by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, have maintained that a narrow, though shrinking, window of opportunity to achieve the 1.5 degree Celsius target existed, if only countries stepped up their climate action.

However, far from countries making greater efforts, climate change has clearly fallen off the priority list of the international community in the last few years, particularly after Donald Trump's second innings as President of the United States began last year.

The Emissions Gap Report, in fact, noted that the United States, the world's second biggest emitter of greenhouse gases, saw its annual emissions increase by more than 133 million tonnes of CO2 equivalent in 2025, the largest for any country, as per preliminary data.

Emissions grew in China as well while at least one dataset showed that it had slowed down marginally in India, the world's third-largest emitter.

Globally, greenhouse gas emissions in 2025 remained around the same levels as in 2024, around 58.4 billion tonnes of CO2 equivalent. Some datasets showed that emissions in 2025 were about 0.1 billion tonnes of CO2 equivalent lower than in 2024, but the difference was way smaller than the error of margin in assessment.

"Due to the high aggregate uncertainty range and the provisional nature of emissions estimates for the prior year, it is not possible to conclude on the overall direction of emissions in 2025. Emissions have steadily grown over the past decade since 2016 (0.8 per cent per year) and in the period between 1990 and 2016 (1.7 per cent per year)," the report said.

Son of popular Ludhiana eatery owner shot dead in brawl at birthday party

Divya Goyal
Ludhiana, October 22

IN ANOTHER incident of gun violence in Punjab, the 34-year-old son of the owner of a popular Ludhiana eatery was allegedly shot dead following an argument at a birthday party late Wednesday night.

Rahul Sharma, the son of '*Pandit ji Kulche Chole*' owner Kuldeep Sharma, was attending a gathering on the terrace of a friend's house, said the police.

According to Alam Vijay Singh, DCP, the police were alerted during the intervening night of Wednesday and Thursday about a shooting.

"It was a crime of passion committed during an argument when 8-10 men got together to celebrate a birthday," said DCP Singh in a statement.

Friends rushed Rahul to Dayanand Medical College and Hospital (DMCH), where he succumbed to injuries during treatment. Sadar police station Inspector Jagdev Singh said that Rahul had two bullet wounds, according to the preliminary probe.

Based on a statement from Rahul's brother-in-law Piyush Sharma, the police registered a murder case against eight people, including key suspects Paramraj and Gagandeep. The police have formed four teams to trace and arrest the accused.

Rahul was actively involved in managing and expanding his family's long-standing street food business. '*Pandit ji Kulche Chole*' on Cemetery Road is a local favourite known for its onion-and-garlic-free recipe served with homemade chole and tangy tamarind chutney. The family migrated to Punjab from Himachal in the 1950s, starting small, with Kuldeep Sharma sitting under a tree with an iron container before opening a permanent shop nearby.

Rahul is survived by his parents, his wife, and a married sister. "The family is devastated now," said Sahi.

The killing comes amid concerns over deteriorating law and order in Punjab, with Opposition parties targeting the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) over a recent rise in fatal shootings. Rahul's death follows a string of similar targeted killings across the state in recent weeks, including anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota in Mansa, LGBTQ+ influencer Mad Sandhu in Amritsar, and former sarpanch Navtej Singh in Ludhiana.



MESSAGE



PIOTR ANTONI SWITALSKI

Dear Indian Friends,

It is my great honour to welcome Prime Minister Donald Tusk to India. His official visit, from 21 to 23 October at the invitation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, takes him to New Delhi and to Bengaluru – to the seat of India's political decision-making and to the heart of its innovation economy. That itinerary says a great deal about what Poland wants from this relationship.

Two years ago, Prime Minister Modi's visit to Warsaw – the first by an Indian Prime Minister in 45 years – raised our relations to the level of a Strategic Partnership and gave us an ambitious Action Plan for 2024–2028. Since then, we have been working to fill that framework with concrete substance. Prime Minister Tusk's visit sends a clear signal to companies, investors, universities and institutions on both sides: Polish–Indian cooperation has the green light.

The Poland that India meets today is not the Poland of the history textbooks. Since the fall of communism in 1989, we have achieved what economists call an economic miracle. Poland is now the sixth-largest economy in the European Union and the twentieth-largest in the world, with a GDP of around one trillion dollars. This transformation was driven by the very resource that powers India's rise: human capital – a workforce that is highly educated, hard-working and innovative.

Yet our economic ties remain far below their potential. Bilateral trade stands at around USD 5 billion. I would like to see that figure doubled – and with the India–EU Free Trade Agreement now concluded, the conditions have never been better. Prime Minister Tusk is accompanied by Minister of Finance and Economy Andrzej Domański and a delegation of nearly one hundred Polish companies, ready to do business in information technology, space, green energy and hydrogen, batteries and e-mobility, infrastructure, agri-food and mining. To Indian companies I say: use Poland. Consider it your friendly gateway to the European Union and its market of nearly half a billion consumers. On the Polish side, the sky is the limit.

Bengaluru is a fitting stop. Poland's space sector is young, ambitious and growing fast – and last year, a Polish and an Indian astronaut flew together to the International Space Station on the Axiom-4 mission. That shared journey is a good image of where our technological cooperation can go.

Security is now a cornerstone of our partnership. Geography has given Poland a frontline role in European security. We devote close to five per cent of our GDP to defence and field some of the strongest land forces in NATO. Several Polish systems have proven themselves in real operating conditions, including in India. But we are looking at India not only as a market – we see India as a partner. India is highly advanced in many areas of defence production and has the scale that Europe needs. Our ambition is to move from a buyer–seller relationship to joint ventures and co-production, in India and in Poland. Poland also stands firmly with India in the fight against terrorism.

Our partnership matters beyond the bilateral. The world has become unpredictable and turbulent, with many disruptive forces at play. India and Europe – and Poland in particular – can together build an axis of stability and predictability, and offer a good model for global governance. When I speak of Poland, I also speak of the European Union, which Poland strongly wants to see working ever more closely with India.

I am confident that this visit will turn strategic intent into tangible results – contracts signed, investments launched, and new partnerships between our people. Welcome to India, Prime Minister. And to our Indian friends: let us build this future together.

Piotr Antoni Switalski
Charge d' affaires a.i.

POLAND-INDIA TIES:
From Strategy to Action



At the invitation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Prime Minister of the Republic of Poland Donald Tusk is on an official visit to India, accompanied by Andrzej Domański, Minister of Finance and Economy, and a large business delegation. This is Tusk's second visit to India as Poland's Prime Minister, following his earlier visit in 2010. He also visited New Delhi in 2017 for the India-EU Summit in his capacity as President of the European Council.

The visit provides an opportunity to further strengthen the Poland-India Strategic Partnership and advance cooperation in key areas, including trade and investment, defence, emerging technologies, renewable energy, education and cultural exchanges. It also offers momentum for deepening the broader India-EU strategic partnership.

Poland is an important economic partner for India in Central Europe and serves as a gateway to Central and Eastern European markets. India, in turn, offers Polish businesses access to a large consumer market and a growing manufacturing base. Pharmaceuticals, information technology, engineering and renewable energy present promising avenues for collaboration. However, greater business engagement, improved market access and sustained investment will be essential to realise the full potential of bilateral economic ties.

Beyond trade, joint ventures and research partnerships in automotive technology, defence manufacturing, clean energy and digital services can add further depth to the relationship. Stronger links among businesses, research institutions and government agencies will be crucial to translating diplomatic commitments into practical outcomes and long-term commercial gains.

The partnership is also rooted in shared history and cultural ties. India's role in providing shelter to Polish refugees during the Second World War, particularly in Jamnagar and Kolhapur, remains an enduring symbol of friendship between the two countries. This legacy provides a strong foundation for strengthening educational, cultural and people-to-people exchanges.

As India and Poland build on their Strategic Partnership, the priority is to translate political goodwill into tangible economic opportunities, deeper industrial collaboration and sustained business engagement. Tusk's visit offers an opportunity to advance this agenda through stronger university partnerships and joint initiatives in satellite applications, green energy, mining equipment, artificial intelligence, cyber resilience and advanced manufacturing, laying the groundwork for long-term cooperation and mutual growth.



Mr. Apoorvshree Chaturvedi,
Director – Global Operations, UFlex Group

"The visit of H.E. Donald Tusk, Prime Minister of the Republic of Poland, offers an opportunity to deepen the economic engagement between India and Poland and explore new avenues of industrial cooperation.

For businesses operating across borders, strong bilateral ties create the conditions for investment, technological exchange, and long-term value creation. At UFlex, our manufacturing operations in Poland across packaging films and recycling reflect our belief in the importance of local capabilities, responsible resource use and resilient industrial partnerships.

As India and Poland look to expand their economic relationship, closer collaboration between businesses can help translate shared ambitions into tangible outcomes. We see considerable scope for both countries to build on their industrial strengths, encourage innovation, and advance a more resource-efficient future."



Rooted in shared values and a common opposition to colonialism, imperialism, and racism, India and Poland have maintained a warm and enduring friendship since establishing diplomatic relations in 1954. People-to-people exchanges continue to strengthen mutual understanding and cultural connections between the two countries.

During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Poland in August 2024, both leaders emphasized greater cooperation in culture, education, science, research, and healthcare. They encouraged academic partnerships, university exchanges, collaborative research, and parliamentary engagement to deepen institutional ties.

Tourism offers further opportunities to enhance bilateral engagement. Polish visitors are drawn to India's spiritual and cultural heritage, particularly yoga, Ayurveda, meditation, and wellness experiences. In contrast, Indian travel to Poland is significantly supported by corporate and professional engagement, especially in the IT and business outsourcing sectors, alongside growing opportunities for cultural and leisure tourism.

Expanded tourism promotion, cultural exchanges, and academic collaborations can generate economic opportunities while fostering closer connections between the peoples of both countries. As India and Poland advance their Strategic Partnership, strengthening these human connections will remain essential to sustaining their longstanding friendship and building a shared future.

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Masjid demolition: Gujarat HC summons Kutch Collector over 'supernormal haste'

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, October 22

TAKING EXCEPTION to the "supernormal haste" with which encroachment proceedings were concluded against Mohamadi Masjid in Kutch, the Gujarat HC Thursday directed the District Collector to remain personally present on October 30 and explain the corrective or punitive action proposed against the officials concerned.

Justice Niral R Mehta of the Gujarat HC dictated the order in open court after finding that the affidavit filed by the Kutch District Collector had "failed to explain" the authorities' haste in concluding encroachment proceedings and implementing the order preceding the demolition of Mohamadi Masjid on June 21.

The HC was hearing a petition filed by Mohamadi Masjid Jamat through its trustee and mutawalli, Sidhik Tejmal Sama, took note of the Collector's affidavit, observing it did not explain conduct of the authorities or dispute the speed with which the proceedings were concluded and the order implemented.

The court said, "The principal grievance raised before this court is with regard to the overzealous action on the part of the respondent authorities in contemplating to sit under Section 61 and implementing the order passed under Section 61 within a period of two days."

The court further said although the Collector had filed an affidavit, it had not explained the authorities' conduct or disputed the "supernormal haste" in concluding the proceedings under Section 61 of the Gujarat Land Revenue Code and implementing the order within two days.

The direction follows the court's October 13 order asking the Collector to file an affidavit by October 19, after the petitioner alleged the authorities had acted with undue haste.

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SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, TOHANA	CONSTRUCTION OF STREET FROM H/O JAIVIR TO KANAV, SHOP OF LAALI TO H/O RAKESH, H/O PALA TO SALEEM, H/O RINKU TO RAKESH, H/O HAWA TO H/O SAMEER WARD NO. 14 MC TOHANA + 24 WORKS	19.10.2026 26.10.2026	3,10,34,676/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996676131 mctohana1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 5042S/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

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1	UHBVN	EOI-497/EMP/P&D/2026-27	DATE OF CLOSING OF ONLINE E-TENDER FOR SUBMISSION OF TECHNO COMMERCIAL BID AND PRICE BID ON WEB PORTAL HAS BEEN EXTENDED UPTO 27.10.2026 AT 15.00 HRS. AND DATE OF OPENING PART-I OF PROPOSAL ON WEB PORTAL SHALL BE 28.10.2026 AT 15.00 HRS.	www.uhbvn.org.in	01722570431 cepdc@uhbvn.org.in

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Christians 'attacked, forced to perform Puja rituals': FIR filed

Incident in Paschim Medinipur district, community members say 'still in fear'

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, October 22

THREE CHRISTIAN families were allegedly assaulted, one of them was forced to take a purification bath in public, and all were made to perform a ritual at a Durga puja pandal in Paschim Medinipur district.

The incidents took place under the Chandrakona police limits on October 18, 19 and 20.

Although police personnel have been posted near their houses, the victims said they fear further attacks.

A case has been registered on several charges including attempt to murder, criminal intimidation, outraging a woman's modesty, and robbery, police sources said.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* over the phone, a 40-year-old woman among the victims said, "Around 3.30 pm on October 18, the miscreants came to my house, dragged me and my husband out, and beat us up. I fell to the ground. They tore my clothes. Then they made me eat Tulsi and Bel leaves and poured water on me as a purification ritual. Everyone watched while they poured water on me."

The woman and her husband, 50, make copper jewellery at home to earn a living.

The complainant alleged that the assailants also pressured her family members to abandon their faith.

More violence after victims call police

The assailants allegedly entered the houses of two other families later and beat up their members. They took away Rs 20,000 from the house and threatened them not to approach the police.

"However, we later dialled 100, and some police personnel came. They heard us verbally and left. On October 19, in the morning, the group returned, infuriated that we had called the police. They took us to a Durga mandap in a nearby village and made us offer anjali. Everyone was watching us. We came back and locked ourselves inside our houses. We dared not venture out," the woman added.

The complainant wrote that the Durga Puja pandal was a 10-minute walk away from her house. According to her, the assailants also attacked a minor girl of one of the two other Christian families in the neighbourhood.

The next day, on October 20, the menfolk of the three families were allegedly threatened.

"They picked my husband and men from the other families. When they returned home, they were crying. They were threatened. It was a horrific three days. We could not leave our houses out of fear. We sent three minor girls to our relative's house. Then I called up community members who asked me to call the police again. Finally, the police came and took us to a local hospital for treatment. Then we lodged a formal complaint," said the woman.

"Now there are four policemen posted outside our houses for security. We are happy the police helped us. But threat calls are coming. One day the police will leave. What will we do then? I just want to live at my house peacefully. I have a sick father-in-law and an elderly mother-in-law at home," said the woman.

No arrests yet

An advocate practising in the Calcutta High Court who helped the victims said the police had acted fast, adding that they registered an FIR after he visited the police station on October 20.

"However, the culprits are yet to be arrested and the families are in fear," he said.

Superintendent of Police Papiya Sultana told *The Indian Express* that the investigation in the case was underway.

"They were feeling insecure, so we reached their home. They were brought to the police station, and we have received their complaint. They wanted to go home but were feeling insecure. We have put up a police picket near their home. We are ensuring that nothing further happens to them," Sultana added.



CHORBAGAN PANDAL STAMPEDE

Committee member held for announcement that triggered panic

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, October 22

THE KOLKATA Police has arrested the treasurer of the Chorbagan Durga Puja Committee, whose announcement to evacuate the pandal reportedly triggered panic and led to the stampede, sources said.

According to police, Sanjeev Raha, alias Sentu, who had been absconding since the pandal stampede on October 17, was picked up from Nadia district Thursday after investigators tracked a series of burner numbers he used to contact family and friends. He was brought to Lalbazar for interrogation, and later arrested.

According to police sources and CCTV footage, the situation spiraled into a stampede after a voice over the microphone announced, "The pandal is collapsing", and urged visitors to evacuate immediately. Eyewitnesses claim this announcement triggered widespread panic instead of an orderly dispersal.

Police sources said they will be interrogating Sentu to determine why he made the announcement over the microphone and whether he was acting on orders from others. Meanwhile, police are still searching for a second suspect, a neighbour who works as an app-cab driver and has been missing since the incident.

RSS-affiliated group to protest Starlink over security concerns

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, October 22

DAYS AFTER urging the government to block Elon Musk's Starlink from launching commercial satellite broadband in India, RSS-affiliated Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM) has decided to take its campaign to the streets. The organisation has announced a protest march in New Delhi on Friday.

The march, to be held under the banner of "national security and digital sovereignty", will begin at Teen Murti Chowk in Chanakyapuri at 11 am. "The protest aims to raise public awareness and express concerns regarding national security, data sovereignty, dependence on foreign digital infrastructure, and the potential implications for India's indigenous telecommunications and technology sectors."

"Say No to Starlink", "Defend Our Data, Defend Our Sovereignty, Support Swadeshi" and "India Needs Swadeshi Solutions, Not Foreign Controls!" are the slogans seen on a poster issued by the organisation for the protest. Describing Starlink as a "security threat", it features Musk prominently alongside a satellite orbiting the Earth and a Starlink terminal crossed out with a red prohibition sign.

The organisation said the demonstration would also advocate "digital self-reliance", protection of national interests and promotion of indigenous technological solutions.

The protest marks an escalation of a campaign the SJM launched earlier this month. On October 13, the group urged the Centre to deny Starlink permission to roll out commercial satellite broadband services.

It argued that Starlink's satellite architecture could make it harder for India to impose geographically targeted Internet restrictions and undertake lawful interception.

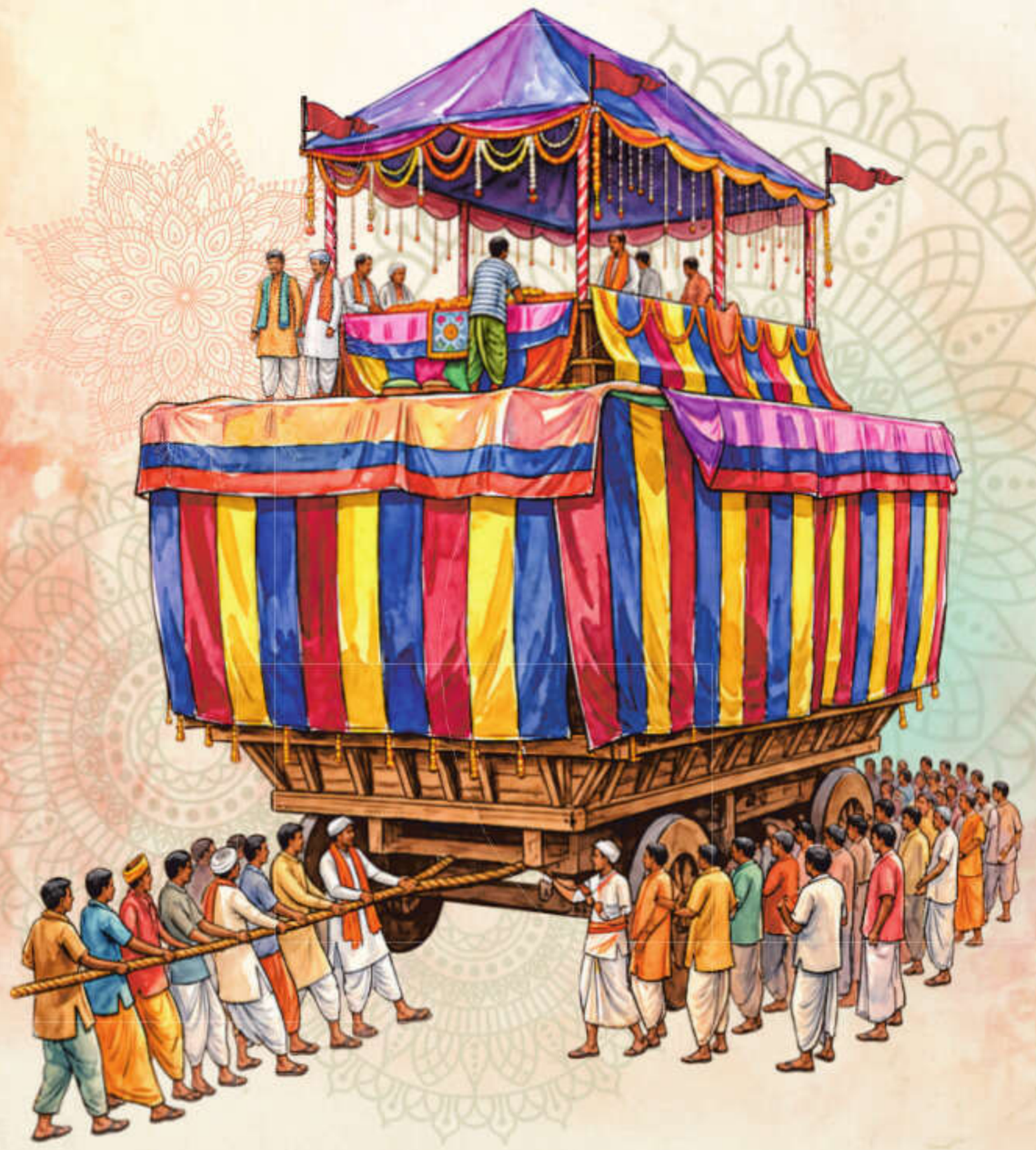
It noted that authorities sometimes need to disrupt internet services during separatism, terrorism, riots and protests. It also claimed Starlink's satellites, which communicate through laser links, could make it difficult to ensure that India's internet traffic passes through domestic gateways.

The campaign comes amid a public dispute between Musk and Reliance Industries chairman Mukesh Ambani over Starlink's delayed commercial launch in India.

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Corrigendum No 1	Corrigendum Publish Date 22.10.2026
Name of Work and its location	Tender for "Stripping, supply, Installation, testing & commissioning of complete cable harness in LHB AC coaches during MLR at RCNK/SNP"
Approx. Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 3,68,47,964.55/- including GST (Rs. Three Crores Sixty Eight Lakh Forty Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Sixty Four and Fifty Five Paisa Only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 7,37,000.00 /-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post	NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs on 12.11.2026
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BECAUSE THE TRUTH
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Foreign hand bogey is wearing thin. Bury it

IN AUGUST, Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat visited America as part of a three-nation tour in the RSS's centenary year. He spoke of India's "destiny", "duty" and "diversity". His articulation and nuancing of the RSS worldview abroad was also part of a longer formal and informal process of engaging global audiences. In October, delivering his annual Dussehra speech from Nagpur, however, Bhagwat spoke darkly of a "western storm" and global conspiracy that seeks to destabilise regimes, suggesting that India is its target, alongside France and Albania, Bangladesh and Nepal. The dissonance between the spirit of outreach in New York and the loose spectre-mongering in Nagpur is striking. Evidently, it has to do with the fact that students' protests, which had wound up in July, have begun again, this time on the issue of the Chief Election Commissioner's conduct of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. And ever since the 1970s, when Indira Gandhi infamously peddled the "foreign hand" theory to delegitimise the mounting unrest against her government, this theory has been recycled by ruling elites faced with Opposition agitation and people's resentments. It is disturbing that the RSS chief — and members of the BJP and NDA government — should be resorting to a jaded political alibi. It denies agency to protestors and disrespects their legitimate concerns. It delays an honest reckoning by the government with its own blind spots and abdications.

A kind of political and intellectual bankruptcy lies behind the attempt to blame domestic turmoil on secret plots hatched abroad and malevolent external forces. In fact, dots can be connected between the protests in India and other countries — a lesson, not a conspiracy, can be drawn. A sharp disconnect seems to be rising to the surface, across countries, between the politics-as-usual of complacent leaderships and the people, especially the young, whose frustrations are being amplified by social media. Political institutions, legislatures and parties need to rethink their roles and open their doors, instead of retreating behind denial and self-serving stories.

Of course, all nations, including India, operate in an environment rife with global pressures, foreign interests and constraints. But that must not make any country lose sight of the fundamental fact that the principal reasons why people feel anxious and alienated are hiding in plain sight at home — from economic mismanagement to rising corruption, from the closing of channels of communication to the clampdown on forums of accountability. As the Narendra Modi government falls back on the "foreign hand" in a bid to put down the young protestors on the streets, it also goes against the grain of its own successes in engaging a changing world and navigating global currents. It should resist the seductions of glib narratives that link tariffs with Jantar Mantar, and both with Dhaka, Kathmandu and Paris.

On climate, a long road back to Paris

THE WRITING has been on the wall for at least three years: The Paris Pact's goal of keeping global temperature rise down to 1.5°C above industrial levels will be unattainable in the near term. The United Nations Environment Programme's (UNEP) "Emissions Gap Report 2026", released on Wednesday, underlines this. It sets out what it would take to return to the Paris threshold by the end of the century. Under a scenario designed to achieve the lowest possible overshoot, global warming would peak at 1.7-1.8°C around 2050 before returning to 1.5°C in the next half a decade. This pathway requires global GHG emissions to fall by 18 per cent by 2030, 45 per cent by 2035 and 69 per cent by 2040, relative to 2025 levels.

The scale of the challenge becomes clear when the projected reductions are measured against the climate action plans countries submitted under the Paris Agreement. The full implementation of these would reduce global emissions by only 5-8 per cent by 2030 and 11-15 per cent by 2035, relative to 2025 levels — well short of the reductions suggested by UNEP. The report mentions futuristic technologies like carbon storage. But the jury is out on their costs. The Emissions Report's renewable energy targets, too, are demanding, but solar and wind power growth in the past decade offer reasons for optimism. Installations have increased 2.5 times since the Paris Agreement. According to UNEP, they will need to surge by three times above 2025 levels in the next 10 years. Technological progress and falling costs can support such a transition. The more difficult task will be to shield the market from geopolitics, especially to ensure clean energy can be stored.

Climate-related damage cannot be ruled out, at least in the immediate future. The question, then, is how to compensate the most vulnerable. The shortcomings of the Loss and Damage Fund, formalised three years ago, were evident in its failure to aid Nepal after floods in August. When climate delegates meet at the next CoP in about two weeks, they will need to summon greater resolve than in the past to get the Paris Pact back on track.

When AI vies for literary glory

IN 2023, a year after the launch of ChatGPT, the Authors Guild in the US, including writers such as John Grisham and George RR Martin, sued OpenAI, alleging that their copyrighted books had been used without permission to train its artificial intelligence models. Three years on, the literary establishment finds itself confronting a different stage of the same upheaval: Whether literature written with AI's assistance should be formally recognised and rewarded. France's new Prix Pascal de Littérature IA, an award for books co-written with artificial intelligence, suggests that the answer, for some, is to accept the inevitable and bring it into the open. But what becomes of the human process, then, that gives art its meaning?

Recent controversies make that question more urgent. The 2026 Commonwealth Short Story Prize was caught in a storm over charges of AI use in its winning entries. Thélyson Orélien's novel was removed from the Prix Goncourt longlist — France's highest literary award — amid similar allegations.

What is it, then, that a literary prize rewards? Is it the facility of a well-crafted sentence or the instant gratification of a neat turn of phrase? The point of literature, after all, is not merely to dazzle a reader with craftsmanship. It is work that is both interior and exterior — the rigour that follows inspiration, the daily drudgery of putting pen to paper, the frantic search for words that can capture the fullness of one's experience. A machine may be taught to (re)produce the end product, if literature could even be classified as one. But, as Samuel Beckett wrote in *Murphy* (1938), "The sun shone, having no alternative, on the nothing new."

Fossil fuel in the farm, and food as fuel — a double bind



HARISH DAMODARAN

WAR AND weather are exposing Indian agriculture's vulnerabilities from two fronts — "fossilisation" of farming and "fuelisation" of food.

In 1950-51, the country had hardly 8,500 tractors and its chemical fertiliser consumption was 69,800 tonnes in terms of nitrogen (N), phosphorous (P) and potassium (K). The only fertiliser products were ammonium sulphate (with 20.6 per cent N and 23 per cent sulphur or S content) and single super phosphate (SSP: 16 per cent P and 11 per cent S).

That was a time when farmers overwhelmingly used bullocks for ploughing their fields, treading over harvested crops to separate grain from straw, pulling carts to transport produce, and powering the *rahat* or Persian wheel to lift water from wells for irrigation. Plant nutrients, too, were predominantly supplied by cattle as decomposed farmyard manure with an average 0.5 per cent N, 0.2 per cent P and 0.5 per cent K.

Contrast with the present, where India's tractor population has crossed 1.2 crore and a whopping 11.6 lakh units sold just in 2025-26 (April-March). These have rendered bullocks redundant in field operations and haulage. Harvesting and threshing is increasingly done by combines, while the *rahat* has given way to electric motor and diesel engine-driven pumps.

The same holds for fertiliser consumption, which reached 33.5 million tonnes of N, P and K in 2025-26. Roughly 67.5 per cent of that came from two fertilisers: Urea (containing 46 per cent N) and di-ammonium phosphate (DAP: 46 per cent P).

Fossilisation, moreover, isn't confined to tractors and nutrients. The building blocks for manufacturing most of the active ingredients in crop protection chemicals — insecticides, herbicides and fungicides — are benzene, toluene, xylene, ethylene and propylene, which are, in turn, derived from naphtha. The solvents, emulsifiers and surfactants, which dissolve, blend and stabilise these ingredients to create uniform sprayable formulations, are also largely petroleum-based.

The West Asia and Black Sea region conflicts have pushed up the prices of liquefied natural gas — the primary feedstock for urea and other N-containing fertilisers — delivered ex-ship to Northeast Asian markets from around $11 to $30 per million British thermal units, and that of Northwest European naphtha cargoes from $515-520 to $910-915 per tonne, over the past year.

Equally significant is sulphur. No production of DAP, SSP or any other fertiliser with P is possible without this byproduct of oil refining and natural gas processing.

Till 2021 or so, sulphur was imported into India at below $300 per tonne — even sub-$100 in 2019 and 2020. Landed prices rose to $400-500 per tonne during March-June 2022 after Russia's invasion of Ukraine. As Ukraine has stepped up drone and missile strikes on Russian refineries and gas complexes, and Iran targeted the energy infrastructure of its Persian Gulf neighbours, prices of the once-throwaway product have soared to $1,000-1,100 levels.

The risks from agriculture's heavy reliance on hydrocarbons wouldn't have been evident when India embarked on the Green Revolution in the mid-sixties. The iconic 'Mere Desh Ki Dharti' song from Manoj Kumar's 1967 blockbuster *Upkar*, indeed, had lines extolling traditional farming: *Bailon ke gale mein jab ghungroo jeevan ka raag sunate hain… Sunke rahat ki aawazen yun lage kahin shehnai baje* (when the bells hung around the bullock's neck sing the song of life; the sound of the *rahat* seems like that from the *shehnai*).

> The West Asia and Russia-Ukraine conflicts, together with El Niño, are testing the limits of both fossilisation of farming systems and the growing fuelisation of food

But it isn't fossilisation alone. What we are also witnessing in parallel is the fuelisation of food. The longer Brent crude prices stay at $100-plus per barrel, the more the incentive for diverting food crops towards biofuel production. This is reverse fossilisation, wherein agriculture becomes more a source than a consumer of fuel.

In India, we have ethanol produced from sugarcane, rice, maize and other starchy cereal grains being blended up to 20 per cent in petrol. Vegetable oils are, likewise, amenable for conversion into fatty acid methyl esters (FAME), which can be blended with regular petroleum diesel. Indonesia has, from July, made it mandatory for all diesel sold nationwide to contain 50 per cent palm oil-derived FAME.

If the ongoing wars are laying bare the vulnerabilities from fossilisation, the limits to the fuelisation of food could be tested by a prospective "very strong" El Niño. When the two supply shocks combine, it's agriculture that bears the brunt. The last time India experienced such a twin shock was in 1979-80, when the farm sector contracted by 12.8 per cent and its oil import bill doubled on the back of Iran's Islamic Revolution.

Indian agriculture is, of course, far more diversified now than in 1979-80, with a growing share of farm incomes coming from dairying, poultry, aquaculture and horticulture, as against normal field crops. Also, about 56 per cent of its gross cropped area is under irrigation, whereas that ratio was 29 per cent in 1979-80 and 17.1 per cent in 1950-51. The twin shocks from wars and El Niño are unlikely, then, to cause sharp farm output declines of the kind seen in the past.

That said, policymakers would do well to learn lessons from the still unfolding energy-cum-climate shocks. The implications for agriculture cannot be ignored when India is an importer of oil and gas, fertiliser raw materials (ammonia, rock phosphate, sulphur and muriate of potash) and technical-grade active ingredients and intermediates in crop protection chemicals.

There is scope firstly to reduce the consumption of urea and DAP, especially given their low nutrient use efficiency. Only a third of the 46 per cent N in urea is absorbed by crops; the rest escapes into the air as ammonia gas or leaches underground after conversion into nitrate. Even with the 46 per cent P applied through DAP, three-fourths of it simply gets "locked up" in the soil and is unavailable to the plant roots during the growing season.

The focus must be on gradually replacing urea and DAP with ammonium sulphate and complex fertilisers having more balanced nutrient composition with lower N volatilisation/leaching losses and P lock-up. Nutrient uptake and absorption can be further enhanced by biostimulants that expand the root surface areas and modify the metabolic pathways of plants. A similar approach — to trigger the internal defence and adaptation mechanisms of plants (think vaccines) — can bring down chemical pesticide application. Irrigation, too, should progressively move to solar-powered pumps and drip systems.

As for fuelisation, the Modi government has already banned the use of sugarcane juice and B-heavy molasses for making ethanol. As El Niño bites, the turn of grains may also not be far.

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Smash patriarchy in India, turn a blind eye to it in Bangladesh



SHAZIA ILMI

THERE IS something wonderfully convenient about being a revolutionary in India. You can denounce the government, ridicule the Prime Minister, question institutions, organise protests and announce the imminent collapse of democracy, all while enjoying the constitutional freedoms that make such performances possible. Neha Bora seems to have discovered this delightful arrangement. Her enthusiasm for Bangladesh's Gen Z revolution is particularly touching. She appears captivated by the romance of young people overthrowing a government. What seems to have escaped her attention is what happened afterwards.

The student-led uprising that forced Sheikh Hasina from power in August 2024 emerged from grievances over what was perceived as political repression and a deeply resented quota system. But removing a government is one thing. Understanding what replaces it requires considerably more effort.

The National Citizen Party (NCP) — comprising the Bangladesh Gen Z that Bora is so admiring of — discovered that commanding the streets was easier than commanding the ballot box. Ahead of the February 2026 elections, it entered an electoral alliance with Jamaat-e-Islami, the Islamist party whose leadership has defended religiously prescribed distinctions between men and women, opposed equal inheritance rights and explicitly ruled out a woman occupying its highest leadership position. Jamaat chief Shafiqur Rahman made it clear that a woman could not become the party's supreme leader. His explanations of women's roles have invoked childbirth, motherhood and breastfeeding.

Would Bora accept being told that motherhood disqualifies her from leading a political organisation? Or does feminism become negotiable when the revolution happens to be fashionable?

In 2011, young Egyptians filled Cairo's Tahrir Square demanding freedom and democracy. Hosni Mubarak fell, but the Muslim Brotherhood subsequently came to power through elections. Its Islamist political agenda provoked fierce disputes over women's rights, civil liberties and religious authority. The revolutionaries supplied the crowds. The Brotherhood collected the electoral dividends. Bangladesh raises a similar concern. What happens when a movement promising freedom helps empower religious fundamentalists whose ideology places restrictions on women's autonomy?

> Neha Bora can celebrate Bangladesh's youth uprising. But its alliance with Jamaat-e-Islami raises an uncomfortable question: What happens to women's rights when revolution empowers religious conservatism?

Rahul Gandhi seems quite happy to let Bora call the shots. A woman leader from AISA, who is exercising considerable influence over the leadership of the Congress party — whose political vocabulary has included the stirring slogan "Smash the Patriarchy" — now appears enamoured of a youth revolution whose political offspring have joined hands with a party that will not permit a woman to lead it.

Good for her. Women should exercise political authority without apology. But surely there is something absurd about celebrating a political movement whose allies would deny women precisely the authority she enjoys. Smash the patriarchy in India, make allowances for it in Bangladesh?

Bora enjoys the freedom to lead, challenge authority and influence national politics. Surely the Muslim girls of Bangladesh deserve the same freedom to aspire, question and lead. Or are their ambitions to be sacrificed at the altar of revolutionary solidarity? France has witnessed fierce debates over this phenomenon, often described as Islamo-leftism. In such an alliance, the Marxists provide revolutionary rhetoric, the Islamists bring their religious agenda, and women's rights become an inconvenient detail. For liberal and moderate Muslims, particularly women, religious fundamentalism is not liberation. It is precisely what they have every reason to fear.

The problem is not admiration for Bangladesh's young protesters. Their grievances were real. The problem is confusing the spectacle of revolution with the substance of democracy. Gen Z is a generation, not a political philosophy. Young people can be liberal, conservative, secular, religious or authoritarian. Viral slogans are not constitutional safeguards and youthful enthusiasm is no substitute for political understanding. Bora is entitled to admire Bangladesh's Gen Z. But perhaps she should ask one simple question: Would Jamaat-e-Islami ever allow a woman like her to lead it? Its leadership has already supplied the answer. Perhaps the next revolution should begin with reading. Especially the part about women.

The writer is national spokesperson, BJP

For migrant children, access to school is not enough



KULDEEPSINGH RAJPUT

AS THE Kharif harvest comes to an end, seasonal migration begins across many parts of India. But this year, drought is adding a new dimension, with seasonal migrants increasingly becoming "climate migrants". Intense drought, drying fields and shrinking livelihood opportunities are likely to push more families towards sugarcane fields, brick kilns, construction sites and other worksites in search of livelihoods. The most overlooked victims of such migration are often children. Forced to migrate with their parents, they face interrupted schooling, learning loss, and the risk of prolonged educational exclusion. According to the last Census, India had 9.29 crore migrant children. At present, there is no reliable estimate of how many are out of school. The recent NITI Aayog report, 'School Education System in India: Temporal Analysis and Policy Roadmap for Quality Enhancement', highlights the educational exclusion of migrant children. Schooling disruptions, often lasting five to six months, widen learning gaps, weaken social ties, and undermine school belonging. These increase the risk of irregular attendance and dropout. Many children begin assisting their parents at work and slip into child labour.

The Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan, launched in 2001, marked a systematic effort to address barriers to school access among migrant children. Alongside expanding educational infrastructure in remote and underserved areas, it promoted context-specific alternative education models to ensure continuity, including seasonal hostels, residential schools, *basti shala*s, *sakhar shala*s (sugarcane schools), tent schools (construction-site schools), and transit education centres. Both the Right to Education Act (2009) and the National Education Policy (2020) have recognised the educational exclusion of migrant children and underscored the importance of inclusive education. Recently, NITI Aayog has recommended measures such as migration-responsive schooling, bridge learning centres, portable school records, inter-state transfer mechanisms, and tracking systems. Despite this, in practice, the primary focus has remained on access and enrolment.

Access and enrolment are only the first steps. The challenge lies in ensuring meaningful learning, remedial teaching, academic and mental-health support, emotional well-being, care, and equitable educational strategies. While providing education at worksites is a significant intervention, there is an equally urgent need to implement equitable and context-responsive alternative education models that address the distinct learning needs of migrant children. This is precisely what the NEP 2020 advocates.

> The challenge lies in ensuring meaningful learning, remedial teaching, academic and mental-health support, emotional well-being, care, and equitable educational strategies

The question is whether teachers have the pedagogical competencies and sociological perspectives to critically interrogate the sociocultural and structural inequalities reproduced in classrooms. Most teacher-education programmes are structured around the assumptions of sedentary formal schooling; migration-responsive education must be urgently integrated.

The true measure of an inclusive education system lies not merely in whether migrant children enter classrooms, but in whether they can learn, participate, and progress without their mobility determining their educational futures.

The writer leads Rubal Foundation, a non-profit working with migrants and informal workers

40 YEARS AGO
October 23, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
Arun Nehru, Gadgil among five dropped
Arjun Singh, Bhajan Lal, Vengal Rao inducted
N. D. Tiwari given External Affairs, Panja I & B
Four new ministers of state

Major cabinet reshuffle

IN A major reshuffle, Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi inducted Arjun Singh into the cabinet and dropped Arun Nehru. While Singh gets the Communications portfolio, J Vengal Rao has been given Industry. N D Tiwari is the Minister for External Affairs. Shiv Shanker now retains only Commerce.

'Heavyweights' inducted

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi said he had inducted some "heavyweights" into his Council of Ministers to give added dynamism to the government. Asked about the re-induction of Arjun Singh, the PM remarked, "We require experienced and able people."

Tripathi on Arjun Singh

CONGRESS (I) working president Kamlapati Tripathi welcomed Arjun Singh's removal from the party post of vice-president. Asked for his comment on Singh's induction into the Council of Ministers, Tripathi said, " He is now the right person in the right place."

Tit-for-tat expulsions

IN RETALIATION for the expulsion of 55 Soviet diplomats and employees from the US, the Soviet Union decided to expel 160 US diplomats and employees. This is to keep parity with the strength of Soviet diplomatic employees in the US. The present strength of the US staff in Moscow and Leningrad is 460 whereas there are 300 Soviet embassy employees in Washington and San Francisco.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

France's riots expose the impotence of its political class.
—Financial Times

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DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

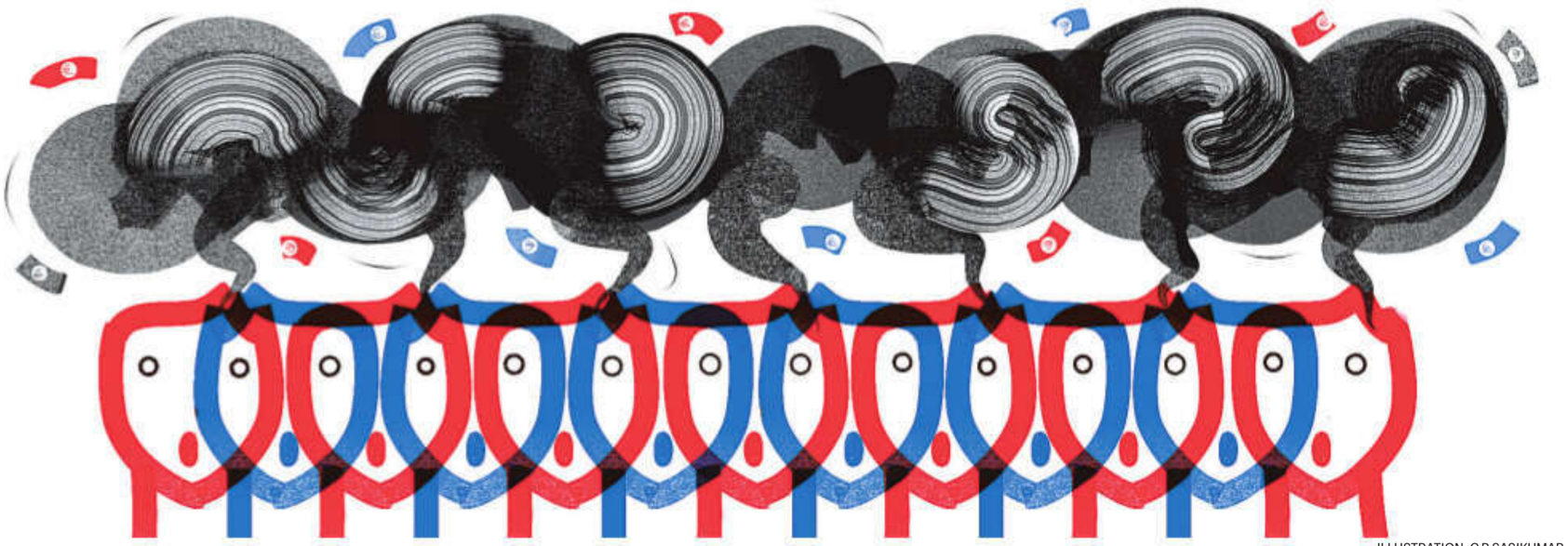


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Unrest in France, protests in Belgium, Spain, Italy and Albania — does a common thread run through them?

A post-War promise belied across Europe



DAVID LEES

IN THE past two weeks, Europe has witnessed demonstrations and riots in several countries. What began as an earnest protest against the poor quality of some suburban French state schools has now become a pan-European movement. Protests in Spain over high rental costs pushed the country's prime minister, Pedro Sánchez, into calling an early general election, while in Belgium, demonstrators complained about the poor educational outcomes emerging from the nation's Francophone education system. Violent protests have also taken place in Albania, challenging its potential entry to the EU.

On the surface, these apparently disparate movements have little in common. Yet look a little deeper, and there are a number of common threads beyond the obviously violent nature of some of these protests. But first, we have to look at France.

There is no such thing as a "European dream" to rival the notion, inherent in the American dream, that any individual can progress to a better life through education and hard work. Yet there has been, since World War II, an expectation in some liberal democratic countries that each generation would improve on the chances of the previous one. In France, this was best captured in the post-War period through the financial boom of the *Trente Glorieuses*, the 30 so-called "glorious years", in which the US-funded Marshall Plan led to a newfound economic optimism. The baby boom necessarily required changes to the education system, which were gradually introduced once Charles de Gaulle returned to power in the new Fifth Republic.

The events of May and June 1968, pivotal in the history of protest in modern France and used as a template for the current protestors, accelerated education reform, including the need for better facilities at high schools and in state universities. But as the 30 glorious years drew to a close, coinciding with the 1973 oil crisis, the prospects of young people in France became far less bright. Ever since, it has been much harder for aspirational youth to obtain a high-quality job. No president of the Fifth Republic has been able to make any meaningful changes to improve youth unemployment.

Given that the French economy declined considerably as the oil crisis hit, subsequent governments struggled to pump in sufficient funds to better the education system. This has led to dissatisfaction with the condition of school buildings, an absence of cover teachers during teacher absence, and poor educational outcomes — issues at the heart of these protests. With French public debt reaching over 115 per cent of GDP and a deficit of 5.1 per cent in 2025, Emmanuel Macron faces an uphill struggle to address any of these very legitimate concerns. It seems unlikely that the cost of living is likely to reduce any time soon in France, despite Macron's visit to the Gulf to try to obtain cheaper oil.

The cost of living is not solely a French concern. The rental costs in Spain provoked the demonstrations in that country, with the spark coming from an elderly lady — María Abascal — being forced to leave her apartment in the face of an unaffordable increase in rent. The scale of these protests, and the lack of capacity of the Socialist government to push through legislation to address rental laws, has led to a snap parliamentary election. Spain, led by Sánchez, has been vocal in its criticism of Donald Trump's war in Iran, the catalyst for the staggering increase in the cost of oil. Inevitably, other goods have also increased in cost, making it challenging for many to go shopping for everyday essentials.

Other eurozone countries have not been immune to protests over economic concerns. Belgium and Italy have both seen demonstrations. In Belgium, as in France and Spain, youth unemployment is high and there is concern over educational standards in the Francophone stream of the education system. There is very little room for manoeuvre for these governments. Their link to the eurozone means that they have little capacity to ease the cost of living. Inevitably, tax rises will be necessary to fund essential public services. None of the eurozone economies can instruct a central bank to begin buying up government bonds to ease pressure from the markets.

The post-War consensus appears to have frayed. The likes of Macron and Sánchez, especially, are challenged by the political extremes. As protests grow violent, the far-right looks to assert its authority on law and order, a move Marine Le Pen in France has already made. The extreme left places itself on the side of the protestors, urging greater public spending and taxes on the rich. The centrists appear to have very few answers. As we head towards pivotal elections in Spain and France, the future of moderate political parties appears in doubt.

The writer teaches contemporary French history, culture and politics at the University of Warwick

Each discontent has own roots, trajectory



GULSHAN SACHDEVA

ALTHOUGH DRAMATIC images of violent protests in France have dominated the headlines, protests are also sweeping across major European cities in Spain, Italy, Portugal, Belgium and even Albania. Most of these protests began with specific demands from younger generations, such as dissatisfaction with school conditions in France. They soon drew in other sections of society, particularly trade unions and those affected by related issues, including the cost-of-living crisis.

With major elections approaching in France, Italy and Spain, domestic political dynamics have further complicated the situation, as political parties seek to capitalise on public discontent to advance their electoral agendas.

Broadly, protests are attributed to sluggish economic growth, declining competitiveness and the perceived failure of multiculturalism across Europe. As members of the eurozone, these countries must also operate within the EU's fiscal framework, which sets limits on budget deficits and public debt. This constrains their fiscal space, limiting the scope for increased public spending on essential services, including education. Younger generations feel less secure about their future than earlier generations who benefited from more generous welfare systems.

For years, right-wing parties have channelled public anger towards outsiders and gained electorally, while the radical left is also gaining ground in some countries as centrist parties are seen as failing to deliver. The problem, therefore, cannot be attributed simply to misguided policies of either the left or the right.

These countries are governed by coalitions spanning very different ideological positions: From France's liberal-centrist government and Italy's right-wing parties to Spain's left-wing coalition, a mixed coalition in Portugal and Belgium's centre-right government.

In France, street protests are embedded in its political culture. From the French Revolution and 19th-century insurrections to the student-led occupations of Paris in 1968, demonstrations against policy rollbacks in the 1980s and 1990s, the 2005 suburban riots and the Yellow Vest movement of 2018-2020, la rue has long served as a means of challenging state authority. Linking the current unrest primarily to migration would therefore be an oversimplification. The political climate is also increasingly polarised, with two veteran figures, far-right leader Marine Le Pen and far-left leader Jean-Luc Mélenchon, potentially emerging as leading contenders in France's next presidential election.

In countries such as Italy, Spain and Portugal, the housing crisis has been a major concern for years. The influx of tourists has fuelled anti-tourism protests in several cities in the past, as short-term rentals through platforms such as Airbnb have reduced the availability of affordable housing in city centres. The surge in energy prices following the war in Ukraine has further intensified the cost-of-living crisis. Together, they have become serious concerns for young people and low-paid workers across southern Europe.

Spain's left-wing government sought to cap rents, restrict evictions of vulnerable groups and curb investment by corporate funds through new legislation. However, right-wing and regional opposition parties blocked the minority government's emergency housing decrees in Congress. Amid the impasse, PM Pedro Sánchez called a snap national election, placing housing affordability and the right to housing, particularly for younger generations, at the centre of the country's political battle.

Inspired by the French protests, students in many Italian cities took part in large-scale "No Meloni Day" demonstrations. Universities, seeking to strengthen their finances, are increasingly recruiting international students, raising concerns among local students about mounting pressure on campus infrastructure. These protests are also unfolding amid a major shift in European defence policy. Under the EU's ReArm Europe/Readiness 2030 initiative, substantial resources are being mobilised to strengthen Europe's defence capabilities, with plans to facilitate up to €800 billion in defence spending. Students are protesting against proposed cuts to education funding and questioning the priority given to rising defence expenditure over public services.

Protests in Albania, one of Europe's lower-income countries, reflect a different set of grievances. Demonstrators have taken to the streets as part of the so-called "Flamingo Revolution", driven by anger over alleged government corruption, economic hardship and a controversial luxury tourism project on the southern coast linked to Jared Kushner, Donald Trump's son-in-law.

Overall, Europe's protests reflect a shared crisis, but not a single cause. Understanding them requires looking beyond continent-wide structural weaknesses to the distinct realities shaping discontent in each country.

The writer is professor and Jean Monnet Chair at the Centre for European Studies, JNU

ECI's course correction is welcome, need for accountability remains



ASHOK LAVASA

I REMEMBER the first protest I witnessed. An instrument had been stolen from the Chemistry laboratory in school but no student admitted to doing it. The principal pleaded in the school assembly for the guilty to come forward but to no avail. He then announced that he would fast until the culprit confessed.

Within five hours of the protest, the culprit came forward. In the assembly the next day, the principal described the student as the "hero of our school" because he had the "courage to admit his mistake". The principal's protest turned culpability into courage, making a hero of a man who pleaded guilty. Could a similar fate await the Election Commission of India (ECI) or the Election Commissioners (ECs)?

In the past few days, the ECI has made some hasty decisions that amount to admitting to its mistakes and atoning for wrongs caused by previous decisions. Is this a "change of heart" by an institution/individuals accused of heartless disenfranchisement? Is this a trail of corrective measures meant to cover its tracks and blunt the unprecedented outrage it invited?

Almost immediately after *The Indian Express* investigation on September 23 ('14 times in 10 months, two Election Commissioners objected on record to poll panel steps'), with the initial bland denials cutting no ice, the ECI went about rolling back some of its controversial decisions.



ILLUSTRATION: VIKAS AGARWAL

The changes to Form 6, characterised by one of the ECs as "illegal and unauthorised", were admitted and dropped for non-Special Intensive Revision (SIR) states. Booth level officers (BLOs) were asked to visit the homes of those notified for logical discrepancy. Technical experts were engaged to confirm if ECINet was compliant with applicable laws. Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) were directed to organise camps in the states where SIR was completed to ensure that those deleted earlier were readmitted subject to their eligibility, with the BLOs comparing the pre- and post-SIR electoral rolls to identify those deleted. (Remember, the ECI had not agreed to publish their names until ordered by the Supreme Court last year). The changes that would make Form 6 suitable for readmitting deleted electors are yet to be made. CEO Maharashtra has written to the ECI in this regard so that millions of citizens are not vulnerable to criminal liability for making a false undertaking as stipulated in the current Form 6.

Then came the order resuming the suspended Special Summary Revision (SSR), due to which millions of first-time voters were allegedly denied enrolment since the SIR exercise started. (Incidentally, the SSR is meant to "purify" and update electoral rolls by deleting the dead and those who have moved away, enrolling the "eligible" and inquiring into complaints against those allegedly "ineligible", the stated objectives of the SIR.) It is intriguing how those deleted a few months ago for "ineligibility" will now qualify for enrolment. One irrationality replacing another!

In the wake of the numerous allegations of the misuse of Form 7 by mischievous elements, the ECI has imposed restrictions on the number of objections that can be filed using this form. And finally, the ECI has accepted political parties' long-pending demand to provide machine-readable copies of the electoral rolls, something it long resisted.

These are welcome steps even if they seem like those of a warrior who retreats after inciting the battle. These may partially make up for the contentiousness of the SIR but do not account for the alleged illegalities exposed by the *IE* report. The mystery surrounding the over 16 lakh appeals in West Bengal remains unsolved. The ECI cannot evade responsibility for causing the disenfranchisement of millions. It spent billions on an ill-conceived and purposeless exercise that neither identified the "ineligible" nor increased the number of electors by including the "eligible", which it could have achieved following the normal revision process. What about the mass anxiety generated in ordinary citizens and BLOs engaged in an avoidable exercise at the cost of their routine work?

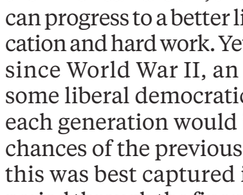
That still leaves us with decisions made unilaterally as opposed to the unanimous or majority decisions mandated by the law, of illegally amending Form 6 and designing a software that obstructed the Electoral Registration Officers (ERO) from performing their duties. The responsibility for these needs to be fixed. That now rests with the Court, which watched the SIR exercise unfold, occasionally providing palliatives but largely letting the ECI be a judge in its own cause.

The SC verdict on the alleged illegalities could "uphold" the decisions of the ECI as valid, frustrating the petitioners and leaving the aggrieved to find their own redress. It could rule the ECI decisions illegal and overturn them, leaving the ECI licking its wounds, a government bewildered about the next move, and a people fuming at their helplessness. Will the SC have fulfilled its responsibility by pronouncing the illegality just as it pronounced the Tamil Nadu Governor's actions unconstitutional? Will the government be willing or compelled to take note of the SC's verdict and act?

The matter now rests on collective will and individual sense of propriety. Will the CEC withdraw from official work till the Court exonerates him? Will the collective will of Parliament live up to the responsibility of acting against a constitutional authority held responsible by the SC for illegal decisions? Will the CEC/ECs continue to function in utter disregard of an adverse SC pronouncement? Equally, if exonerated by the SC, will they remain self-assured and indifferent to the unprecedented popular upsurge against them and the growing loss of trust it signifies? It was only Iago, the "deceitful wretch" in Shakespeare's *Othello* who could call reputation "an idle and most false imposition; oft got without merit and lost without deserving".

The writer is a former election commissioner

Daler Mehndi & the grace we owe artistes



SUANSHU KHURANA

THE STAGE has always been an unforgiving space. Yet there was something quite uneasy about watching popstar and Sufi singer Daler Mehndi being publicly hauled up over his recent performance at a Navratri event in Uttarakhand's Tehri Garhwal. Subodh Uniyal, a state cabinet minister, publicly criticised the musician, alleging that he appeared intoxicated. He also declared that Mehndi had failed to do justice to his art despite charging a hefty fee, that he was merely lip-syncing to songs playing through a "mixer".

No matter what the minister's displeasure, there is no justification for a politician to berate an artiste on the microphone and to resort to a public dressing-down the way Uniyal did. If Mehndi failed to honour his end of the bargain, which he did, there were other ways to register his complaint in private and with dignity.

Right after the incident went viral, many from the music industry, including Alisha Chinai, Harshdeep Kaur, Badshah, Shaan and Mehndi's younger brother Mika Singh, spoke of Mehndi's ill health. The musician had reportedly undergone a surgery recently and therefore could not perform to capacity.

While Mehndi must be defended from public criticism of this nature, it also cannot completely absolve him of his responsibility towards the audience. Musicians and their management teams must exercise some judgement on whether the artiste is fit to perform and hold the stage. Mehndi has been a brilliant performer in the past. From 'Tunak tunak tun' to 'Bolo tara ra' to 'Ho jayegi balle balle', Mehndi has given some of the biggest hits of his time. If he is unwell, he needs to be rested.

Playback singer and independent artiste Sona Mohapatra, a huge Mehndi fan, recently wrote on her social media about staying back for a day to attend the Punjabi singer's performance at the Sufi Heritage Festival in the Capital earlier this year. She had already performed at the festival and when I met her after her performance, and was visibly thrilled at the prospect of seeing Mehndi on stage the next day. There was something quite lovely about that anticipation: A glimpse that even artistes, who spend their lives performing for others, can be hardcore fans themselves. She was disappointed as Mehndi seemed "disoriented" and "struggled to hold a note" during his Delhi performance. "Respect is not a one-way entitlement. It is a relationship of reciprocity," she wrote.

There is no question that artistes owe the audience a great time. These people have spent time and money to watch their favourite people perform. Artistes will be surprised how the audiences can be forgiving when they are honest with them. A cracked voice, a missed note or an admission that illness has taken its toll are all human frailties and will almost always be accepted with love and grace. What they are less likely to accept is a sense of being taken for granted.

That said, an apology from Uniyal to an artiste who's entertained the country for three decades is in order.

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Rubio in India

INDIA'S GROWING refining capacity is a major strength, but protecting national interests must remain the priority ('Rubio visit prepares ground for reboot of ties', *IE*, October 22). Energy decisions should be based on economic benefits, reliable supplies and the country's long-term needs rather than foreign political pressure. Past policy changes have shown the risks of depending too heavily on other countries. India must negotiate fair agreements, protect its investments and maintain its strategic independence. Strong international partnerships are important, but they should never come at the cost of national interests.

Fathima K, Kozhikode

IN KEEPING with New Delhi's doctrine of strategic autonomy — exercised freely to engage US adversaries like Moscow and Tehran — it is only befitting that India ceases to treat Washington's engagements with Islamabad as a zero-sum grievance ('Rubio visit prepares ground for reboot of ties', *IE*, October 22). India cannot assert multi-alignment for itself while expecting diplomatic exclusivity from others. As Marco Rubio's visit demonstrated, bilateral relations now rest on tangible convergences — from Jamnagar's refining prowess to Quad integration. With Rubio wielding dual authority as Secretary of State and NSA, India must shed reflexive regional anxieties, finalise the long-pending trade agreement, and engage Washington strictly on its own merits.

Krishan Kumar Chugh, New Delhi

Inspiring legacy

SIR SYED Ahmad Khan's emphasis on modern education remains relevant in a society facing rapid technological and social change. Educational institutions must encourage scientific temper, critical thinking and respectful debate rather than rote learning. Equal access to quality education, particularly for disadvantaged students, deserves greater attention. His legacy should inspire institutions to combine academic excellence with social responsibility, enabling young people to question inherited prejudices and contribute constructively to a pluralistic society.

A S Nithish Kumar, Neelambur

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	PURCHASE OF LAPTOP, DESKTOP SET, PRINTER FOR OFFICE USE OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, ROHTAK. (RE-CALL),PURCHASE OF BIOMETRIC ATTENDANCE MACHINE FOR OFFICE USE OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, ROHTAK. (RE-CALL)	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 engg-rohtak@ubharyana.gov.in
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	SELECTION OF AN EXPERIENCED AGENCY / FIRM / ORGANIZATION FOR SETTING UP, OPERATION AND MANAGEMENT OF 22 CUSTOMER FACILITATION CENTRES (CFCS) HAVING 44 SERVICE WINDOWS FOR ELECTRONIC DELIVERY OF CITIZEN CENTRIC SERVICES (E-GOVERNANCE INITIATIVE), ALONG WITH SETTING UP AND OPERATION OF A WHATSAPP CHATBOT FOR GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL AND A 24X7 CALL CENTRE	19.10.2026 10.11.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 engg-rohtak@ubharyana.gov.in
3	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF BITUMEN ROAD NEAR TIKONA PARK SORROUNDING ROAD IN SECTOR-4, WARD NO. 09, MC ROHTAK + 1 WORKS	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	60,46,504/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com
4	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	REPAIR/REPLACEMENT OF VARIOUS ELECTRICAL INFRASTRUCTURE IN MAHARAJA AGRASEN COMMUNITY CENTER, SECTOR 21, ROHTAK	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	68.57 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50412-HRY

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB AMBALA	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 20 NOS. STAFF QUARTERS (CLASS-III) IN MARKETING BOARD COLONY AT AMBALA CITY (QUARTER NO. 8, 8-A TO 17, 17-A)	CLOSING DATE 30.10.2026	87,65,763/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171 7564380 xenambala2025.hsamb@gmail.com
2	HSAMB AMBALA	CONSTRUCTION OF CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE FOR LITCHI AT NAHEPUR, AMBALA (DEPOSIT WORK OF AGRICULTURE DEPARTMENT)	CLOSING DATE 13.11.2026	5,36,09,123/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171 7564380 xenambala2025.hsamb@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50417/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION MANESAR	PROVIDING AND LAYING SEWER LINE AND CONSTRUCTION OF RMC PAR GRADE ROAD IN VILLAGE MAHARPUR KASAN IN WARD NO 14, SH-01, MC MANESAR. + 1 WORKS	20.10.2026 03.11.2026	8,15,07,872/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	98130[illegible] enda2-xenmsr@ubharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50416/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE LADWA	CONSTRUCTION OF MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE BUILDING , LADWA	15.10.2026 30.10.2026	8,67,12,109/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8700851589 secy-ladwa@ubharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50413/HRY

Public Health Engineering Department

Govt. of Bihar

Public Health Engineering Division, Nawada

RETENDER NIT No –01/R1/2026-27/O&M-PHED

National Competitive Bidding

(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Nawada
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	16.10.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	31.10.2026 to 11.11.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	03.11.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division , Nawada
5	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	12.11.2026 up to 17:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of technical bid	12.11.2026 at 17:30Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

8.Details of works:

Group No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Completion Period (in months)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Comprehensive operation and maintenance, routine repairs and Special repairs of i.) Rural Piped Water Supply Scheme (PWS- 30 Nos) ii.) Single Village piped water supply schemes (SVS- 07 Nos), iii.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in quality affected wards (WLS Quality- 95 Nos) and iv.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in non quality affected wards (WLS Non Quality- 420 Nos) based on item rates; constructed by the Public Health Engineering Department including payment to the pump operators, electricity bills for five years.	6273.989	72.74	10000.00	As per Beltron	60 Months

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 013887 (PHED) 2026-27

Executive Engineer,
Public Health Division, Nawada

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE : SUNDARGARH

25001/1374/2627

AT/PO-SANKARA, SUNDARGARH-770020, E-mail address-serw_sundargarh@yahoo.com

No. Tender Online -RWCCESNG- 34 of 2026-27, Letter No 5673 **Dtd. 22/10/2026**

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Type of the Work: : Roads Work (PR)
2. Class of Contractor: : As specified in the column-7 of the Annexure
3. Time of Completion: : As specified in the column-6 of the Annexure
4. Detail Projects: : As per Annexure attached
5. Estimated Cost : As specified in the column-5 of the Annexure
6. Other details: :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding From	To	Last Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundargarh	RWCCESNG-34 of 2026-27	02.11.2026 11:00 AM	21.11.2026 5:00 PM	20.11.2026 5:00 PM	23.11.2026 11:00 AM	Will be intimated separately

Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Rural Works Circle, Sundargarh

OIPR- 25001/25133/1/26-27/0050

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE SONIPAT CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR MILLS LIMITED	CONTRACT FOR COMPLETE OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF SUGAR PLANT OF 2200 TCD FOR THE OFF SEASONS 2026,AND CRUSHING SEASONS 2026-27 AS PER ANNEXURE 'A', 'B' AND INDEX '1'	CLOSING DATE 26.10.2026	4,50,10,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996258570 sonipatsugar@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50419/HRY

HIMACHAL PRADESH; PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMEN

e-web:- www.hppwd.gov.in E mail:- hp-kin@nic.in
Phone No:- 01786-226027, Fax:- 01786-226027.

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer Kalpa Division, HP.PWD. Kalpa, District Kinnaur (HP) on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the online bids on percentage rate, in electronic tendering system, in 2 Cover System for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/Firms registered with HP PWD Department.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting Date for downloading Bid.	Earnest Money	Eligible Class of Contractor	Deadline for submission of Bid.	Date of opening of Technical bid.	Time
1	Periodical Maintenance on NH-22 to Khadura road Km. 0/00 to 5/00 (under Annual maintenance plan for the year of 2026-27. (VRHP0502VR003221102, 103, 104,105) (SH:- Balance work for Annual surfacing from Km. 4/00 to 5/00)	13,18,26173/-	21-10-2026	27,000/-	D Class	27-10-2026	28-10-2026	One Month
2	Construction of Swimming Pool at Rajiv Gandhi Govt. Model Day Boarding School at Kalpa in District Kinnaur (HP) (SH :- Building portion)	84,63,906.00	21-10-2026	1,70,000/-	C Class	27-10-2026	28-10-2026	Three Months

The bidders are advised to note other details/condition of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

No. 4223/2026-2027/HP

Executive Engineer,
Kalpa Division, HP.PWD. Kalpa

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, HOME DEPARTMENT (PORTS & TRANSPORT)

MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD

Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Ramjibhai Kamani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai-400 001. **Tel.:** 022-69041777 **Fax :** 022-69041740
Web site : https://mahammb.maharashtra.gov.in
Email : ceo.mmb@maharashtra.gov.in / ceommb@gmail.com

Second E-Tender Notice - (Year 2026-27)/R3/54

Main Portal : https://mahatenders.gov.in

DIGITALLY signed E-Tender for following work is invited by the Chief Executive Officer, Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai, from Registered with Government of Maharashtra and having experience in execution of Marine related civil works, for the following work in B-2 Tender Form.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Approximately Tender Cost in Rs.	Blank Tender form amount in Rs.	Earnest Money Amount in Rs.	Time Limit for Completion of Work
1.	Providing Infrastructural Facility to Fish Landing Center at Trombay in Maharashtra.	43,90,25,299/-	3,540/-	21,95,500/-	24 Months (Including Monsoon)

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal https://mahatenders.gov.in **21.10.2026* at 12.00 to 04.11.2026* at 1700 hours** (IST)*.

The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason is reserved.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai

DGIPR-2026-27/3337

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

noida

Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Re - Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	06/GM(Civil)/SM (E&M- III)/2026-27	Strengthening of Surveillance Security System Work at Vedvan Park Sec-78, MBIC & Noida Elevated Road Sec-18 to Sec-61, Noida.	37.20
2	09/GM(Civil)/SM (E/M- III)/2026-27	Supply, Installation, testing and commissioning of Surveillance Security System at Bhangel Elevated Road, Noida.	67.41

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **23.10.2026 to 29.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated **30.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.**

General Manager (Civil), NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

जल संसाधन विभाग
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
तिलैया नहर प्रमण्डल, वजीरगंज गया

Govt. of Bihar

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–01SBD/2026-27
(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. कार्य का विवरण :–

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख रु० में)	अग्रधन की राशि (लाख रु० में)	परिमाण–विपत्र का मूल्य (रु० में) (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑनलाईन मोड में भुगतेय)	बेल्ट्रॉन को देय "बिड प्रोसेसिंग फी" (रु० में) (अप्रत्यर्पणीय) (केवल ऑन लाईन मोड में भुगतेय)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की तिथि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	रामपुर शाखा नहर के विभिन्न स्थलों पर नहर तटबंध सुदृढ़ीकरण, NC एवं EC Bag Pitching , एक अदद CD एवं Outle t निर्माण तथा क्षतिग्रस्त Outlets की मरम्मति एवं अनुरक्षण का कार्य।	216.46109	4.33	10,000.00	5900.00	3 माह

2. निविदादाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, तिलैया नहर प्रमण्डल, वजीरगंज गया।
3. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत करने की तिथि : दिनांक–15.10.2026
4. निविदा कागजात डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की अवधि : दिनांक–06.11.2026 से 17.11.2026 को 3:00 बजे अपराह्न तक। केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
5. प्री–बीड मीटिंग की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान : दिनांक 09.11.2026 को 3:00 बजे अपराह्न मुख्य अभियंता, सिंचाई सृजन, जल संसाधन विभाग, गया के कार्यालय कक्ष में।
6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक 19.11.2026 के अपराह्न 3:30 बजे। केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी द्वारा बाद में वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर घोषित की जायेगी।
8. निविदा खोलने का स्थान : केवल वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
9. निविदा वैधता की अवधि : 120 दिन।
9. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु वेबसाईट http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in,oa www.wrd.fmiscwrdbihar.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No. 014007 (WRD) 2026-27

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
तिलैया नहर प्रमण्डल, वजीरगंज, गया
मो0 :– 7463889885

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Public Health Engineering Department

Govt. of Bihar

Public Health Engineering Division, Araria

TENDER NIT No – 01 (R1)/2026-27/ARR/WLS/O&M-PHED

National Competitive Bidding

(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Araria
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	16.10.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	03.11.2026 to 12.11.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	05.11.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division , Araria
5	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	12.11.2026 up to 17:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of technical bid	12.11.2026 at 17:30Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

8. Details of works:

Group No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Completion Period (in months)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Comprehensive operation and maintenance, routine repairs and Special repairs of **a. Rural P iped Water Supply Scheme (PWS) (10 Nos.)** **b. Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in quality affected wards (WLS_Quality) (1790 Nos.)** and based on item rates; constructed by the Public Health Engineering Department including payment to the pump operators, electricity bills for five years.	19302.091	203.02091	10000.00	5900.00	60 Months

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 014027 (PHED) 2026-27

Executive Engineer
Public Health Division, Araria

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

अरुणाचल प्रदेश सरकार
GOVERNMENT OF ARUNACHAL PRADESH
उपायुक्त कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY COMMISSIONER
दापोरिजो, अपर सुबनसिरी जिला पिनः 791122
DAPORIJO, UPPER SUBANSIRI
DISTRICT PIN: 791122

ईमेल / E-mail: dc-usuban-arn@nic.in

DC

No. LM/DRJ-83/N&A/LA/2022/ **Dated Daporijo, the 15th October 2026**

Notice under section 21 of LARR Act 2013, for land acquisition of land measuring area 66.649 hectares for establishing forward logistic area and administrative detachments of Indian Army purpose at Nacho-l, Gengba (Nacho), Limeking (Yapong Yalong), Redi, Redi Helipad and Orak-(A & B pocket) under Nacho & Limeking circles of upper Subansiri district.

In pursuance of the government declaration No.LMD-13011/17/2026/1352, Dated Itanagar, the 28th September 2026, the District Administration, Upper Subansiri District, Arunachal Pradesh had widely circulated in the district the declaration under section 19 of LARR Act 2013, vide No. LM/DRJ-83/N&A/LA/2022/547 Date Daporijo, the 7th October 2026, for the claims of objection of interested person(s) to the said land as per section 21 of LARR Act 2013,

Whereas, no further claims and objection have been received by the undersigned office and even the office of the Sub-Divisional Officer Nacho regarding the said land, and hence, as per office records of previous the claims and objection made under section 11 and section 15 as mentioned in the declaration remains same for the interested person(s).

Now therefore, the notice section 21 of clause 3,4,& 5 of LARR Act 2013, for the land acquisition of land area measuring 66.649 hectare for establishing forward logistic area and administrative detachments of Indian Army purpose at Nacho-l, Gengba (Nacho), Limeking (Yapong Yalong), Redi, Redi Helipad and Orak-(A & B pocket) under Nacho & Limeking circles of Upper Subansiri District, Arunachal Pradesh is issued for general information to all the concerned person(s) interested in the land to appear on hearing scheduled on 31.10.2026 at SDO office Nacho at 1100 hours for hearing of their clams and objection to the measurement made under section 20 and declaration under section 19 under LARR Act 2013.

Sd/-
(Tasso Gambo)
Deputy Commissioner
Upper Subansiri District Daporijo

DIPR/ARN/218

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING WDG./STG. OF VARIOUS 2 NOS. ROADS BAHIN TO NANGAL JATT (ID 12124) RD 0.00 TO 2.47 KM AND SEVLI TO BAHIN ROAD (ID 9201) RD 0.00 TO 4.00 KM IN HATHIN CONSTITUENCY IN PROVINCIAL DIVISION, PWD BANDR BR., PALWAL UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27 (PART-II) IN PALWAL DISTT. (UNDER HEAD-3054-ODR-GROUP-1) (WITHOUT GST). + 3 WORKS	19.10.2026 28.10.2026	1666.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	CONSTRUCTION OF 100 BEDDED MCH WING IN DISTRICT KAITHAL (UNDER NHM FUNDS)	CLOSING DATE 10.11.2026	1608.25 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	IMP. OF ROAD FROM SAMPLA TO KHARKHODA ROAD IN ROHTAK DISTT (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF-XXXII) ROAD ID - 12693	19.10.2026 10.11.2026	1072.59 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416046666 pwd-eepd1-rohtak@hry.nic.in
4	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-AUCTION FOR COFFEE SHOP AT KCGMC, KARNAL	27.10.2026 10.11.2026	EMD 6300	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8295340665 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
5	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE,CHARKHI DADRI.	RENOVATION OF POND AND RAMP INLETS, VILLAGE LOHARWARA, BLOCK CHARKHI DADRI , DISTT. CHARKHI DADRI	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	18.27 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com
6	CIVIL SURGEON,PALWAL	PUBLICATION OF RETENDER FOR NOTICE FOR DRUGS INJECTION CONSUMABLES DENTAL ITEMS REAGENTS	21.10.2026 29.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9671369752 sanjayalon1977@gmail.com
7	PANCHAYATI RAJ, PINJORE	BDPO OFFICE :REPAIR AND CONST. OF B/WALL OF BDPO OFFICE BLOCK PINJORE DISTT. PKL	19.10.2026 26.10.2026	2.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466110204 sdoprpinjore@gmail.com
8	PANCHAYATI RAJ, CHARKHI DADRI	CONSTRUCTION OF RASTA NUMBER 238 AND 240 AT VILLAGE MEHRANA (CM ANNOUNCEMENT 29088) + 2 WORKS	16.10.2026 27.10.2026	109.56 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9582622008 xenprcharkhidadri@gmail.com
9	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	CONST. OF WALL OF POND NEAR MANDIR AT VILLAGE GULLARPUR BLOCK NISSING DISTRICT KARNAL SCHEME VANGY + 8 WORKS	19.10.2026 27.10.2026	150.83 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896202019 prexeeng.krl@hry.nic.in
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, BAHADURGARH	INTERNAL CLEARANCE OF DULHERA DISTY FROM RD 75855 TO 121000(BEFORE RABI 2026-27) + 5 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 26.10.2026	32.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01276-298418 wsdivisionbgarh@gmail.com
11	HORTICULTURE C.S.T.F. LADWA,KURUKSHETRA	TENDER NOTICE FOR THE PROCUREMENT OF PLANTING MATERIAL (ROOTSTOCK / SEEDLINGS) FOR PRODUCTION OF GRAFTING PLANTS	13.10.2026 30.10.2026	20000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7988103898 cstfladwa@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50449/HRY

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Gaurav Gupta S/o ram chander gupta R/o 701 Iconic Tower Cloud 9 Society Vaishali Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh 201010 have changed my minor daughter s name from Prisha to Prisha Gupta. Henceforth she would be known by the name of PRISHA GUPTA for all future purposes.

0040884849-1

I,**DEBANKUSH** MONDAL CHINTU,S/O-Laxman chand mandal,R/o.H.NO-784, Pocket-5, Sector-A/6, Narela, Delhi-110040 have changed my name to DEBANKUSH MANDAL Permanently.

0040884854-4

I, Ranjna Kumari, W/o Raj Kumar, R/o 36/144, Trilokpuri, East Delhi-110091, hereby declare that I have changed my name to Ranjna for all future purposes.

0040884756-1

I, MANJU DEVI, W/o UPENDER YADAV, R/o A-1079, Durga Gali, Mandawali Fazalpur, East Delhi-110092, hereby declare that my name and my husband's name have been wrongly recorded as MANJU YADAV and UPENDRA YADAV respectively in my daughter AYUSHI's 10th class marksheet. Henceforth, our correct names shall be read as MANJU DEVI and UPENDER YADAV for all future purposes.

0071067236-1

I SUSHEEL KUMAR S/o RAJENDRA SINGH R/o 439/5,LAKHPAT COLONY PART-2, MITHAPUR EXTN,BADARPUR,SOUTH DELHI-110044 Have changed my name to SUSHIL KUMAR

0040884862-9

I,**MUNEER** AHMED,s/O-JAMIL AHMED,r/o-T Huts no,E-44/C-493,New Seemapuri,Jhilmil, Shahdra,Delhi-110095,has changed my name to MUNIR AHMAD permanently for all future purpose

0040884863-5

I Urmila Gupta Alias Urmila Devi D/o Ved Parkash and W/o Raj Kumar Gupta R/o House NoA-51, Majlis Park, Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033, have changed my name to Urmil Gupta

0071067165-1

I,**GUNEET** GHURA,W/O-RAMAN DEEP SINGH GHURA,Address A-83 GREENWOOD CITY,SECTOR-45,NEW CYBER PARK, GURGAON, HARYANA-122003,have changed my name to GUNEET BAHRI.

0040884862-2

I, Pradhuman Kumar Ray S/o Shri Yadavlal Ray R/o Chandrwardai Nagar, Muzaffarpur, Bihar-842001, have change my name from Pradhuman Kumar Ray to Pradhuman Kumar for all future purpose.

0040884860-1

I, Shalini W/o Anil Verma R/o Ho No-B-233 Kh, No-276, Chattarpur Enclave phase-2, Chattarpur Village, Chattarpur South Delhi, Delhi 110074. have changed my name to Shalini Verma for all purposes

0040884751-1

I, Dheer Singh S/o Mr. Rang Lal R/o Village Sadullapur, P.O.-Vaidpura, Greater Noida, Distt. G.B.Nagar, U.P.-203207 have changed my name to Dheer Singh Nagar S/o Mr. Rang Lal Singh for all future purposes.

0071067243-1

I SONI DEVI W/O SUSHIL KUMAR R/O 439/5,LAKHPAT COLONY PART-2, MITHAPUR EXTN,BADARPUR, SOUTH DELHI-110044 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SONY

0040884862-11

I, Vipin Singh S/o Amar Singh R/o 1/386, F.No.-T-1, Third Floor, Ambedkar Marg, Near Asha Ram Gali, Mandawali Fazalpur, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my minor son's name from Saksham Singh aged 14 years to Milan forever

0071067166-1

I,**Neetu,D/o-Shoraj** Singh,R/o.D-1191 GROUND FLOOR GALI NO 4 ASHOK NAGAR NAND NAGARI EAST DELHI 1100093 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NEETU SINGH

0040884862-8

I, Kummar Parashar S/o Sunil Parashar R/o Z-419 B, Sector-12, Noida-201301, have changed my minor daughter name from PRATHA PARASHAR to PRATHA K PARASHHAR for all future purposes.

0071067235-1

I, Mohammad Imteyaz Hasan S/o Mohammad Ahsan R/o F-135, G/F, Shaheen Bagh, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-2, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 have changed my old name from Imtyaz Hassan to my actual name MOHAMMAD IMTEYAZ HASAN for all future purposes and legal documents.

0040884749-1

I,**MOHAMMAD** WAHEED SALMANI,S/O.MOHAMMED AHEMAD SALMANI,R/O.B-155,J.J.COLONY,KHYALA,TILAK NAGAR,DELHI-110018 have changed my name to MD WAHID PERMANENTLY.

0040884854-3

I Sanjiv Kumar S/o Roshan Lal Chugh R/o C-337 Majlis Park Delhi-33 declare name wrongly written Sanjiv Chugh in DL0819970368367

0040884538-1

I, Manju W/o Ram Mehar R/o 4620/14, Jai Mata Market, Tri Nagar, VTC: Onkar Nagar, Sub District: Saraswati Vihar, District: North West Delhi, Delhi-110035 have changed the name of my minor son from KESHAV to KESHAV SHARMA for all purposes.

0071067260-1

I, Gaurav Suratmani Tripathi S/O Suratmani Damodarprasad Tripathi R/o Flat No. 703, Tower 6, Panchsheel Pratishtha, Sector 75, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name to GAURAV TRIPATHI for all future purposes.

0071067160-1

It is for general information that I,Ashish Kumar Jain,S/o-Sheel Chand Jain,Residing at K-65-C,Chachi Building,Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051,declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as,Ashish Jain in my minor daughter namely Preksha Jain Aged-14Years in her School-Record and in her Birth-Certificate No.EA015041.The actual name of mine is Ashish Kumar Jain which may be amended accordingly.

0040884863-2

I,**PUSHPA** DEVI,W/O-MAMRAJ SHARMA,R/O.A-68 KH NO-914/2,GALI NO-2 FRIENDS ENCLAVE WEST BLOCK MUNDKA DELHI-110041 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PUSHPA FOR FUTURE.

0040884862-6

I, Irene Saikia W/o Bijoy Sankar Saikia R/o-B12A09, Noornagar, SCC Sapphire, Rajnagar Ext., Ghaziabad have changed my name to Irene Agnes Obrien.

0071067232-1

I, SUNNY S/o- Ram Prashad R/o-J-328, Shakur-Pur Delhi-110034,have changed my Name from SUNNY to SUNNY KHADIYA, permanently

0040884854-1

I, GOPAL DAS S/o PYARE LAL R/o HOUSE NO. A-138, NEHRU GALI NO. 6 SHIV MANDIR MARG, MANDAWALI FAZALPUR, DELHI, SHAKARPUR, EAST DELHI, DELHI - 110092 have changed my name to GOPAL DAS CHAUDHARY for all purposes.

0071067250-1

I, JAMEEL AHMAD, S/o BABU KHAN R/o J-20/1, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name to JAMIL AHMED.

0071067154-1

I,**NEHA** TIWARI W/O SUMEET PAREEK R/O AE-151 SHALIMAR BAGH DELHI-110088.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NEHA PAREEK FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040884862-4

I, Suhali Jain, W/o Harsh Jain R/o E-532, 3rd floor, Greater Kailash, Part-2, New Delhi-110048, have changed my name from Sohali Jain to Suhali Jain for all future Purposes.

0071067228-1

I,**ROSHI,W/O-WASEEM** KHAN,R/O-D-341,NAVJEEVAN CAMP,GOVIND-PURI KALKA JI SOUTH DELHI 110019 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO ROSHI KHAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE.

0040884863-4

I Tarun Lekhi S/o Krishan Gopal R/o B-407, Fourth Floor, Sai Baba Apartments, Rohini Sector-9, Rohini, New Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Charanjeet Lekhi

0071067171-1

I, Kapil Kumar Dureja S/o Manohar Lal R/o C-11, East Baldev, Park, Krishna Nagar, PO- Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my minor daughter's name from Aarohi aged 13 years to Aarohi Dureja forever.

0071067164-1

I, Sandeep S/o Ram Kishan R/o 264, Habuda Mohalla, Rangpuri, Malikpur Kohi Alias Rangpuri, PO- Gurgaon Road, South West Delhi-110037, have changed the name of my minor daughter PARI aged 07 years and he shall hereafter be known as Prisha Choudhary.

0071067209-1

I Dhan Lal S/o Ramesh Prasad R/o House No- 315, Pipartola, Bichhiya, Bhuabichhia, Mandla, Madhya Pradesh-481995, have changed my name to Dhan Raj Maravi

0071067241-1

I hitherto known as,GRANVI MITTAL,W/o-KANISHQ BANSAL,R/o-H.No.12,Road No. 72,West Punjabi Bagh,Delhi-110026,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as,GRANVI BANSAL.

0040884862-10

I,**MOHAMMAD** TAHIR,s/o-MOHD ILYAS,r/o-H no-496,Bagowali,Bagowali, Muzaffarnagar,Uttar Pradesh-251001,has changed my name to MOHD TAHIR permanently for all future purpose

0040884863-6

I hereby declare that NOOR VASUNDHARA MUBAYI and NOOR VASUNDHARA refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself. I request all concerned authorities to consider and recognize my name as NOOR VASUNDHARA MUBAYI, as mentioned in my Aadhaar Card.

0040884759-1

I, Vidha Wati W/O B. M. Pandey R/O A-287, Gali No.6, Part-5, Sonia Vihar, Delhi-110094, inform that Vidyanti Devi and Vidha Wati both the names are one and same person.

0040884860-2

I, Mohd. Waseem Qureshi S/o Mr. Mohd. Saleem Qureshi, R/o House No. C-100/8A, Street No. 11/3, Matke Wali Gali, Near Bilal Masjid, Chauhan Bangar, New Seelampur, Delhi-110053, have changed my name from Vasim Qureshi to Mohd. Waseem Qureshi, for all future purposes. 0040884760-1

I Dipanshu S/o Saheb Lal R/o RZ-60, Second Floor, Gali No-24, Vashisht Park , Sagarpur, PO-Nangal Raya, Delhi - 110046 have changed my name to Deepanshu. 0071067170-1

I,**Nizole** Fita Snock,C/o.Lt.M Asang,R/o.H.No.158,Upper Ground floor,Near Gurudwara,East of Kailash,Delhi-110065, have changed my name to FITA permanently 0040884862-3

I hitherto known as Ankur Chib S/o Vipin Chib, R/o A-175, Sector-40, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as AKIRA ANKUR YAMAMOTO CHIB

0071067247-1

I, Sanjay kumar S/o-Rajpal Singh Address- Murha Navjarpur po: sujawalpur Dist Hathras Uttar Pradesh 204211, have changed my name to Sanjay

0040884862-1

I, Irene Obrien W/o Bijoy Sankar Saikia R/o-B12A09, Noornagar, SCC Sapphire, Rajnagar Ext., Ghaziabad have changed my name to Irene Agnes Obrien.

0071067229-1

I,**TARUNKUMAR** HARESHBHAI PARMAR,S/O-PARMAR HARESHBHAI BHIKHABHAI, R/O-UPWAN KOTHI DELHI ROHTAK ROAD BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARMAR TARUNBHAI.

0040884862-5

I,**Suneeta** Devi,W/o-Anil Kumar,R/o-H.No-118, Village Pitam Pura, New Delhi- 110034, have changed my name Sunita Devi for all Purposes.

0040884854-5

I,**Manish** Kumar,S/o Ashok Kumar,R/o-2266 E/3,Gali No.1,Bihari Colony, Shahdara,East Delhi-110032, have changed the name of my minor son Antriksh Aggarwal,DOB-09-11-2008 to,Antriksh Gupta.Antriksh Aggarwal and Antriksh Gupta is one and the same person.

0040884863-1

I, Himanshu Kataria S/o Praveen kumar kataria R/o C-504, Park View Apartment Sec-61, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my minor Daughter's name from Janita to Janita Kataria. Henceforth She Would be Know as Janita Kataria for all future Purposes 0071067155-1

I, SATISH KUMAR S/o BABU LAL R/o SHOP NO 18-19-20-21 1ST FLOOR, BLK-A, KALAMANDIR CINEMA HALL, MANGOLPURI, MANGOLPURI N BLOCK, PO: MANGOLPURI N BLOCK, DELHI-110083 have changed the name of my minor daughter from ASHNA to ASHNA RAJ for all purposes. 0071067253-1

I, **Mohammad** Tarique Jamal, S/o- Abdul Aziz Kotha, R/o-C11/C11A S/F F/S M/P, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-2, Tayyab Masjid Road, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, South Delhi-110025, have change my name to Tarique Jamal, for all purposes. My father's correct name is Abdul Aziz Kotha instead-of Abdul Aziz mentioned in my Passport.

0040884854-2

I, Manish Kumar Garg,S/o Sh.Chander Lal Garg,R/o-House No-C-64,Block-V, Bhagwati-Vihar,Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059,have changed my name Manish Kumar Garg to Manish,for all future purposes.

0040884748-1

I, JANAK RANI ALIAS JANAK KOCHAR D/o SADANAND GHABLANI W/o JUGAL KISHORE R/o 8210, STREET NO. 5, MULTANI DHANDA PAHAR GANJ, SWAMI RAM TIRTH NAGAR, SWAMI RAM TIRTH NAGAR, DELHI, 110055 have changed my name to JANAK KOCHAR for all purposes.

0071067234-1

I,**MOHAMMAD** MUSTUFA,S/O-SHAKEEL AHMED,R/O-1015,KISHAN-GANJ TELIWARA,NEAR IMLI WALI MASJID-AZAD MARKET,DELHI-110006,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD MUSTUFA FOR FUTURE. 0040884862-7

I,**SUNIL** CHACHRA,S/o-Lajpat Rai Chachra,R/o-flat No-6,Shubham Apartments, plot No-37,Patparganj,I.P Extension,Delhi-110092,have changed my name to SUNIL KUMAR CHACHRA for all future purposes. 0040884863-3

I, DIMPLE MINOCHA ALIAS DIMPLE KUMAR D/o B C MINOCHA W/o RAJESH KUMAR R/o ED-137/2, TAGORE GARDEN, DELHI, TAGORE GARDEN, RAJOURI GARDEN, WEST, DELHI, 110027 have changed my name to DIMPLE KUMAR for all purposes.

0071067161-1

LOST & FOUND

It is notified for information for public that original property documents of Flat No. 374, Shakti Khand-3, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, belonging to my late mother, Mrs. Asha Sikka, have been lost/misplaced Police FIR No. 20260001104244 dated 21.10.2026. Finder Please contact to Namita - 9620048543

0040884820-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

Let it be known to the general public that my client **Sh. Narendra Kumar,** son of Shri Meeru Ram, address: 4590, Gali Chaudhary Sundar Singh, Sabzi Mandi, Malka Ganj, North Delhi, Delhi-110007 debarred his son namely **Sh. Tarun Kumar** and daughter-in-law **Smt. Muskan** from all his movable and immovable property due to their disobedient and quarrelsome nature towards my client and my client will not be responsible for the conduct of them, anybody deals with them shall do the same on his/her risks, costs and consequences.

Sd/-
T.R. KASHYAP
Advocate
Ch. No. 607, Western Wing, (G. Floor) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Sonia Gandhi (Mobile No.7021985063) W/o Sh. Rajiv Gandhi R/o 706 A-Wing Mount Alps Bhakti Park, Near Imax Theater Wadala, East Antop Hill, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400037, have lost my property original documents i.e. Allotment Letter dated 25.10.2002, Possession Letter dated 17.01.2003 and Conveyance Deed dated 10.03.2015 of Flat no. 446 on Second Floor, Cat. MIG, Pocket No. B, Sector 13 situated at Dwarka Phase -II, New Delhi -110075 (Property) during shifting the Property and I tried to trace but did not find the same.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby notified to the general public that my client, SMT. SUNITA W/o LATE SH. PURSHOTTAM DEV BENIWAL, R/o H.No.116, Pitampura Village, Delhi–110034, has, of her own free will, severed all personal relations with her son, SH. SUMIT BENIWAL, her daughter-in-law, SMT. NEHA SHEORAN D/o SH. OM PRAKASH SHEORAN, and their child, KIARA, owing to family disputes. They shall have no right, title, interest or claim whatsoever in respect of the movable or immovable properties/assets belonging to my client. Any person dealing with the aforesaid persons in any matter shall do so entirely at their own risk, cost and responsibility. My client shall not be held liable or responsible for any act, omission, debt or liability incurred by them.

GIRISH KUMAR TOMAR (Advocate)
Enrl.No.D/3179/2024

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public Notice It is Information that my client Ms. Sunita Mehra w/o Late Mr. Vishwa Mehra, Ms. Reema Sarna d/o Late Mr. Vishwa Mehra & Mr. Nipun Mehra s/o Late Mr. Vishwa Mehra are the owners of Flat No. F-1 on First Floor without roof rights, measuring 65.02 sq. mtr. built-on Plot No. A-147, at Shalimar Garden, main, Tehsil & Distt. Ghaziabad U.P. & he has lost the Original Sale Deed dated 06.06.1998, as Doc. No. 3391 in favour of Smt. Inderjeet in respect of the said property, has also lodged a FIR dated 30.05.2011 for the same. Any person dealing with the said document may do so at his/her own risk and manner whatsoever any claim on the basis of the title document will be entertained within 15 days of publication, failing which any such right, title interest, or claim if any, will be deemed to have been waived and not binding on our client.

Yogesh Kumar (Advocate)
Office No. 2 First Floor, Kalyan Kunj Chaudhary Farm, Near Piller No. 37 Sector-49, Noida, G. B. Nagar- 201301, Mob: No.9911004142, 9310203738.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be It Known that my client **ALKA BURMAN** W/o Late Sh. Sushil Kumar Burman R/o D-53, Prashant Vihar Delhi-110085 have disowned and severed all her relation with her daughter namely **PARUL KASHYAP** W/O DEEPAK KASHYAL and their children namely **HITA KASHYAP** and **HIYA KASHYAP.** debarred them from her movable and immovable properties/assets due to her mis-behaviour. Anybody dealing with them in civil and criminal matter shall be doing at his/her/their own risk, cost and responsibility.

Sd/-
PARKASH CHAND
Advocate
Enrl. No. D/9065/2019

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that my client is in the process of purchasing the property bearing No. 54, Entire Third Floor, with terrace rights, excluding 3 Servant Quarters and one common toilet on terrace of Third Floor situated at NRI Complex, Mandakini, Alaknanda, Greater Kailash-IV, New Delhi- 110019 (hereinafter called the said Property), from its present owners, namely Mr. Vinod Kumar Mattoo son of Late Shri Amar Nath Mattoo and Mrs. Kiran Mattoo wife of Dr. Vinod Kumar Mattoo, who represent themselves to be lawful owners of the said property.

Any person(s), bank, financial institution or other entity having any right, title, interest, claim, demand, objection, lien, charge, mortgage, encumbrance or dispute of whatsoever nature in respect of the aforesaid property, by way of sale, agreement to sell, gift, inheritance, lease, tenancy, litigation or otherwise, is hereby called upon to intimate the same in writing, along with supporting documentary evidence, to the undersigned within 15 (fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice.

In the event no such claim or objection is received within the stipulated period, my client shall be proceed with the proposed purchase of the aforesaid property on the presumption that no third party claims or objections subsist, subject to verification of title and applicable law. Any claim received thereafter may not be entertained by my client.

Amit Garg (Advocate)
Address: 30/192, Basement Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar-IV, New Delhi. # 98101-75534

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public Notice hereby informed that my client SARABJEET KAUR W/O LATE SUKHBIR SINGH R/O HOUSE NO. A-8, HIMGIRI ENCLAVE, NILOTHI EXTN., WEST DELHI-110041 hereby debarred and disowned her daughters (1) KIRANDEEP KAUR W/O MANDEEP SINGH & (2) SONAM KAUR from all movable and immovable properties because they harassing, torturing and misbehaves with my client and totally out of control. "If anybody deals with them at his/her/their own risk, cost and expenses. My clients shall neither liable and responsible for their acts, deeds, and things under any circumstances".

DHARAM SINGH MANDHOLIA (ADVOCATE) BCD. E No. 0/1916/1999

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients 1. Sh. Suresh Kumar S/o Shri Ram Sarup Dass and 2. Smt. Bala Devi W/o Sh. Suresh Kumar both R/o F-19/45, Sector-8, Rohini, North West, New Delhi-85, have debarred their son Mr. Sunny Singhal along with his wife Mrs. Ashana Singhal & their 2 children (Kriday Singhal & Goransh Singhal) from their movable, immovable properties, jewellery (Gold & Diamond) and all other assets, due to his misconduct, insubordination & irresponsible behavior. Anybody dealing with him shall do at his own cost & risk and responsibilities.

Ayush Mittal (Advocate)
D/5626/2022
AN-2, Shalimar Bagh, New Delhi-88
Ph.- 8700319650

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Government of Himachal Pradesh
Jal Shakti Vibhag
"Notice Inviting e-Tender"

The Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Vibhag, Flood Protection Division, Gagret (HP) invites online e-tender on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors for the following works through online process :-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost	Earnest Money	Cost of Tender document	Time Limit	Eligible Class of Contractor
1.	C/o 20 Nos. Tubewells in village Shivpur Pandra, Kailash Nagar, Kalruhi, Lower Andora, Pirthipur, Harwal, Bhaderkali (Maira Amb Harizan Basti), Dangoh, Dangoh-II, Lower Joh Beh, Joh, Dangoh Khas, sagnai, Tubewell No. 1 Kaloh (improvement), Tubewell No. 37 Mubarikpur (Replacement of Old T/well), T/well Gondpur Banehra (Replacement of Old T/well), T/well at Daulatpur (Replacement of Old T/well), Tubewell No. 49 Jadla (Improvement), Tubewell No. 83 Loharli (improvement) and Upper Loharli (improvement) in Gagret Constituency Distt. Una (HP) (SH: Construction of Civil work, Laying of Rising Main, P/L Distribution system and S/E of Pumping Machinery for Tubewell No. 49 at Jadla, Tubewell at Upper Loharli & Tubewell No. 83 at Loharli).	Rs. 1,35,18,047/-	Rs. 1,67,680/-	Rs. 5000/-	3 (Three) Months	Class "C"

1. The last date of physically submission of earnest money deposit and cost of tender documents etc. on 29.10.2026 upto 12:00 PM.
1. The last date of e-tendering upto 29.10.2026 at 12:00 PM and the same will be opened on the day on 29.10.2026 at 12:30 PM.
2. The Tender forms and other detailed conditions can be downloaded from the **http://hptenders.gov.in**.

No. 4253/HP — HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd., VS, VIJAYAWADA-520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)
TENDER ID No.1003553

APGENCO invites open tenders for "Renovation & Moderinization (R&M) of HVAC Systems for Units 5 & 6 (2X210MW) of Stage -III at Dr.NTTPS" through AP e-procurement. Estimated Cost Value : **Rs.2,56,68,832/-**
Schedule available Date & Time : **13.10.2026** - onwards.
Bid submission closing Date & Time : **05.11.2026** - 13.00 Hrs
For other details visit the website : **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**
DIPR No.5520PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22, Dt: 22/10/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.
In reference to above, tender opening date already extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026 to 21.09.2026 and 21.09.2026 to 21.10.2026, now this is fourth corrigendum, tender opening date has been extended from 21.10.2026 to 23.11.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
The corrigendum has been published on website **www.ireps.gov.in.**
Note: This is the Fourth Corrigendum in above referred tender.
Date: 19.10.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3677/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Office of the Principal Chief Materials Manager
Headquarters Office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001

Sub: - Intimation of Pre-bid meeting for procurement of DESKTOP BASED SIMULATOR FOR THREE PHASE ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVE in newspaper.
Tender No. 15265111 for procurement of 25 Nos. of DESKTOP BASED SIMULATOR FOR THREE PHASE ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVE has been published by this office. The pre-bid meeting is scheduled for **03.11.2026** in PCMM Conference Room, Stores Branch, Baroda House from **15:00** hrs onwards & tender is due to open on dated **26.11.2026**. **Estimated Cost of Purchase is approx. Rs. 95.27 Crore**. Please make it convenient to attend the pre-bid meeting.

(SHANTANU SINGH)
No. 15265111/P-15 Dt. 22.10.2026 DY. Chief Material Manager/DSL
SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 3671/2026

The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)
TENDER NOTICE
E-tenders is invited for the supply of following item.
(1) 82244 - High Speed Diesel Oil For Automobiles.
Note: For more details, log on to website **https://mahatenders.gov.in**
PRO/AAM(M)/77/2026 GENERAL MANAGER

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in
Ref. No. :- F.02 (458)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-20/2026-27/5317 Dated :- 16/10/2026
Corrigendum-I in NIB-20/2026-27
In Reference to NIB No. F.02 (458)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/ NIB-20/2026-27/5519 Dated: - 28.09.2026 UBN No. MSC2627GLOB00057 Corrigendum-I is issued for date extension in bid. All details may be seen on **https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in & https://www. rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in.**
Director (Proc.)
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12291 RMSCL, Jaipur

कार्यालय अति० मुख्य अभियंता,
सा.नि.वि., सम्भाग द्वितीय, जयपुर।
पी.डब्ल्यू.डी. कैम्पस, जैकब रोड, जयपुर क्लब के सामने, जयपुर
फोन :- 0141-5110537, 5110501 एक्स-299, फैक्स: 0141-5110537
E-mail:- acezoneii@yahoo.com/acejprii.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक: 1566 दिनांक:- 15/10/2026
निविदा संशोधन सूचना संख्या- 28/2026-27
इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 1322 दिनांक 19.09.2026 द्वारा जारी निविदा सूचना संख्या 28/2026-27, में कार्य की निविदा अब 26.10.2026 को साय 6.00 बजे तक बेची जाकर दिनांक 27.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 2.00 बजे खोली जायेगी। जो राज्य की उपापन पोर्टल (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**) एवं विभागीय वेबसाईट **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in**. पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
निविदा की शेष शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

S.No	UBN	S.No	UBN	S.No	UBN
1	PWD2627WLOB12740	2	PWD2627WLOB12846	3	PWD2627WLOB12849

हस्ता/-
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता
DIPR/C/17839/2026 सा.नि.वि. सम्भाग द्वितीय, जयपुर

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE No. 52/2026-2027 Dated: 22/10/2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi - 110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items :-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	01261832	PORCELAIN STAY ARM INSULATOR	2995 NOS	09-11-26
02	07260449	OVERHAULING KIT FOR DUMP VALVE	2112 SET	12-11-26
03	07260108	HANGER FOR BOLSTER SPRING SUSPENSION	11710 NOS	13-11-26
04	07260999	HIGH CAPACITY THERMOPLASTIC POLYESTER	21224 NOS	18-11-26
05	09262475	CAST STEEL SIDE FRAME FOR BLC WAGON	75 NOS	23-11-26
06	09272220	DISTRIBUTOR VALVE	360 NOS	14-12-26

Note :
1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained. 3678/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Executive Engineer
P. W. Division No. 1 Nagpur
e-mail- div1nagpur.ee@mahapwd.com
CORRIGENDUM
Ref: 1. E-Tender Notice No 39/RAC/2026-27

SR. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In lakh)	Cost of Blank Tender Form	Time limit in Tender (Calendar Months)
11	Miscellaneous Repairs to 38/1 Bunglow, Civil Lines, Nagpur.	41.18	590/-	01 Month

Executive Engineer, Public Works Division No.1, Nagpur had invited above reference tender. Which was published by this office outward no.8807 dated 30.09.2026 in Tender Notice 39 on Sr.No. 7. **Kindly note that above mentioned Tender is cancelled due to Technical reason.**
O.W. No. 9555 dt. 19 OCT 2026 sd/-
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION NO.1,
Nagpur

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Ref: Tender Notice No. 44/2026-2027 dated 23.09.2026 Sr. No. 06 (i). Tender No. 15265111 due on 26.11.2026
In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from **22.10.2026** to **26.11.2026**. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
The corrigendum has been published on website **www.ireps.gov.in**.
SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 3676/2026

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1.	Tender Enquiry No. 202/GATP/IMD/BTG/20018238 dated 22/10/2026 "Procurement of Temperature and Pressure sensors installed in TG and other BTG area from GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB. "Area of 2 x. 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib" at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications."	

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 22/10/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
No. 16407 GATP-93/26

आधुनिक रेल डिब्बा कारखाना, रायबरेली
सूचना
पेंशन अदालत पेंशन अदालत पेंशन अदालत
आधुनिक रेल डिब्बा कारखाना, रायबरेली के कार्मिक विभाग में दिनांक 15.12.2026 (मंगलवार) को पेंशन अदालत आयोजित की जा रही है।
आधुनिक रेल डिब्बा कारखाना, रायबरेली से सेवानिवृत्ति ऐसे कर्मचारी/अधिकारी जिन्हें समापन देयों के भुगतान से संबंधित कोई शिकायत है, तो पूरे विवरण सहित (अर्थात आवेदनकर्ता का पूरा नाम, कर्मचारी का अंतिम पद, पी.पी.ओ. सं., कर्मचारी सं., सेवानिवृत्ति/मृत्यु की तिथि, शिकायत का विवरण, वर्तमान पूरा पता देते हुए) दो प्रतियों में आवेदन पत्र बंद लिफाफा जिस पर "पेंशन अदालत–2026 के लिए" लिखा हो, दिनांक **07.12.2026** तक निम्न पते पर भेजें:–
"वरिष्ठ कार्मिक अधिकारी/कल्याण & वेतन
आधुनिक रेल डिब्बा कारखाना, रायबरेली लालगंज,
जिला: रायबरेली (उ.प्र.) पिनकोड–229120"
नोट:– उपरोक्त विज्ञप्ति एमसीएफ रायबरेली की वेबसाईट **https://mcf.indianrailways.gov.in Employee's Corner Pension Adalat** पर उपलब्ध है।
कृते महाप्रबंधक (कार्मिक)
ग्राहकों की सेवा में मुस्कान के साथ

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Const./Northern Railway, DRM Office, New Delhi-110001 invites EPC-tender under Single stage Two Packet System for the under noted work:-

1	Name of work and location	"Design, Supply, Erection, Testing, Commissioning of Laying of Cable for the connection of SP/SSP/ In NDLS-CPYZ Section of Delhi Division of Northern Railway for raising of speed to 160 Kmph.
2	Completion period of the work	12 Months
3	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 94,15,93,660.90/-
4	Bid Security amount (to be deposited Online as given in Tender)	Rs. 1,88,31,900/-
5	Date & Time of opening of tender	Tenders will be opened on or after 11.00 hrs on date 18.11.2026 on IREPS web site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**. The bidders can participate in the epc-tender.
6	Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document	The detailed e-tender notice and tender document is available on **www.ireps.gov.in**. Above tender document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS web site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** from 23.10.2026 to 13.11.2026. All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document. The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

Tender No.: 347-R/Dy.CEE/C/NDLS/2026-27/EPC Dated: 22.10.2026 3672/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लाट सं.–01, नॉलेजपार्क–IV, ग्रेटर नोएडा, गौतमबुद्ध नगर, उत्तर प्रदेश–201308
वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in, ई–मेल: authority@gnida.in
पत्रांक– अर्बन सर्विस/2026/917 दिनांक 22/10/2026
ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण की ओर से ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या: अर्बन सर्वि

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, राँची

अल्पकालीन ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना
(द्वितीय निविदा)
(प्रथम निविदा का PR No.- (388201)

टेन्डर रेफरेंन्स नं0–प0नि0वि0/राँची–35/2026–27 दिनांक :–21.10.2026

1.	कार्य का नाम	Surface Renewal of LPN Sahdeo Chowk to Booty more road (Total Length 7.90 KM) for the year 2026-27.
2.	अनुमानित प्राक्कलित राशि (रू0 लाख में)	रू0 1171.49377 लाख (रूपये ग्यारह करोड़ एकहत्तर लाख उनचास हजार तीन सौ सतहत्तर) मात्र।
3.	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0 लाख में)	रू0 11.72 लाख (रूपये ग्यारह लाख बहत्तर हजार) मात्र।
4.	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	06 (छः) माह
5.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाषन की तिथि	26.10.2026 10.30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
6.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि/ समय	12.11.2026 12.00 बजे दोपहर तक
7.	निविदा खोलने की तिथि/ समय	13.11.2026 12.30 बजे अपराह्न।
8.	निविदा प्रकाषित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता पथ निर्माण विभाग,पथ प्रमंडल, मोहराबादी, राँची–834008.
9.	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	0651–2361018
10.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	0651–2401010

• प्राक्कलित राशि एवं अग्रधन की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है, जिसे Tender Online Upload में देखा जा सकता है, एवं किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
• नियम एवं शर्तों के लिए वेबसाईट http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखें।

PR 392182 Road Construction Dept Road Division Ranchi (26-27) D"

कार्यपालक अभियंता
पथ निर्माण विभाग,पथ प्रमंडल, राँची

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

SOIL INVESTIGATION DIVISION, ADVANCE PLANNING, ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT, RANCHI
Nirupan Bhawan, 3rd Floor, Room No. 403, 56-Set, Doranda, Ranchi-834002

e-Procurement (Very Short Tender Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.-14/2026-27 (1stCall)
e-Tender Ref No:– RCD/SID/AP/RAN/14/2026-27 Date:- 21.10.2026

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for Construction of High level bridge over Damodar river in 16th km Dantu to Kathara Road under Bokaro district, Jharkhand including Approach Road, Land Acquisition proposal Ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Proposal, Forest Diversion Proposal and Proposal of Utility Shifting in details etc. as required by the department (if any) under Bokaro Distict in the State of Jharkhand *Empanelled consultant with RCD under categoryII vide letter No. 4073 (S) WE Dated 28.09.2026are allowed to Bid.
2	Tentative Length	337.00m
3	Period of Completion of Work	60 Days
4	Cost of Tender documents	Rs 5,000- (Five Thousand) only. Non refundable Fee.Tender fee will be recived through online mode only. The quotationers have to deposit a fixed amount of Rs 30,000 as Earnest Money. As per the Departmental Letter no.-4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit be received in online mode only through e-procurement (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facIity as per Standard Operating system Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no 120 dated 03.10.2023
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering(http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	24.10.2026,10:30 AM
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	31.10.2026 12:00PM
8	Last Date/Time of Submission of Tender Fee & EMD	31.10.2026 12:00PM
9	Date and Time of Bid opening	02.11.2026 12:30 PM
10	Bid validity	120 days
11	Bid Submission Address	Chief Engineer(Communication),Road Construction Department,1st Floor, Engineer Hostel No.-2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
12	Designation and Contact no. of Tender inviting Officer	Executive Engineer,Soil Investigation Division,Advance Planning, RCD, Ranchi Mob - 9905660677.

Note:- Only e-Tender shall be accepted. Sd/-
(Ravi Shankar Pravakar) Executive Engineer
Soil Investigation Division, Advance Planning,
PR 392189 Road (26-27)_D **Road Construction Department, Ranchi**

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

स्टेट एजेंसी फॉर कॉम्प्रिहेंसिव हेल्थ एण्ड इंटीग्रेटेड सर्विसेज

चतुर्थ तल, नवचेतना केन्द्र, 10, अशोक मार्ग, हजरतगंज, लखनऊ–226 001
द्वारा संचालित
आयुष्मान भारत–प्रधानमंत्री जन आरोग्य योजना अन्तर्गत
महाप्रबन्धक–आई0टी0

का एक पद प्रतिनियुक्ति के आधार पर रिक्त है, जिस पर चयन साक्षात्कार के माध्यम से किया जाना है।

योग्यताएँ:-
- Permanent Government employee working in a Government Department of Government of Uttar Pradesh will be eligible for posting on deputation basis with minimum of 7 years of experience in administrative work in public–sector programs.
- Full time regular M.Tech (CS/IT)/ MCA/BE (CS/IT)/B. Tech. (CS/IT) from a recognized institute/University.

इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी अपना बायोडाटा **uprsby@yahoo.co.in** पर मेल करें अथवा कार्यालय में सम्पर्क करें।

RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD

No. :- ACE-III/2026-27/206 Dated :- 16/10/2026

NIB : 06/2026-27

Bids for 1. Remetaling, Carpeting and new road work at Block-D, Block-G And Block-E At Mahala Scheme Jaipur 2. Construction of various compound boundary wall, drain work and park development work at mahala residental Scheme Jaipur 3. Bituminous Work at CHS Ramganj Mandi Distt. Kota 4. External Electrification, Street Light Work of EWS 49 No., LIG 214 No. and 102 No. MIG-A Houses and shifting of 11KV Line work at RHB Mahala Residential Scheme, RHB, Jaipur 5. Operation & Maintenance of street light and Hight mast light work at various sectors in Pratap Nagar , Jaipur (For One year) 6. Construction of RCC slab over fire stair case at AIS Residency Phase-I, sector 17, Pratap Nagar, Jaipur 7. Construction of scheme Boundary walls at Asnawar Distt. Jhalawar 8. Construction of WMM Roads, Raising & Strengthening of existing retaining wall pocket scheme at CHS Atru Distt. Baran are invited from interested bidders from 26.10.2026 (11.00 AM) to 16.11.2026 upto 6.00 PM. Other particular of bid may be visited on the procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in)** of the state & **https://rhb.rajasthan.gov.in** Department Website.

UBN No. :- RHB2627WSOB00194 to RHB2627WSOB00201

Raj.Samwad/C/26/12337 **Addl. Chief Engineer-III, Jaipur**

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.

OBRA-SONEBHADRA
E-Tender Notice

1. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8169945,** Deployment of expert persons (Graduate Engineer Ex-BHEL/NTPC having experience of minimum 10 years) for Third party inspection of quality of Boiler Pressure Part & Rotary Parts during overhauling of unit No. 10, 3x200MW, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD- Rs. 18,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 11.12 Lakhs (with GST), Last Date of Uploading Bid : 26.10.2026.
2. **Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8130374,** Cleaning & other related work of A CHP, Tender Cost: Rs. 0.00, EMD- Rs. 73,000.00, Amount:- Rs. 37,53,326.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 29.10.2026

For Information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit Website **https://etender.up.nic.in**

सं. 103/ज०स०का०/निविदा/ Dated: 22.10.2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

उत्तराखण्ड पावर कॉरपोरेशन लि.

(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)
कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)
18 ई०सी० रोड, देहरादून, दूरभाष नं०: 91–0135–2652916, Email Id:eddndn@yahoo.com

निविदा सूचना

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु उत्तराखण्ड शासन द्वारा प्रदत्त विद्युत कार्यों के लिए "क" श्रेणी के लाईसेन्स धारक, वैध जी.एस.टी., ई.पी.एफ., ई.एस.आई.सी. के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत, आयकर/पैन कार्ड धारक निविदादाताओं से मुहरबन्द निविदायें दो भागो में (प्रथम भाग में निविदा धरोहर धनराशि संबंधी घोषणा पत्र, नियम एवं शर्तें, उत्तराखण्ड विद्युत नियामक आयोग द्वारा निर्गत "ए" क्लास लाईसेंस की प्रतिलिपि, जी.एस.टी पंजीकरण, पैनकार्ड आदि एवं द्वितीय भाग में दरें जो कि निविदा खुलने की तिथि से कम से कम छः माह तक वैध हो) दिनांक 13.11.2026 को 14.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है जिसका प्रथम भाग उसी दिन 15.00 बजे उपस्थित निविदादाताओं अथवा उनके प्रतिनिधियों के सम्मुख अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा सार्वजनिक रूप से खोला जायेगा। प्रथम भाग के मूल्यांकन के बाद द्वितीय भाग खोला जायेगा। निविदा प्रपत्र किसी भी कार्य दिवस में वैध जी.एस.टी. धारक के द्वारा दिनांक 12.11.2026 (14:00 बजे) तक अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय से निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य नगद (अप्रतिदेय) जमा कर क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। बिना निविदा धरोहर धनराशि व अन्य संबधित घोषणा पत्र के निविदा भाग–2 नहीं खोली जायेंगी। निविदा खुलने की तिथि में अवकाश होने/अधोहस्ताक्षरी के मुख्यालय से बाहर होने पर अगले कार्य दिवस को निविदा खोली जाएगी। अधोहस्ताक्षरी को यह अधिकार होगा कि वह बिना कारण बताये समस्त अथवा किसी भी निविदा को निरस्त कर सकते हैं। विस्तृत नियम एवं शर्तें निविदा प्रपत्र में वर्णित हैं।

निविदा संख्या - 29/EDD(N)/2026-2027, Work - R&R work under EDSD Mussoorie, Under EDD(North), Dehradun की धरोहर राशि रू० 30,000.00, निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु० 590.00 G.S.T.Extra.

पत्रांक: 4705/वि०वि०ख०(उ०) अधिशासी अभियन्ता
दिनांक: 21.10.2026 विद्युत वितरण खण्ड (उत्तर)

किसी भी विद्युत समस्या के लिए संम्पर्क करें टोल फ्रि. नं. 18004190405
राष्ट्रहित में बिजली बचायें।

झारखण्ड सरकार
राजस्व, निबंधन एवं भूमि सुधार विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

सं0सं0–13/नि0वि0(विविध)–06/2025–441/नि0, रांची, दिनांक–16.10.2026

संस्था निबंधन अधिनियम, 1860 की धारा–4 एवं झारखण्ड संस्था निबंधन नियमावली, 2025 की धारा–8 तथा विभागीय जाँच पत्रक में दिए गए निर्देश के अन्तर्गत सभी निबंधित संस्थाओं को वर्ष में एक बार आम सभा की सहमति से वार्षिक अंकेक्षण प्रतिवेदन, क्रियाकलाप संबंधी प्रतिवेदन, कार्यकारिणी की अद्यतन सूची, संस्था में कार्यरत कर्मचारियों का ब्यौरा संबंधित प्रपत्र–'क' एवं राज्य सरकार, केन्द्र सरकार तथा विदेश से प्राप्त राशि से संबंधित प्रतिवेदन प्रपत्र–'ख' तथा अन्य दस्तावेज ऑनलाईन माध्यम से विभागीय वेबसाईट– https://enibandhan.jharkhand.gov.in/ में अपलोड की जानी है। इस निमित्त डाक से समर्पित किए गए प्रतिवेदन अस्वीकार्य है।

उक्त प्रतिवेदन अपलोड करने हेतु विभाग द्वारा संस्थाओं को दिनांक–10.06.2026 से दिनांक–30.06.2026 तक User ID एवं Password निर्गत किया जा रहा था। संबंधित समय–सीमा के समाप्ति के पश्चात कतिपय संस्थाओं द्वारा तय समय–सीमा में आवेदन नहीं किए जाने के स्थिति में पुनः अवसर प्रदान करने हेतु अनुरोध विभाग से किया जा रहा है।

उक्त आलोक में यथा निदेशित सभी निबंधित संस्थाओं को इस प्रेस विज्ञप्ति के माध्यम से सूचित किया जाता है कि विभाग से User ID एवं Password प्राप्त करने हेतु विभागीय वेबसाईट–https:// enibandhan.jharkhand.gov.in/ पर ऑनलाईन आवेदन आवश्यक रूप से **दिनांक–25.10.2026 से 30.11.2026 तक** समर्पित की जाए। उक्त तिथि के पश्चात User ID एवं Password विभाग द्वारा निर्गत नहीं किया जाएगा एवं संस्था द्वारा संबंधित प्रतिवेदन अपलोड नहीं किए जाने की स्थिति में अर्थदण्ड/निबंधन रद्दीकरण संबंधी कार्रवाई की जाएगी।

(अनिलसन लकड़ा)
PR 392164 Registration(26-27).D निबंधन महानिरीक्षक

BHAKRA BEAS MANAGEMENT BOARD

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Name of Office	NIT No. Name of Work	i) Document Downloading Start Date (Time)	Estimate Cost
Executive Bhakra Mechanical Division Nangal	NIT No. 82/BM/26 Overhauling Renovation of Elevator and 2500 lbs. capacity (23 A) & 8000 lbs. (17 A) installed at Bhakra Dam.	23.10.2026 at 09:00 Hrs ii) Pre-bid meeting Date (Time) 05.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs iii) Tender submission starts date (Time) 13.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs iv) Tender submission Closing Date (Time) 15.12.2026 at 15:00 Hrs v) Opening bid Date (Time) 16.12.2026 at 15:00 Hrs	Rs. 5,78,20,000/- Earnest Money Rs. 11,56,400/-

Note: Detailed tender invitation notice can be downloaded from BBMB Website **www.bbmb.gov.in & www.etenders.gov.in**. If there is a need for any extension in the due date, its corrigendum will be posted on the website itself.

331-PR-Board Sectt.-4 FOR YOUR BETTER TOMORROW SAVE ENERGY TODAY

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL, MEDICAL EDUCATION & TRAINING

2nd floor, Kisan Bazar, Vibhuti Khand, Gomtinagar - 226 010. UP

No. ME-3/2026/ 1858 Lucknow:Dated 22/10/2026

REVISED TIME-LINE FOR THE THIRD ROUND OF ONLINE COUNSELLING UNDER UP NEET MDS-2026

In continuation of the time-table issued by Medical Counseling Committee (MCC), New Delhi for counseling of NEET MDS course, the Revised time-table of third round of online counseling for admission of state quota seats of MDS course in Government/Private Dental Colleges/Universities of the State is as follows:-

S.No.	Description	Dates
1.	Date of online registration	22 October, 2026 (From 05:00 PM) to 27 October, 2026 (Till 11:00 AM)
2.	Date of depositing registration fee and security Fee	22 October, 2026 (From 05:00 PM) to 27 October, 2026 (Till 02:00 PM)
3.	Date of declaration of merit list	27 October, 2026
4.	Date of online choice filling	28 October, 2026 (From 11:00 AM) to 02 November, 2026 (Till 11:00 AM)
5.	Date of declaration of result of seat allotment	03 November, 2026
6.	downloading allotment letters and admission process	04 November, 2026 to 07 November, 2026

All information related to UP NEET MDS-2026 counseling will be uploaded on Departmental website **https://upneet.gov.in** and **www.dgme.up.gov.in**
Help Line Numbers-8189011696, 8189011697, 8189011698,8189011699, 8189011700
Timing-From 11:00 AM to Till 05:00 PM

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
AGRA CIRCLE, P.W.D AGRA

Notice inviting E-Tender

Letter No. : 6653 /14M-A.C/2026 **Date : 14.10.2026**

1. The Superintending Engineer Agra Circle, U.P.P.W.D. on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites the percentage rate bids online from the eligible and approved registered Contractors. As The work Comprises of specialized Road work, hence contractors bidding for this work must be registered in **Road work** with UP PWD. **Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 4 of the Instructions to Bidders to qualify for the award of the contract.**
2.

Sl. No	District	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)		Total Cost (Rs. in Lacs)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Document (in Rs.)	Time of Completion	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category of Contractor
			Construction Cost	Maintenance Cost (5 year)								
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
1	Agra	New Construction from Km-4 of Kundaul Kabis marg to Lalwara via Thar Karua Thar Durga.	79.53	1.99	81.52	6.08	Rs.2000.00 STC +300.00 TC+60.00 GST-2360.00	05-Months	Executive Engineer, Constretion Division-2, P.W.D., Agra	Superintending Engineer, Agra Circle, P.W.D., Agra	Chief Engineer, Agra Zone. P.W.D., Agra	A, B
2	Agra	New Construction of CATK Road (Mewali Dam) to Nagla Khokhlia and Shahpura.	96.00	6.40	102.40	7.12	Rs.2000.00 STC +300.00 TC+60.00 GST-2360.00	06-Months	Executive Engineer, Constretion Division-2, P.W.D., Agra	Superintending Engineer, Agra Circle, P.W.D., Agra	Chief Engineer, Agra Zone. P.W.D., Agra	A, B

3. Bid document with detailed terms and conditions will be available online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** and Prahari (**http://wms.upppwd.gov.in/Prahari**) From **26.10.2026 to 02.11.2026.** Bids must be submitted online only at e-tendering portal of **http://etender.up.nic.in** and Prahari App with all documents as per GO No 14/2020/879(1)/23-7/2020/176 (सा.) / 06 Dt 25-08-2020 on or before 12:00 Hours Dt. 02.11.2026. Technical Bid received online will be opened on 02.11.2026 at 12:30 Hours.
4. Government Order No.-86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 Public Works Section-7 dated 23 May, 2026 will remain effective.

(G.K. Varshney)
Executive Engineer
Constraction Division-2, P.W.D., Agra

UPID-258946 Dt. 21.10.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(R.K. Singh)
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
AGRA CIRCLE, PWD, AGRA

CSB Bank

Trusted Heritage Smart Future

PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/auction notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **02nd November 2026 at 10.30 AM.** The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discreation of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by public auction/e-auction, if the auction is not successful, and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrower/s for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No.of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 21.10.2026	Weight (grams)
1	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Anirudh Joshi	04561152	002	7,30,903.14	72.70
2	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Neelam	10252252	002	1,51,851.91	15.10
3	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Paras Ram Sharma	00598888	002	10,19,371.87	114.90
4	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Parvinder Kaur	10247114	001	4,97,273.84	50.20
5	Gautam Nagar	Babita Gautam	07649647	001	8,66,722.48	97.00
6	Gautam Nagar	Chetan Singh	07951069	001	55,665.55	8.50
7	Gautam Nagar	Mohini Devi Kashyap	05057548	003	1,77,101.02	34.50
8	Gautam Nagar	Priyanka Gupta	03436614	002	5,29,578.47	105.34
9	Karol Bagh	Chanchal	04283575	002	1,13,152.24	26.84
10	Palam	Ashok Sharma	08133001	001	3,85,015.59	83.82
11	Palam	Deepak	08162947	001	8,11,322.31	72.80
12	Palam	Gajender Singh	04951030	001	1,38,628.97	27.15
13	Palam	Harish Kumar	04192322	003	5,90,211.68	62.49
14	Palam	Natthu Ram	04242962	003	2,33,841.63	24.73
15	Palam	Pankaj Batra	08161720	001	8,17,461.47	76.70
16	Palam	Rajput Dayashankar	04500924	001	14,27,976.20	157.96
17	Palam	Sachin Kumar Sharma	08251609	001	8,29,988.62	76.18
18	Palam	Suman Singh	07968201	001	5,44,576.30	54.18
19	Janakapuri	Harmeet Singh	04687729	003	3,25,951.50	43.87
20	Janakapuri	Karishma	05007949	001	4,39,983.63	40.40
21	Janakapuri	Shikha Choudhary	10245753	001	6,08,309.20	68.92
22	Janakapuri	Soni .	04590998	001	2,01,017.20	21.74
23	Dwaraka	Ajay Kumar Shakya	04917293	001	5,17,988.36	44.50
24	Rohini Sector 7	Anushka Aggarwal	07321297	001	1,06,227.41	17.42
25	Rohini Sector 7	Mohd Irshad	10171249	002	10,61,188.48	98.23
26	Rohini Sector 7	Pawan Gupta	10244295	001	15,75,478.06	155.71
27	Rohini Sector 7	Sanjesh Kumar	04663682	002	1,73,123.01	28.29
28	Rohini Sector 7	Shalu	05057078	001	33,186.61	7.20
29	Shalimarbagh	Ashish	10248795	001	57,339.38	5.63
30	Shalimarbagh	Bal Kishan	10373697	001	3,42,760.03	29.00
31	Shalimarbagh	Brij Mohan Sonkar	04673004	001	62,955.18	6.36
32	Shalimarbagh	Dherya Manchanda	10306047	001	4,78,168.54	40.30
33	Shalimarbagh	Gautam	04669921	001	3,10,504.66	37.57
34	Shalimarbagh	Harichand Jain	10307535	001	3,57,199.51	34.13
35	Shalimarbagh	Ibrahim .	07897275	001	5,16,165.85	51.76
36	Shalimarbagh	Kavita .	10347431	001	6,03,167.58	56.41
37	Shalimarbagh	Minu .	10232967	001	2,18,535.51	23.40
38	Shalimarbagh	Mohammad Raqeeb	04565536	001	59,984.56	6.20
39	Shalimarbagh	Nidhi Bhola	10243601	001	13,73,844.95	174.01
40	Shalimarbagh	Nikhil Singhal	07823896	001	1,96,071.06	22.02
41	Shalimarbagh	Prakash Chandra	04511266	003	14,47,506.99	149.53
42	Shalimarbagh	Rakesh	10130152	002	1,95,225.08	18.78
43	Shalimarbagh	Reetu Sethi	04328410	001	8,56,002.85	93.03
44	Shalimarbagh	Rekha Gulia	10028147	002	13,02,751.89	198.44
45	Shalimarbagh	Samiksha Bhatia	04507832	001	7,77,429.92	75.83
46	Shalimarbagh	Sanjana Jindal	08167873	001	7,22,022.97	69.92
47	Shalimarbagh	Sisir Raul	05075591	001	1,76,356.13	17.70
48	Shalimarbagh	Tarun Chhabra	10258815	001	7,80,632.40	77.99
49	Shalimarbagh	Toni	04730406	001	1,08,688.00	10.00
50	Shalimarbagh	Vijay .	10245506	001	8,52,425.26	82.07
51	Shalimarbagh	Vikas Ahuja	04453519	001	38,100.80	4.50
52	Shalimarbagh	Yogesh Jain	08201517	002	6,94,135.29	61.75
53	Okhla	Ashwani Nasa	10254139	002	3,51,269.70	37.29
54	Okhla	Mohd Arif	10244286	001	2,04,623.89	21.65
55	Okhla	Nabin Kumar Shaw	04235743	003	3,93,419.13	57.29
56	Okhla	Prakash	10241429	001	65,941.28	6.84
57	Okhla	Shameem .	10246352	001	1,20,076.34	13.90
58	Okhla	Virendra	04456562	005	4,29,551.31	61.99
59	Patel Nagar	Manas Dass	10038063	002	13,85,683.15	217.97
60	Mayur Vihar-New Delhi	Joli Devi	10387989	001	8,21,605.22	75.44
61	Mayur Vihar-New Delhi	Renu Upadhyay	10089672	001	6,57,325.26	71.17
62	Mayur Vihar-New Delhi	Saurav .	10222714	001	4,55,764.75	44.34
63	Tilak Nagar, New Delhi	Farmaan Khan	08171106	001	8,42,837.93	88.73
64	Tilak Nagar, New Delhi	Gurneet Singh	07931135	002	9,14,435.07	92.87
65	Tilak Nagar, New Delhi	Meenu Maggon	10124476	002	64,92,447.77	709.78
66	Tilak Nagar, New Delhi	Monika Marwah	10098776	001	8,40,565.73	78.08
67	Tilak Nagar, New Delhi	Priyanka Tandon	10256982	001	8,19,463.07	82.21
68	Dilshad Garden	Aqsa Naz	10018733	001	6,14,003.32	66.70
69	Dilshad Garden	Asif	04688168	001	4,26,715.18	49.28
70	Dilshad Garden	Jinat	10043241	001	90,612.88	16.10
71	Dilshad Garden	Manisha	10256814	001	2,12,144.61	21.81
72	Dilshad Garden	Mohd Arbaaz	10040107	001	1,88,004.17	21.60
73	Dilshad Garden	Mohd Aslam	10243580	001	1,92,704.36	20.00
74	Dilshad Garden	Nisha	10041411	001	43,887.64	8.45
75	Dilshad Garden	Pooja Rani	04750006	001	5,29,165.58	54.05
76	Dilshad Garden	Raju Mahadeorao Raut	10049997	001	54,509.98	13.40
77	Dilshad Garden	Riya Goswami	05052596	001	2,11,876.53	34.70
78	Dilshad Garden	Rohit	08169545	001	7,54,151.85	73.99
79	Dilshad Garden	Tamjid Banoo	04594480	001	73,390.15	13.80
80	Rajouri Garden	Anu Aggarwal	08202821	001	5,13,928.42	49.76
81	Rajouri Garden	Gunjan Gulati	10230675	002	7,56,765.25	69.12
82	Rajouri Garden	Karishma	05007949	001	3,93,925.48	35.00
83	Rajouri Garden	Kashish Grover	10255761	001	2,52,448.35	25.70
84	Rajouri Garden	Puneet Kumar	10098661	001	7,09,645.68	59.86
85	Rajouri Garden	Pushpa	07577163	002	2,01,857.56	27.10
86	Rajouri Garden	Updesh Kumar	04895567	001	3,73,986.39	37.35
87	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Himanshu	10179336	001	7,25,261.96	62.30
88	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Mohit Sharma	10051866	001	8,09,303.91	71.02
89	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Ritesh Sarvang	10173704	001	2,90,105.11	27.49
90	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Sudhir Kumar	10251022	002	10,83,254.19	110.80
91	Narela	Ajay Kumar	10259059	002	61,637.70	8.47
92	Narela	Arvind Kumar	07642167	001	1,98,913.05	19.40
93	Narela	Ashok Kumar Jha	10254196	001	1,48,784.15	19.32
94	Narela	Hardev Chaudhary	04611405	001	1,21,901.06	31.94
95	Narela	Jitender	07960504	002	11,96,634.03	116.67
96	Narela	Mahesh	10055657	001	56,776.63	7.23
97	Narela	Manoj Kumar	10005880	002	25,84,433.81	258.73
98	Narela	Narender	07501050	002	10,13,429.97	157.50
99	Narela	Pooja	04768252	001	1,03,265.28	23.72
100	Narela	Rani	10261727	001	69,001.43	6.97
101	Narela	Ravi Kumar	04582027	003	16,73,250.64	182.86
102	Narela	Tek Ram	07979893	001	5,04,192.30	68.71
103	Narela	Vishal Bareja	07707652	001	86,347.82	8.28
104	Bhajanpura-New Delhi	Manish Gupta	10059826	001	2,13,969.47	32.82
105	Bhajanpura-New Delhi	Shikha .	08130461	001	1,15,897.90	27.82
106	Tri Nagar, New Delhi	Nazma .	08143568	001	3,21,648.00	34.25
107	Shyam Nagar-New Delhi	Guljar Hussain	04584309	001	27,092.75	6.37
108	Shyam Nagar-New Delhi	Puspa	04577702	001	32,790.69	8.18
109	Laxmi Nagar	Amit Gupta	10086527	001	1,97,340.29	19.57
110	Laxmi Nagar	Mohd Iftikar	10017918	001	10,39,561.14	153.59
111	Laxmi Nagar	Rajesh Ranjan	04976965	001	2,74,593.89	27.45
112	Paschim Vihar	Manoj Singh	10252167	001	2,61,456.65	24.66
113	Paschim Vihar	Monika .	10310403	001	7,08,966.28	64.03
114	Kalkaji	Maanya Madan	08207073	001	2,65,029.04	38.60
115	Kalkaji	Sheema Devi	10244011	001	2,35,989.78	27.60
116	Kalkaji	Usha Jha	10055811	001	86,241.69	12.00
117	Kalkaji	Yogendra Kumar Yadav	10071814	001	1,72,286.79	18.80
118	Saraswati Vihar-Pitampura	Jarina	10260673	001	1,07,414.22	10.95
119	Saraswati Vihar-Pitampura	Shyam Kohli	08353147	001	3,98,655.22	37.75
120	Punjabi Bagh-New Delhi	Anupma Arora	04864832	001	5,43,710.84	53.00
121	Punjabi Bagh-New Delhi	Harichand Jain	10307535	001	4,37,705.30	40.00
122	Punjabi Bagh-New Delhi	Manish Arora	10135759	001	6,33,566.72	58.29
123	Model Town-New Delhi	Firoja	10244218	001	61,470.18	6.80
124	Model Town-New Delhi	Mahesh Kumar	10236598	001	66,615.23	6.98
125	Kamla Nagar-New Delhi	Sonam	10030340	001	2,94,506.47	38.02

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• TECHNOLOGY

PHP2Shell: The flaws that forced websites to shut down worldwide

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, October 22

WEBSITES WORLDWIDE — including services operated by Japan's Finance Ministry, the Port of Rotterdam in the Netherlands, and the Wikimedia Foundation — went offline on Wednesday. The precautionary shutdowns came as governments and cybersecurity agencies scrambled to address two critical vulnerabilities in PHP, one of the most widely used programming languages on the internet. The flaws have collectively been dubbed PHP2Shell.

The developers of PHP have since released security updates addressing both vulnerabilities. Google-owned security company Wiz said its researchers had discovered the flaws in PHP using AI tools. OpenAI said security firm Calif had discovered one of the vulnerabilities using an OpenAI model. The researchers coordinated with PHP's developers to address the flaws.

First, what is PHP?

PHP, short for Hypertext Preprocessor, is an open-source programming language that runs behind the scenes on roughly 70% of websites whose server-side language is identifiable. It helps websites process information — log-ins, application submissions, or online purchases. PHP is free to use and maintained by volunteers. WordPress, which runs over 40% of sites globally, is powered by PHP.

What is PHP2Shell, and why is it dangerous?

PHP2Shell is the name given to two critical vulnerabilities in PHP that could allow attackers to remotely execute malicious code on affected web servers without logging in, or access sensitive information stored in the server's memory. Cybersecurity researchers flagged the following two vulnerabilities:

1. MEMORY PROBLEM: Take the example of someone uploading their CV to a job portal, PHP may process the file and information. If an error interrupts that process and PHP treats incomplete information as valid, it could create a security vulnerability that an attacker could exploit.

2. LEFTOVER INFORMATION: Imagine two people using the same job portal, one after another. If the server uses information left over from the first person's request while processing the second person's, it could end up handling the second request incorrectly. An attacker could exploit this confusion to interfere with the server's operations.

Both vulnerabilities pose security risks even without the involvement of AI, which could result in quicker exploits. Crucially, attackers may not always need an account or physical access to a server. They could send a malicious request over the internet and make the server execute instructions. This could put personal information, uploaded documents or login credentials at risk.

Why did websites go offline?

Since the vulnerabilities could allow outside attackers to take control of affected servers, cybersecurity agencies advised site operators to install fixes immediately. Where that was not possible, temporarily taking websites offline was a precaution against attacks.

Updating PHP is not straightforward. Many small sites are run by owners on shared hosting platforms where they do not control the server or know who maintains the PHP. "The immediate challenge is not simply installing a patch, but finding and managing every instance where PHP is running," said Don Smith, Vice-President of Threat Intelligence at cybersecurity firm Sophos' Counter Threat Unit, in comments shared with *The Indian Express*.

Chris Yule, Senior Director of Threat Research at Sophos Counter Threat Unit, pointed to another challenge: older systems and devices that can't easily be updated or replaced. "Appliances... can be a black box within an organization's environment, with limited visibility into patch levels and software versions... organizations often depend on the vendor for an update," he told *The Indian Express*.

A.I.: FRIEND OR FOE?

- AI tools helped Wiz researchers speed up their investigation of the flaws.
- Conversely, AI could also help attackers to speed up their exploits of such flaws. This would leave companies with little time to respond.

• ECONOMY

Venezuelan oil imports: US push & India's limits

Marco Rubio wants India to import much more Venezuelan oil, especially via RIL. But technical and economic factors mean it cannot supplant Russian crude



SUKALP SHARMA

THE US wants India to buy more Venezuelan oil, particularly through Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL), which runs the world's largest single-location refining complex in Gujarat's Jamnagar. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio visited the Jamnagar complex on Wednesday, and one of the items on the agenda of his meeting with the RIL top brass was expanding India's — and RIL's — imports of Venezuelan oil, which is now under US oversight.

Ahead of his Jamnagar visit, Rubio said Tuesday that India is a "refining superpower", and pitched for an increase in oil imports from the Western Hemisphere, particularly Venezuela, as New Delhi continues to diversify its energy sourcing portfolio. RIL's twin-refinery complex is among the most complex in the world, which means that it is equipped to process the extremely "heavy" Venezuelan crude. A few other Indian refineries can also handle Caracas's highly viscous oil.

"Venezuela... is going to be rapidly increasing the production of oil and crude, heavy crude, which can only be refined in certain parts of the world. One of those places is the Gulf Coast of the US. But one of the few other places in the world that can actually refine Venezuelan heavy crude is India, and Reliance," Rubio told *The Indian Express* in an interview.

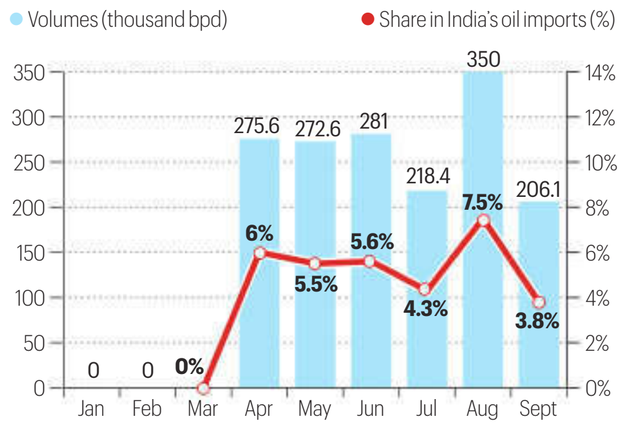
But translating the US wish into a substantial and sustained increase in oil purchases from Venezuela isn't that simple. For Washington, directing Venezuelan oil towards buyers such as India could help establish a market for it after years of sanctions. But for New Delhi and its refiners, oil purchases are primarily a commercial decision shaped by price, quality, freight, payment arrangements and supply reliability.

There are limits to just how much Venezuelan crude India can import and process. While India is among the world's third-largest oil importer, it can't simply substitute a substantial chunk of its import slate with Venezuelan crude. Moreover, India is already a top destination for Caracas's oil outside of the US, so how much more it can increase those flows appears limited from a technical standpoint, according to industry watchers and experts.

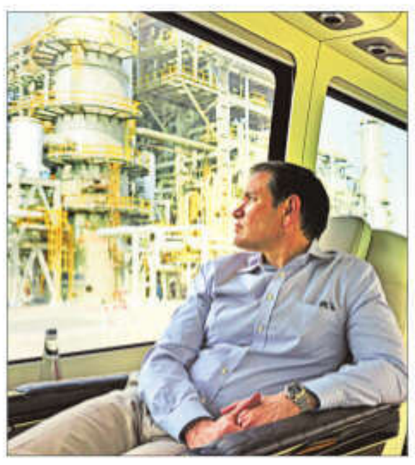
The US also wants India to reduce oil purchases from Russia — its largest source of crude — but experts cautioned that New Delhi shouldn't allow a coupling of Washington's two wishes.

A SMALL SHARE IN INDIA'S CRUDE BASKET

India resumed Venezuelan oil imports after US eased curbs



SOURCE: KPLER; NOTE: BPD REFERS TO BARRELS PER DAY



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio at RIL's Jamnagar facility. PTI

Techno-commercial limits

There is room for Venezuelan crude to gain a larger place in India's oil import basket, particularly at RIL's Jamnagar complex, which has a combined crude-processing capacity of around 1.4 million barrels per day (bpd). Some purchases by other refiners like Indian Oil, Hindustan Petroleum, and Nayara Energy could broaden that market to some extent. But Venezuelan crude is unlikely to be suitable for a large chunk of India's refining capacity, and even RIL's technical capability doesn't mean it can buy unlimited quantities.

"There are two major challenges to increasing Venezuelan crude imports: refining capacity and price competitiveness. Venezuela's flagship Merey grade is extremely heavy and highly sulphurous. This makes Reliance's sophisticated Jamnagar refining complex particularly well suited to processing it, but also limits the number of Indian facilities capable of handling large volumes," Abu Dhabi-based energy analyst Natalia Katona told *The Indian Express*.

"The economics is another obstacle. Although Merey is offered at a substantial discount of around $25 per barrel to (benchmark crude) Brent, freight to India's west coast currently costs approximately $35 barrel. That effectively turns the discount into a landed premium...And with freight this expensive, transporting Venezuelan crude on vessels smaller than VLCCs (very large crude carriers) is hardly economical," she said.

Expectation and reality

For Washington, directing Venezuelan oil towards buyers such as India could help establish a market for it after years of sanctions.

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But for New Delhi and its refiners, oil purchases are primarily a commercial decision shaped by price, quality, freight, payment arrangements and supply reliability.

Also, India has already substantially increased its Venezuelan purchases since the West Asia crisis began, from virtually zero beforehand to a peak of 3,50,000 bpd in August, before easing to around 2,00,000 bpd in September (*see chart*). Katona said there is already meaningful diversification underway, and the scope for increases in imports from Venezuela is constrained by infrastructure and economics.

"With diversification already underway, Rubio's proposal raises a basic question: what additional commitments does Washington want, and what would Indian refiners gain?" think tank Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) said in a report on Wednesday. "Reliance's dominance in India's Venezuelan crude purchases explains Washington's focus on the company. India imported Venezuelan crude worth $3,585.6 million during April–August 2026, with Reliance accounting for 74.3%...Other imports comprised $421.3 million through Indian Oil's Paradip facility, representing 11.7%; $405.8 million through Mundra's storage terminals operated by HPCL and others, accounting for 11.3%; and $95 million through Nayara Energy's Vadinar facility, representing 2.7%," it added.

It is also worth noting that oil supplies from West Asia are also gradually returning to the market, including heavier crude grades from Iraq, which have the benefit of a much shorter and cheaper shipping route. According to Katona, this is likely to make the competition difficult for Venezuelan barrels. A discounted barrel may look attractive on paper, but the advantage can diminish if freight, insurance, financing or processing costs are high compared to barrels of similar quality available in nearby geographies.

Russian supplies still key

Rubio's pitch for Venezuelan oil reflects a convergence of American geopolitical priorities and India's search for alternative oil supplies. Washington wants a larger market for Venezuelan crude and hopes India's massive refining capacity can help absorb growing production. India, meanwhile, wants more options as it navigates American pressure over its hefty imports of Russian crude and uncertainty in supplies from the Gulf.

Venezuelan oil can't replace the large Russian oil volumes for India, and experts and analysts caution that its role is likely to remain only supplementary. Russia's flagship crude Urals is quite different from Venezuela's Merey, and is more suited to India's broader refining infrastructure. Commercial terms also differ considerably. Moreover, India's effort to diversify sources of crude is much wider, with its crude slate having over 40 supplying countries, although the top five-six suppliers —led by Russia — account for a massive chunk of the supplies.

According to experts, New Delhi shouldn't allow Washington to link its desire for higher Venezuelan oil imports by India with its wish that New Delhi pivots away from Moscow's crude. GTRI said that India must draw a clear distinction between importing more Venezuelan crude and moving away from Russian supplies.

"The US position on Russian oil has become increasingly flexible, largely because of the global supply crisis. Washington has just waived potential tariffs of up to 100% on major Russian energy buyers, including India, while simultaneously encouraging greater purchases of Venezuelan crude. To me, this suggests that keeping oil flowing and preventing another price shock have become more immediate priorities than restricting Russian exports,"said Katona.

The waiver from Washington comes ahead of the midterm elections in the US next month. Had the new law taken effect and led to a major reduction in Russian crude flows, already elevated energy prices would have risen further, including in the US, potentially hitting the Republican Party's prospects.

• CULTURE

Minus-one, plus-one and zero-track: The secret life of 'live' music

Suanshu Khurana
New Delhi, October 22

AFTER DALER Mehndi's performance at a Navratri event in Tehri Garhwal in Uttarakhand led to controversy, Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami Thursday said the state respects all artistes and he would meet Mehndi and his brother Mika Singh.

Mika Singh and other artistes had rallied behind Mehndi after state cabinet minister Subodh Uniyal interrupted his performance, alleging he was drunk on state and not singing well despite charging a heavy amount. Uniyal had also questioned why the songs were playing through a "mixer" instead of Mehndi singing live.

Mika Singh said his brother has been unwell and doesn't drink alcohol. Alisha Chinai, the '90s popstar, pointed out that using minus-one tracks is standard in many live performances today.

What is minus-one and plus-one in live music?

Minus-one is a backing track with complete orchestration, with the lead vocals removed so that a live singer can perform over the instruments. It is like a karaoke track. Ad-libs and backing vocals may or may not remain on the track, depending on the arrangement.

This is commonly used in concerts all over the world and is done to minimise technical glitches. While more regular at pop concerts, it is frowned upon at rock concerts, where zero-track — a completely live and raw performance with live orchestration — is the expectation. Some playback singers in India who almost always sing live during their concerts include Shreya Ghoshal, Sunidhi Chauhan, Sonu Nigam and Arijit Singh. A lot of independent artistes also mostly still sing on zero-track.

A plus-one track is the one that includes pre-recorded vocals and orchestration. It is usually pre-recorded, sometimes specifically for a concert, in a controlled environment. This creates the impression of an artiste singing live even when they aren't. In the case of plus-one, an artiste could lip-sync or sing along.

Not playing it by ear

- There are too many variables at play in live singing, such as the weather, the noise around, and the artiste's health.
- Production companies choose plus-one over live so that nothing goes wrong. Often, recordings are made specifically before live concerts even if the artiste plans to be completely live, so that unforeseen circumstances can be managed.

Why are plus-one and minus-one used in live concerts?

There are too many variables at play in live singing, such as the weather, the noise around, and the health of the artiste. Production companies often choose plus-one over live so that nothing goes wrong. Often, recordings are made specifically before live concerts even if the artiste plans to be completely live, so that unforeseen circumstances can be managed.

This is especially done in case of Olympic ceremonies or any huge stadium show and award show, to allow high-energy performers to achieve vigorous choreography or sustain long concerts without the audio quality dropping.

The flip side is that in minus one, if you miss your cue, there's no taking it up again unless one catches the track midway. This makes timing and cues very important.

What are some lip-sync scandals that made history?

The most significant is from 1990, when German pop duo Milli Vanilli was stripped of its Grammy after it was revealed that the artistes, Fab Morvan and Rob Pilatus, were not the actual singers on their own debut album. The songs were actually sung by session artists. A live show malfunction contributed to the truth coming out.

Ashlee Simpson's lip-sync on *Saturday Night Live* in 2004 remains one of the more infamous episodes. It became a live TV embarrassment: A song she had just performed (*Pieces of Me*) began playing again as she was to sing another song (*Autobiography*). Simpson did an awkward dance and went off the stage.

Another incident that was talked about was Beyoncé's rendition of the US national anthem, *The Star-Spangled Banner*, at Barack Obama's second presidential inauguration. Beyoncé lip-synced a pre-recorded version because she had not rehearsed it with the orchestra and did not want to risk a flawed performance of a song that's notoriously difficult to sing. She sang the anthem live without any instruments at the Super Bowl press conference 10 days later, famously showcasing her vocal prowess.

• HISTORY

West Asia to west coast: How the Jewish community made a home in Keralam

Abhinav Chakraborty
New Delhi, October 22

TWO RECENT incidents in Keralam's Kochi — attempted arson near the Kadavumbhagam Synagogue and a fire at Fort Kochi's heritage Koder House — have brought the state's Jewish community into focus. At its peak in the 1950s, the community numbered nearly 2,400; today, only a handful remain in the state.

Their arrival

Different narratives exist about when the Jewish people first arrived in Keralam.

The region's unique geography — sandwiched between the Arabian Sea and the Western Ghats — made it ideal for growing spices. High demand in ancient times meant that trade flourished, particularly in the Malabar region. This thriving spice trade drew the Jews to Keralam from West Asia.

"One narrative holds that they were part of the fleet of King Solomon (r. 970-931 BCE), which is believed to have brought materials from South India to build his temple. Items like ivory, gold, and peacocks mentioned in the Hebrew Bible have Dravidian linguistic origins. Some of his fleet may have settled on the Malabar coast," Professor Shalva Weil, senior researcher at the Seymour Fox School of Education, Hebrew University of Jerusalem, told *The Indian Express*.

The earliest tangible documentary evidence comes from the famous copper plates dated around 1000 CE, Weil said. Gifted to Joseph Rabban, the leader of the Jews, by King Bhaskara Ravi Varma of Cranganore (present-day Kodungallur), they conferred 72 royal privileges for "as long as the sun and the moon endure". They also granted land around a village called Anjuvannam, where Keralam's first recorded Jewish settlement was established. Anjuvannam came to be known as "Jerusalem of the East".

But the floods of 1341 affected the ancient port town of Kodungallur and caused heavy silting. Cochin (now Kochi) emerged as the most accessible port on the coast, compelling the royal family to shift base. Many Jews followed suit.

Then came in-fighting. What began as a property dispute between descendants of Rabban later divided the community. The subsequent resettlement saw the community gaining the name "Cochin Jews".



ABHINAV CHAKRABORTY

The Paradesi synagogue in Mattancherry.

The different communities

The Jews of Keralam identified themselves based on their proclaimed origins. Broadly, they are divided into the Malabari or "black" Jews and the Paradesi or "white" Jews. The Malabari Jews descended from Jews who arrived from West Asia and married among the natives.

According to Weil, the Malabaris favour the "biblical narrative" of arriving as part of King Solomon's fleet. The Paradesis (from *paradesi*, meaning foreigner) considered themselves of "pure" European blood and refused to mix with the indigenous peoples. In her book *The Last Jews of Kerala* (2008), British writer Edna Fernandes noted: "The Paradesis claimed they had never been polluted by non-Jewish blood... and sought to distance themselves in order to win a higher place in the caste-based society of Cochin."

The Malabar Jews presently have synagogues in Ernakulam, Fort Kochi's Mattancherry, Chendamangalam, Paravur, and Mala, while the Paradesis have only one in Mattancherry's Jewish quarter or "Jew Town". Established in 1568, it remains the oldest active synagogue in the Commonwealth of Nations. Some synagogues have been preserved as heritage museum sites under the Archaeological Survey of India.

Legacy that outlives migration

Historical accounts suggest local rulers were quite welcoming to the early Jews. Kings granted them tracts of land near palaces and the freedom to practise their faith. "For instance, the Paradesi Synagogue's clock tower points directly towards the Maharaja's Palace, reflecting the protection provided by local rulers. Relations were exceptionally good between the Jews and their neighbours, including Muslims," Weil said.

But the colonial period has a mixed record, especially the Portuguese rule (1503-1663). "The Portuguese set up an Inquisition in Goa as well as an Inquisition in Cochin. Conversos (Jews who had converted to Catholicism but maintained Jewish practices) were persecuted by the Portuguese in Cochin itself. Many Jews fled," Weil said. The Inquisition was a judicial system of the Roman Catholic Church, institutionalised between the 15th and 17th centuries to punish people who didn't agree with its beliefs.

Conditions improved under the subsequent colonisers, according to Weil. Come 1948, Cochin Jews viewed the declaration of the State of Israel as the "fulfilment of their prayers". Malabari Jews undertook "aliyah" — immigration to Israel — in 1954 and settled in agricultural communities.

In later years, the "Jew Town" in Mattancherry gained an outsized reputation, especially among tourists. In 1968, the Paradesi Synagogue marked its quatercentenary celebrations, attended by then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi.

Though the community continued to migrate abroad, the symbols of Jewish heritage came to persist. Prominent Cochin Jews include Keith Hallegua, the lone Paradesi Jew in Mattancherry, and Elias Joseph, the last Malabari Jew in Ernakulam, also the caretaker of the Kadavumbhagam Synagogue. Despite their dwindling numbers, the community has left a lasting imprint on Keralam's society and culture.

SAUDI-LED COALITION SAYS IT INTERCEPTED DRONES OVER RIYADH AND HOLY CITY OF MEDINA

Houthis claim attacks on Saudi defence ministry as US tells diplomats to leave

Aramco tells its staff to evacuate Dhahran HQ

Ismaeel Naar
Dubai, October 22

AT LEAST two people were killed in a strike by the Iran-backed Houthi militia on a major airport in Saudi Arabia on Wednesday evening, as Washington ordered some US diplomatic staff to leave the kingdom following weeks of deadly attacks.

The Saudi authorities said in a statement on Thursday morning that a Saudi national and an Indian resident died in the strike on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam, a city in Saudi Arabia's Eastern Province that is home to the state oil giant Saudi Aramco.

Eight other people were wounded, the statement said, adding that the airport was operating normally on Thursday.

A spokesman for Yemen's Houthis, Yahya Saree, said on Thursday that the militia had targeted Dammam's airport.

He also said, in the same statement, that the Houthis had targeted the Saudi defence ministry in the capital, Riyadh, along with an Aramco site in Yanbu, and an airport in the southern city of Abha. The Saudi authorities have not commented on those claims.



An actor portraying US President Donald Trump sits behind bars in a billboard installation resembling a prison cell in Tajrish Square in Tehran on Thursday. AP

In a separate incident, two people were killed and two others were wounded on Wednesday when a drone was intercepted over Aramco's Shaybah oil field, also in the Eastern Province. Falling drone fragments sparked a fire in a contractor's vehicle, killing a Filipino and a Nepali, the Saudi Energy Ministry said.

Saudi Aramco staff were instructed to leave the company's headquarters building in Dhahran and to work remotely on Thursday, according to two people familiar with the situation who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak for the company.

Aramco did not respond to a request for comment and the Saudi energy ministry referred questions to Aramco. The Saudi-led coalition said on Thursday it had intercepted drones over Riyadh and Islam's holy city of Medina, which is near Yanbu.

Saudi Arabia announced a bombing campaign against the Houthis this month in support of the internationally recognized government of Yemen, which has been at war with the Houthis since 2014.

As the fighting has spilled onto Saudi soil, the United States ordered all "non-emergency government employees and their family members" to leave Saudi Arabia, a State Department spokesman, Tommy Pigott, said in social media post on Wednesday night that cited the Houthis' attacks, mounting civilian casualties and travel disruptions. NYT

US and Israel draw up plans for fresh strikes on Iran after elections

New York Times
October 22

THE US and Israeli militaries have developed specific plans for renewed strikes against Iran after the American midterm elections, according to US officials and other people briefed on the deliberations.

As planning for a short but intensive operation progresses, the US and Israeli militaries have stepped up exercises, flying planes over Iraq to practice strike maneuvers. Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth met with PM Benjamin Netanyahu in Israel this week to discuss new strikes, US officials said.

The targets would likely include Iran's energy infrastructure, nuclear facilities, and missile and drone arsenal. Some officials say one more big round of attacks could push Iran's economy over the brink and force the country to make diplomatic concessions after nearly eight months of conflict.

Still, there are reasons to be skeptical that a renewed war would be any more successful than the first phase of intense US-Israeli strikes between February and April. Those rounds of fighting drove up energy prices and inflation around the world, eroded security in West Asia and severely strained the Pentagon's supply of missile interceptors.

It is also far from certain Trump will approve fresh strikes. Repeatedly this year he has vetoed plans for a return to major combat operations, including this month when the US and Israeli militaries were nearly ready to attack. Iranian officials have promised to retaliate this time by expanding their targets beyond commercial ships and energy infrastructure in the region to data centers and underwater internet cables.

They say the fighting will neither be quick nor limited.

While US is assembling a massive arsenal that will be fully in place by November, diplomatic efforts have continued, as US negotiators use potential return to war as leverage with Iran to make progress on demands on its nuclear program and control over Strait of Hormuz.

Millions of hacking attempts as govts, companies rush to patch PHP flaws

Not seen anything like it in a long time, says Microsoft CEO

Reuters
Tokyo, Beijing, October 22

COMPANIES AND governments worldwide rushed on Thursday to patch critical flaws in the widely used PHP programming language, as a cybersecurity company reported millions of hacking attempts after the vulnerabilities were disclosed.

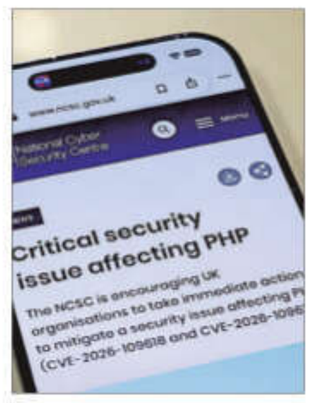
The push came after governments in Europe and elsewhere took websites offline as a precaution on Wednesday while website operators scrambled to secure systems running the software.

The emergency shutdowns of banking, airline, rail, tax and government services from Tokyo to Helsinki showed how much public and corporate systems rely on the software, and how hard it is to fix such flaws quickly once they are made public.

"It was a long day and a long night, I know for all the IT and security folks ... I've not seen anything like this in a long, long time," Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella said at a company event in Cologne, Germany, Thursday.

He said the episode underscored the importance of building digital systems that can be maintained securely.

PHP developers released urgent fixes on Wednesday for vulnerabilities that had lurked in the software for years until they were uncovered using AI, urging users to "update immediately".



The National Cyber Security Centre website is displayed on a smartphone in London. REUTERS

"Details of these flaws became public before fixes were ready, and attacks have since been reported," said Madeline Lawrence, co-founder of Belgian cybersecurity firm Aikido Security. "So companies are racing to update against attackers who can use AI to exploit them. That's the whole race."

As companies and governments deployed patches and suspended websites as a precaution, hacking attempts surged into the millions, according to cloud services firm Cloudflare.

"In the 10 hours before it was publicly announced, across the network we saw thousands of attempts to exploit it," Cloudflare CEO Matthew Prince said in a post on X late on Wednesday. "That jumped to tens of thousands in the 45 minutes post announcement, hundreds of thousands within 2 hours, and millions now."

Iran trying to drive up oil prices before midterm polls: Trump

Reuters
October 22

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Thursday that Iran was doing all it could to drive up the price of oil before the US midterm elections.

"They are even making up fake hits, mines, and everything else because more oil is coming through the Hormuz Strait now than it did even prior to the beginning of the conflict," Trump said in a post on Truth Social.

Oil prices climbed about 2 per cent to a five-month high on Thursday after Houthi attacks in Saudi Arabia stoked concerns of further disruption.

Meanwhile, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio expressed appreciation for Qatar's continued efforts to mediate the conflict in West Asia in a call with Qatari Prime Minister Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani, the State Department said on Thursday. He also reaffirmed the United States' commitment to Qatar's security and freedom of navigation through the Strait.

7 oil tankers attacked in Strait, says Tehran

Associated Press
Tel Aviv, October 22

SEVEN OIL tankers caught fire or were damaged in the Strait of Hormuz overnight after being hit by Iran or striking naval mines, Tehran said Thursday, a markedly high number as tensions rise over concerns about a return to all-out war.

With days before a close election in Israel in which Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu could lose power, and before next month's US midterm election in which war-linked high prices have sparked voter anger, there are concerns that US-Israeli attacks on Iran could resume.



Iran Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi

"Netanyahu wants to attack Iran, that's not even a question," Danny Citrinowicz, a researcher at Israel's Institute for National Security Studies and a former Iran specialist in Israel's military and intelligence services, told *The Associated Press*.

Iranian state television reported the claims about the latest attacks on ships, which the AP couldn't independently confirm. The report cited the Revolutionary Guard Corps navy, which again threatened to strike US military bases in the region if the US keeps helping to guide commercial ships through the strait.

The report didn't mention casualties. Iran still asserts control over the waterway, a central point of leverage in any talks with the US over the war.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on Wednesday said that a wary Tehran remains open to diplomacy, but is ready to defend itself.

In recent days, Tehran has indicated that it could expand targets to include infrastructure such as undersea cables and data centres.

• BRIEFLY

MYANMAR

Aung San Suu Kyi speaks to son for the first time in over 5 years



Suu Kyi talks on phone with her son Kim Aris.

THE SON of Myanmar's detained former leader Aung San Suu Kyi said on Thursday that he had spoken with his mother for the first time in over five years while she remains under house arrest. Kim Aris, who for years had only received sporadic, second-hand updates about his 81-year-old mother, said he had spoken directly with Suu Kyi. A spokesperson for Myanmar's military-backed president said on social media that Aris had spoken with Suu Kyi by telephone through Myanmar's embassy in London, sharing separate photographs of the pair. Suu Kyi, a Nobel Peace Prize winner, has been detained since February 2021. REUTERS

FRANCE

First human case of Shamonda virus reported

FRANCE REPORTED Thursday first human case of the Shamonda virus usually found in livestock in a patient who later died, with authorities adding there was no risk to the general population at this stage. It is suspected the victim was bitten by a midge carrying the virus in eastern France where it had circulated among animals, the government said. REUTERS

SOUTH AFRICA

Police probe killing of foreign national by crowd

SOUTH AFRICAN police said on Thursday they were probing killing of a foreign national by a crowd of about 50 in the city of Durban. A group of people had been marching in central Durban when two men appeared to break away and approach the victim, after which he was assaulted by about 50 people, the South African police said in a statement on X. REUTERS

Russia and Ukraine trade strikes amid push to revive peace talks

Reuters
Kyiv, Moscow, October 22

RUSSIA POUNDED Kyiv with ballistic missiles and Ukraine sent hundreds of drones towards Moscow overnight as the warring sides kept up a barrage of attacks despite the latest US push to end the conflict.

Russia said on Wednesday it was ready to resume US-mediated talks with Ukraine next month, after President Vladimir Putin hosted US envoy Steve Witkoff for talks in St Petersburg.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he hoped negotiations, which would be the first since February, would take place early in November.

Ukraine said Russia fired at least 21 ballistic missiles in three waves. Russia said Ukraine launched 630 drones towards Moscow during the night.

The two sides held an exchange of war dead, with Moscow handing over 252 bodies and Ukraine handing over 25, according to *Belta* state news agency in neighbouring Belarus.



Rescuers search the rubble of a house hit by a Russian drone in Kharkiv on Thursday. REUTERS

But while Witkoff spoke of "some degree of momentum" after meeting Zelenskyy and European and NATO officials in Oslo earlier in the week, the Kremlin expressed doubts.

"The Americans sensed some new nuances (in Oslo) and told us about this. But these nuances, so to speak, do not entirely satisfy us," Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov said.

On Thursday Zelenskyy snapped back at Witkoff for saluting Putin as a "humanitarian" during his visit to Russia, when the US envoy thanked Putin for releasing a 74-year-old American captured by Russian forces in Ukraine.

"Three waves of ballistic missiles have been launched at Kyiv by Russian 'humanitarians' since yesterday evening," Zelenskyy posted on X. "They used 21 missiles. Unfortunately, numerous sites across the city have been hit and damaged."

In Russia, two people were wounded near Moscow by drones launched towards the capital during the night, Mayor Sergei Sobyanin said on Telegram. Most of the drones were downed at long range, he added.

Earthquake of magnitude 7.0 strikes Tibet

Reuters
Beijing, October 22

A MAGNITUDE 7.0 earthquake struck China's southwestern region of Tibet at around 10:33 pm on Thursday, the China Earthquake Networks Center said.

Local authorities have found at least two people injured in a village near the epicentre, with some houses in villages closest to the epicentre showing cracks, the state broadcaster said.

The epicentre was in a sparsely populated, high-altitude county in Nagqu, northern Tibet, at a depth of 10 km . The average elevation within 5 km of the epicentre is about 15,960 feet, CENC data showed.

Local fire and rescue teams have mobilised and are heading to affected region, state media said. A string of smaller tremors of around magnitude 3 and 4 have been recorded in surrounding regions , CENC data showed.

Shelved plans to rename Atlantic Ocean after 'no' from Pichai, says Trump

Press Trust of India
Washington, October 22

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said he had considered renaming the Atlantic Ocean but dropped the idea after Google CEO Sundar Pichai, according to Trump, warned that the move could upset many countries.

Addressing a rally in South Carolina on Wednesday, Trump appeared to suggest that his move to rename Lake Ontario as Lake America had encouraged him to consider renaming the Pacific or Atlantic Ocean.

"Recently, I changed the name of a lake you know the lake. But I did it very lightly. And the damn thing got changed, actually. That's power, right? When you sort of do it half-heartedly, and it gets changed, it's changed. It's called the Lake of America," he said.

Trump said he shared his idea of changing the name of the Atlantic Ocean with Pichai, the Indian-American CEO of Google. "I spoke to a brilliant guy, Sundar. He heads all of Google. He's a brilliant guy. Sergei and Sundar. Totally brilliant guys," he said in an apparent reference to Sergey Brin, the co-founder of Google.

"And, you know, they're still rattled from the Gulf. And I said, 'Sundar, I'm thinking of the Atlantic Ocean. Can you handle it?'" Trump told the gathering, referring to his decision to rename the Gulf of Mexico as the Gulf of America.

Recounting Pichai's response, Trump said the Google CEO had told him oceans were different because they covered many countries and asked him not to pursue the idea. "So, I'll probably pass it," Trump said.

To cut reliance on US, Carney signs key pact with Turkey

Ankara: NATO allies Canada and Turkey upgraded their relations to a "strategic partnership" during the first bilateral visit by a Canadian prime minister on Thursday, as Mark Carney seeks new global trade partners to reduce reliance on United States.

The agreement by Carney and Turkish President Tayyip Erdogan marks a significant thaw in diplomatic ties that had long been cool over Canadian concerns over human rights and a past embargo on sending weapons to Turkey.

The new partnership signed in Ankara focuses on trade and investment, defence and security, energy, and social and diplomatic ties. It aims to create jobs and opportunities for Canadian and Turkish companies to do more business together.

Speaking next to Erdogan at Turkey's presidential palace, Carney said the strategic partnership would have four pillars and include a three-year action plan.

"We've planted the seeds of something new: a strategic partnership that will create new opportunities for our workers and businesses, and greater security and prosperity for both our peoples. With care and commitment, it will grow for generations to come," Carney said.

Canadian and Turkish ministers also signed cooperation deals on energy, defence and air transport. REUTERS

• 'FUND FOR RESPONDING TO LOSS AND DAMAGE', CREATED ON DEMANDS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES, TO SET ASIDE $20 MILLION FOR NEPAL

Nepal becomes first beneficiary of global funding for loss & damage

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, October 22

A NEWLY-created international climate fund that seeks to provide financial assistance to countries affected by climate disasters decided on Thursday to earmark US $20 million for Nepal to help it recover from the devastating flash floods in August, making it the first beneficiary of international funding for loss and damage – a long-pending demand of developing countries.

The Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage (FRLD), created in 2022, convened an emergency board meeting on Thursday at the request of Nepal and several other developing countries. The Board decided to "provisionally set aside" a sum of $20 million for Nepal.

Nepal has been asked to make a formal application for a funding request which will be considered at the Board's next meeting in December.

According to Nepal government's estimates, the economic loss and damage from the floods was at least $2.69 billion, with initial recovery and reconstruction needs pegged at a minimum of $4.71 billion.

What the FRLD board has approved for Nepal is, therefore, less than one per cent of the assessed requirement, but $20 million is the largest amount that can be approved by the FRLD for any single event right now.



Drone view shows mud-covered buildings after flash floods in Devighat, Nepal. FILE

Nepal was devastated by massive floods following a rock and ice avalanche on August 26 in the northeastern district of Rasua. The incident, which has been scientifically assessed to have been a result of climate change induced processes, killed more than 1,300 people, and over 5,000 people are still known to be missing, according to Nepal government sources.

It was the kind of incident for which the FRLD was created on the demands of developing countries, particularly small and least developed nations, which are most vulnerable to impacts of climate change, and have least resources to deal with these.

After over a decade and a half of negotiations, the FRLD was created at the COP27 meeting in Sharm-el Shaikh in Egypt in 2022, and was operationalised at COP28 in Dubai the following year with the announcement of the first round of pledges.

As of June this year, the FRLD had received 176 funding requests from 119 countries for a total sum of $2.8 billion. These requests are still being processed and are expected to be decided at the scheduled board meeting in December. Following the flooding event in August, Nepal had requested immediate support.

While countries can submit multiple requests for different incidents, each of these requests have to be between $5 million and $20 million.

The provisional approval for Nepal is being seen as a small but significant step forward in operationalising the international loss and damage framework in which small and vulnerable countries are able to access some financial assistance to deal with climate disasters.

"The FRLD has taken a landmark operational step by provisionally allocating $20 million for reconstruction in Nepal following GLOF event. But the funding is less than 0.5 per cent of Nepal's estimated $5 billion reconstruction costs, and would be released only after Nepal clears further bureaucratic project proposals, risking a delay to relief amid an ongoing structural crisis," Ajay Mathur, former director-general of International Solar Alliance, said.

IN OCT 1st HALF, PEAK DEMAND EXCEEDED 250 GW ON MOST DAYS

Power prices ease as demand dips, but coal stocks dwindle

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, October 22



Thermal plants' coal stocks declined to 17.5 mt from 18.6 mt at September-end. REUTERS

AS COOLER weather has eased power demand in the second half of October, spot electricity prices on the country's power exchanges have moderated compared with September.

Between October 1 and 21, the average market clearing price (MCP) in the day-ahead market (DAM) fell 3% to Rs 7.6 per unit during October 1–21, from Rs 7.8 per unit in the corresponding period last month. In the real-time market (RTM), the average MCP declined by around 14% to Rs 6.7 per unit, from Rs 7.8 per unit over the same period, data from the Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) shows.

The moderation in prices coincided with a 23% rise in sell bids in the DAM segment and a 1% decline in buy bids compared with the corresponding period in September. The market-clearing price is the price at which electricity is traded, determined by the equilibrium between demand bids and supply offers.

This comes as electricity demand has eased since mid-October, with peak power demand remaining below 250 gigawatts (GW), marking a shift from the first half of October, when peak demand exceeded 250 GW on most days and touched 260 GW on October 5 and 8.

September had also seen an unusual surge in electricity demand, with peak demand reaching 269 GW on September 10 — the highest level recorded for the month and just 1 GW below the annual peak of 270 GW seen in May.

Deficient rainfall and persistently high temperatures also pushed actual electricity requirements above the Central Electricity Authority's (CEA) projections. Between April and August, actual energy requirements were 3.3% higher than projected by CEA, the country's top power planning body.

The higher electricity requirement in this financial year, alongside deficient rainfall amid *El Niño*-influenced weather conditions, increased reliance on coal-based generation as hydropower output fell. Hydropower plays a crucial role in meeting evening peak demand during summer, when solar generation drops sharply after sunset.

Electricity generation from coal-based sources rose 12.05% to 762,526.32 million units (MU) between April 1 and October 18 this year, compared with 680,522.38 MU in the corresponding period last year. In contrast, hydropower generation fell 12.88% to 102,618.89 MU from 117,796.66 MU over the same period.

The increased reliance on coal-based generation is also reflected in falling coal stocks at thermal power plant. Inventories fell to 17.5 million tonnes (mt) as of October 21, from 18.6 mt on September 30 and around 55 mt at the beginning of April.

Power exchanges such as IEX, the country's largest power trading bourse, facilitate short-term electricity transactions, allowing generators to sell surplus power and buyers to meet fluctuations in demand. The prices discovered on these exchanges are wholesale rates and do not determine the retail tariffs paid by consumers.

The DAM allows participants to buy and sell electricity a day before delivery, while the RTM facilitates trades for near-immediate delivery to address changes in demand and supply.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RBI rate-setters split over inflation spreading

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, October 22

ON OCTOBER 7, the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) voted unanimously to raise the repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.5%. Further, four of the six were in favour of further tightening the screws and changing the stance of monetary policy from 'neutral' to 'calibrated tightening'.

But there is another collective opinion that perhaps matters even more: whether inflation is spreading, or becoming generalised.

According to the minutes of the October 5-7 meeting of the MPC, released on Wednesday, four members voiced concerns about inflation spreading — or more and more items in a household's consumption basket seeing higher price increases. These four were external members Saugata Bhattacharya and Ram Singh and two RBI representatives, Governor Sanjay Malhotra and Executive Director Indranil Bhattacharyya.

The other two members — external member Nagesh Kumar and Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta — did not think there were strong signs of inflation becoming widespread or entrenched. And this is a problem — not only does it somewhat soften the overall tone of the MPC as a whole, it also affects these two members' of how much interest rates should be increased.

As Barclays economists Aastha Gudwani and Amruta Ghare noted, the committee members "seemed to be divided on their assessment of inflation generalisation".

Generalisation of inflation is the process of higher prices spreading in a sustained manner. This requires the price rise to span different categories of items and move from ones that are most susceptible to price increases — such as food and fuel — to others, like consumer goods and services. The more and more 'general' price rises become, the more difficult it could get to bring down inflation to the RBI's medium-term target of 4%.

As per latest data, Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation jumped to 5.54% in September from 4.83% in August. It has been above the 4% target since coming in at 4.38% in June. It is expected to cross 6% in October.

MPC members' thinking

The minutes of the meeting showed Saugata Bhattacharya thinks data "increasingly suggests that price pressures are getting entrenched into the economic system". Ram Singh said "evidence suggests inflation has generalised beyond the direct effects of fuel, energy, and commodity prices since the onset of the West Asia conflict".

On the RBI side, Governor Malhotra said there are "increasing signs of generalisation of inflation", with various measures of inflation indicating "normalisation of inflation from the benign levels seen earlier". Meanwhile, Executive Director Indranil Bhattacharyya said the "momentum of underlying inflation is also high".

In the minority were external member Nagesh Kumar and Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta. While the former said inflation "does not show any signs of overheating of the economy nor of generalisation", Gupta was of the view that there are "inflation is mostly driven by external supply-side shocks, with insignificant signs of it becoming entrenched or impacting inflation expectations".

At the risk of being repetitive, Kumar and Gupta did vote for a rate hike, with the Deputy Governor arguing "one may not want to wait for more definitive evidence of generalisation" before increasing interest rates.

Mixed messaging

Communication has not been the MPC's strongest suit in recent months; after all, it was only in August that the committee thought there were "little" signs of inflation spreading, something which didn't have the full backing of the larger economist community.

But as the above excerpts show, the members are not on the same page.

This mixed messaging may also explain why some economists think the MPC may only increase the repo rate by another 25 bps, while some think another 75 bps of hikes lie ahead. Debt markets are also demanding higher rates of interest to buy government securities, with Wednesday's weekly sale of short-term government securities seeing the RBI rejecting all offers for the first time in the current fiscal.

Just three months ago, on July 22, the RBI had sold these securities maturing in 3 months, 6 months and 12 months at an interest rate of 5.34%, 5.6%, and 5.75%, respectively. Today, a 3-month security is trading in the secondary market at 5.84%.

The rupee is another source of mixed messaging, with the currency's weakness finding little mention in the minutes of the October 5-7 meeting. But just one week later, Governor Malhotra said in an interview that the RBI would do "whatever is necessary" to ensure an orderly forex market — which some economists took as a hint that even interest rates may be hiked to defend the rupee.

MPC DIVIDE

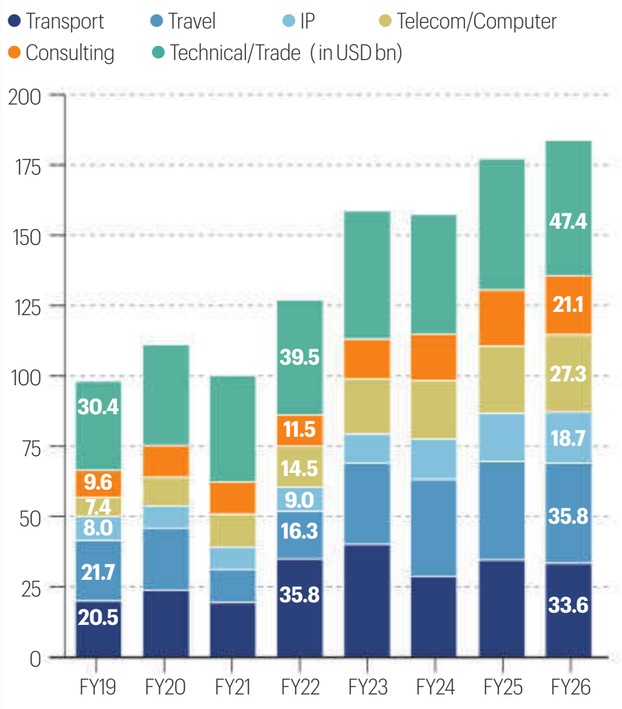
FOUR OF the six MPC members voiced concerns about inflation spreading — or about price increases affecting more items in a household's consumption basket

THESE FOUR were external members Saugata Bhattacharya and Ram Singh and two RBI representatives, Governor Sanjay Malhotra and Executive Director Indranil Bhattacharyya

THE OTHER two members — external member Nagesh Kumar and Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta — did not think there were strong signs of inflation becoming widespread or entrenched

FULL REPORT ON
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Key drivers of services imports



- India's current account deficit (CAD) in the financial year 2027 — till August — increased by $3.5 billion on-year. The steep $19.6bn rise in the merchandise deficit was offset by a $12bn rise in remittances and an increase in the services surplus by $6.4bn. Healthy remittances and the solid services trade surplus have kept the CAD capped.
- According to Nomura, the services sector's performance reflects India's traditional prowess in IT services and its popularity as a global hub for business and professional services. The Japan's investment bank said that there was a structural shift in rising services imports constraining the trade surplus.
- Rising imports of consultancy, digital, technical and trade services could be due to the rising importance of global capability centres (GCC), AI adoption and focus on data centres.

SOURCE: NOMURA

Jio Platforms IPO subscribed 5.6 times on Day 2

Kushan Shah
Mumbai, October 22

JIO PLATFORMS' initial public offering (IPO) continued to attract strong investor interest on Thursday, with the issue subscribed 5.6 times at the end of the second day of bidding. The IPO received bids for 1.1 billion shares worth Rs 1.23 lakh crore at the upper end of the price band, against 197.53 million shares on offer. The second day alone saw bids worth over Rs 50,000 crore, while the retail portion was fully subscribed, reflecting broad-based investor interest in India's largest-ever public offering.

Qualified institutional buyers continued to lead the demand, with their portion subscribed 13.3 times, up from over nine times on the opening day. The segment received bids for 651.5 million shares against 49 million shares on offer. Foreign institutional investors bid for 222.91 million shares, while domestic financial institutions accounted for over 344 million shares. Retail investor participation also gathered momentum, with the segment subscribed 1.54 times by the end of Thursday. It attracted bids for 130.9 million shares worth over Rs 14,650 crore against 85.04 million shares on offer.

The non-institutional investor portion was subscribed 5.97 times, receiving bids for 217.4 million shares worth Rs 24,330 crore against 36.4 million shares on offer. FE

CAS chaos: Sensex swings over 2,200 pts in 4 minutes

Kushan Shah
Mumbai, October 22

THE WEEKLY expiry of Sensex derivatives on Thursday witnessed sharp volatility during the closing auction session (CAS), with the index swinging more than 2,200 points in just four minutes.

The indicative closing value of the Sensex plunged nearly 1,250 points from 73,536 to 72,287 between 3:24 pm and 3:26 pm. However, the index recovered much of the lost ground over the next two minutes to close at 73,249. The sharp decline and subsequent recovery highlighted the extreme volatility during the closing auction.

Market experts attributed the wild swings largely to heavy sell orders in some of the index's heavyweight stocks during CAS.

Anand James, chief market strategist at Geojit Investments, said the sharp decline was primarily driven by selling in Reliance Industries and Larsen & Toubro, which together account for about 15% of the Sensex. Selling pressure in other major constituents, including Bharti Airtel, Infosys and Eternal, also contributed to the volatility. FE

GST reforms to be rolled out in phases, starting November 1

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, October 22

THE PROCESS reforms announced by the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council earlier this month will be implemented in phases, with authorities focusing on simplified registration for e-commerce sellers, streamlined registration process and faster refunds in the first phase. The Ministry of Finance will also share draft GST returns on 'myGov.in' portal on November 1 for public comments till November 30 in a bid to incorporate industry feedback and minimise the sources of mismatches that account for nearly 80% of notices issued at present, officials said on Thursday.

Based on industry representations and consultations, the government is attempting to modify the GSTR-1 return — the monthly or quarterly statement of outward supplies. "Based on the industry responses, we are modifying the GSTR-1 form, we are improving the IMS (invoice management system) so that the need for editing (GSTR) 3B does not arise. If the need does not arise, there won't be any case for notice based on mismatches. We will put the forms on 'myGov' for comments on November 1 with a 30-day window," Gaurav Singh, Commissioner (GST Policy Wing), Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC), said at Assocham's National Conclave on GST.

If reforms in the GST returns system can be implemented successfully, the integrity issues in the supply chain get resolved, Singh said. "This would be the foundation for further reforms," he added. The government is focusing on bringing in the changes that only require administrative processes in the first phase from November 1 that is likely to include simplified GST registration for small sellers on e-commerce platforms, unified documentation for GST registration, faster refunds, and a Rs 10,000 threshold for issuing GST notices.

The changes which require an amendment to the GST law would be implemented from April 1, 2027. The notifications and circulars on the relevant process reforms have already been approved by the legal department and are likely to be issued on Friday, an official said.

FULL REPORT ON
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BRIEFLY

Swiggy narrows Q2 loss, misses estimates

Bengaluru: **Swiggy reported a narrower second-quarter loss on Thursday, helped by improving profitability in its food delivery business, although the result fell short of analyst expectations. The quick-commerce and food delivery firm posted a consolidated net loss of Rs 922 crore ($97.24 million) for the quarter ended September 30, compared with a loss of Rs 1,092 crore a year earlier. Analysts had expected a loss of Rs 792 crore, according to data compiled by LSEG.** REUTERS

Sunil Kumar to become new ONGC chairman

New Delhi: **The government has appointed Sunil Kumar, an executive director of ONGC, as the state-run energy major's next chairman, making him the first executive in the company's history to be elevated directly from the executive director rank to its top post. Kumar will succeed Arun Kumar Singh, whose extended tenure ends on December 6. The appointment follows a multi-stage selection process in which a search-cum-selection committee conducted two rounds of interviews.** PTI

Why eMudhra exited digital certificates biz

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, October 22

INDIAN DIGITAL trust services provider eMudhra withdrew from the global SSL/TLS certificate business on Thursday, after vulnerabilities were found in its digital certificates.

Some of the world's biggest Internet browser companies, including Google, Mozilla, Apple and Microsoft, had blocked digital certificates associated with Bengaluru-based eMudhra, after a serious security flaw was detected in the company's systems for generating cryptographic keys.

SSL and TLS certificates are global security standards that indicate websites using them are safe to browse. Such websites display web addresses starting with "https".

The flaw could have allowed attackers to impersonate legitimate websites and intercept supposedly secure Internet communications.

The incident has raised concerns about the broader security of the Internet, which relies on a system of trust between browsers and certification authorities to authenticate websites and secure online communications.

What exactly happened

The incident concerns eight intermediate certification authority (CA) certificates whose private keys were generated with insufficient randomness, making them potentially easy to decipher. Six of these certificates were meant for authenticating websites, while the remaining two were for digitally signing software. An independent security researcher, identified as Wayne, discovered the weakness and reported it to browser companies on October 17.

Cryptographic keys are central to how digital certificates work. A private key is meant to remain secret and is used to authenticate the identity of an entity, such as a website or software publisher. Generating such keys requires sufficient randomness to prevent outsiders from predicting or reconstructing them.

In eMudhra's case, the weakness meant that attackers could potentially reconstruct the private keys associated with the affected intermediate authorities, in a mere matter or seconds. This could allow them to issue fraudulent certificates that appear legitimate, impersonate websites or make malicious software appear trustworthy.

The role of certification authorities

Founded in 2008, eMudhra is one of India's largest digital identity and security companies. It issues digital signature certificates, provides electronic signing services and supplies technology for authenticating online identities and securing digital transactions.

The company is India's largest certifying authority in the digital signature certificate market. According to its May 2026 investor presentation, it had approximately 38% market share by value, citing a 2024 Frost & Sullivan study. It operates in more than 35 countries and serves businesses, financial institutions and government organisations.

eMudhra admits reputational risk

In a statement on October 21, eMudhra acknowledged that the weakness originated during a key-generation exercise conducted on April 30, 2025.

According to the company, a flaw during the process created a second set of weak cryptographic keys alongside the original strong keys. The weaker keys were subsequently published to browser trust stores.

The company has maintained that its infrastructure had not been compromised, no data breach had occurred and its physical and logical security controls remained intact. "However, this may have some reputational risks on eMudhra which cannot be quantified," it added.

The company said the incident had no connection with its Indian digital signature certificate and eSign businesses, which operate on separate infrastructure. It also said that the affected global TLS business accounted for approximately 1% of its revenue, although the incident could carry reputational risks that could not be quantified.

The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In), under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, issued an advisory on October 21, warning about the compromise of eight eMudhra intermediate CA certificates.

The agency said the weakness arose from insufficient cryptographic randomness in the generation of private keys, making them susceptible to recovery.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▲
73,249.39	22,687.65	₹1,42,694	₹94.83
-460.30	-123.70	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
-0.62%	-0.54%	₹1,99,777	$116.73

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF OCTOBER 21, 2026

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED

e-Procurement Tender Notice

The TGTRANSCO invites bids online for the following work: Spec.No.e-TGTLI-20/26-27, Name of work: Supply of Material/ Equipment including Transportation & Insurance, Delivery, Erection, Testing & Commissioning and Civil & Construction of the following works on Turnkey basis under Makthal - Narayanpet - Kodangal Lift Irrigation Scheme (Package-1) in Narayanpet District. (i) 220/11kV LISS at Budpur, Katrevpalle (V), Makthal (M). (ii) 220KV TMDC Line from existing 400/220kV Veltoor SS to proposed 220/11kV SS Budpur SS (39.553KM). (iii) 2Nos. 220kV Bays at 400/220kV Veltoor SS.

Tender Availability on website from: 22.10.2026. **Note:** Further details can be seen in website: http//tender.telangana.gov.in Fax No. 040-23323565, Phone No.040-23396000 Extn.3552/3424/3687/3627.

Sd/-
CHIEF ENGINEER/LIS

DIPR R.O.No:673-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/1/2026-27

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.
No. NIT/2026-27/8614-26 Date: 21.10.2026
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 430/2026-27
निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई-टेन्डरिंग प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु.)
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:-	
Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Luharu Road SH-08'' for a period of 01 year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00709**	**3487.86 Lakh**
Banswara-Ratalm BOT Road'' for a period of 01 year. **UBN: RRC2627SLOB00710**	**897.53 Lakh**

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in तथा http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है। महाप्रबंधक

राजस्थान राज्य भण्डारव्यवस्था निगम

No. :- HO/PD/F2(1)/H&T Policy/2026-28/5022 Date :- 15/10/2026

Notice Inviting BID

Rajasthan State Warehousing Corporation invites online bids under two-bid system from experienced eligible bidders for entering into a Rate Contract for Handling and Transport work and allied operations in 37 warehouses of Rajasthan State Warehousing Corporation for a period of two years, as per the description mentioned in the bid document.

All technical bid shall be open at Head Office, Rajasthan State Warehousing. Corporation, Bhawani Singh Road, Jaipur as mentioned in Bid Document.

Details of this bid may be seen on the procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in)** and the website of RSWC **(www.agriculture.rajasthan.gov.in/rswc).**

UBN : SWC2627SLRC00144 to 147, 00149 To 180 & SSRC00148

Raj.Samwad/C/26/12282 Joint Director (Dev.)

भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- लेखा/भ.वि.प्रा./2026-27/ दिनांक :-

अल्पकालीन ऑनलाईन निविदा सूचना सं. 49/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, में उपयुक्त श्रेणी एवं विभिन्न विभागों में एए श्रेणी/ए और (योग्यतानुसार) में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्योरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से कुल 01 कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

उक्त कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण, निविदा शर्तें, अनुमानित लागत राशि, निविदा बेचने, प्राप्त करने एवं खोलने की दिनांक आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेवसाईट **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** का अवलोकन करें।

UBN विवरण :– WAQ2627WLOB00123

अधिशाषी अभियंता
भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

राज.संवाद/सी/26/12261

भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- लेखा/भ.वि.प्रा./2026-27/15017 - 28 दिनांक :- 17/10/2026

अल्पकालीन ऑनलाईन निविदा सूचना सं. 52/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, में उपयुक्त श्रेणी एवं विभिन्न विभागों में एए श्रेणी/ए और (योग्यतानुसार) में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्योरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से कुल 01 कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

उक्त कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण, निविदा शर्तें, अनुमानित लागत राशि, निविदा बेचने, प्राप्त करने एवं खोलने की दिनांक आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेवसाईट **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** का अवलोकन करें।

UBN विवरण :– WAQ2627WLOB00125

अधिशाषी अभियंता
भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

राज.संवाद/सी/26/12263

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



MAJOR SAJJAN SINGH GAHLAWAT, SC
9 MADRAS (TRAVANCORE)

All ranks of TRAVANCORE TERRORS pay homage to Major SS Gahlawat, SC who made the supreme sacrifice while fighting terrorists in Surankote (J&K) on this day in 1997. We salute his brave deeds on the 29th anniversary of his martyrdom. You will always remain a source of inspiration for all of us.

Commanding Officer & All Ranks 9 MADRAS (TRAVANCORE)

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.



HEAD CONSTABLE SUSHIL KUMAR, PMG, 127 BN BSF, 15.06.1969 – 23.10.2016



CONSTABLE VISHWAS KUMAR, 55 BN BSF, 04.06.1987 – 23.10.2014



INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)
Inspector Diwan Singh

ITBP salutes its braveheart Inspector Diwan Singh of 36th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Uttarakhand in 2020.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Shri G. P. Punj, Asst. Comdt., **38 Bn**, 11-9-1940 To 23-10-1982



Veer Balidani Constable/ Washerman Ajab Lal, **38 Bn**, 12-11-1949 To 23-10-1982



Veer Balidani Lance Naik Dinesh Kumar Awasthi, **38 Bn**, 1-7-1945 To 23-10-1982



Veer Balidani Constable/ Cook Bhoop Singh, **38 Bn**, 19-4-1950 To 23-10-1982

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to 4 valiant troopers of 38 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while countering an ambush by Mizo insurgents in Mizoram on 23 October 1982. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Suraj Singh, **120 Bn**, 4-7-1949 To 23-10-1999



Veer Balidani Head Constable/ Radio Operator Kamal Singh, **5 SIG Bn**, 30-8-1973 To 23-10-1999



Veer Balidani Head Constable/ Radio Operator Namadeo Kashid, **5 SIG Bn**, 1-6-1968 To 23-10-1999



Veer Balidani Constable/ Driver Ram Naresh, **120 Bn**, 20-4-1969 To 23-10-1999

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to 4 brave troopers of 120 Bn and 5 Signal Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an insurgent attack on 23 October 1999 in Manipur. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Mithai Lal, **67 Bn**, 26-11-1957 To 23-10-2005

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Mithai Lal of 67 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a cowardly attack by a militant on 23 October 2005 in Srinagar, J&K. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

M.P. POWER GENERATING CO. LTD.

Office of the Chief Engineer (Civil-Engineering)
Block No. 1, Shakti Bhawan, Rampur, Jabalpur-482008
Website : www.mppgcl.mp.gov.in, Phone : 0761-2702812, Telefax : 0761-2664250, Email : edcivilpnd@gmail.com, CIN-U40109MP2001SGC014882

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR EXPERT CIVIL ENGINEERS - CEC/05

Madhya Pradesh Power Generating Company Limited, Jabalpur a wholly owned MP Govt. company engaged in power generation in Madhya Pradesh. Company intends to engage retired Civil Engineers from MPPGCL/successor companies of MPSEB/Ex-PSU-02 Nos. Expert Civil Engineer equivalent to Executive Engineer (Civil) or above having minimum experience of 10 years (in any capacity) in dealing with Civil works related to thermal power projects in field and worked for the same post or higher in service at the time of retirement on regular or current charge basis, on contract basis. There will be no age limit for applying but subject to submission of certificate regarding sound health and physical fitness. Experts shall be engaged for one year which is extendable on yearly basis or 67 years of age, whichever is earlier. For details, please visit e-tender website of GoMP. The application should be sent to this office in hard copy only **latest by 18th Nov. 2026.** Willing engineers may be required to undergo a personal interview for which separate intimation shall be made by MPPGCL.

M.P. Madhyam/128716/2026 **ED (CIVIL-ENGG.)**

SHORT NOTE

Subject: Regarding filling up the post of Clerk (Group-C) on Deputation/ Transfer basis in the Fisheries Department.

With reference to the subject cited above, it is informed that the posts of Clerk in the Fisheries Department, Haryana are to be filled up on deputation/ transfer basis for a period of one year. The eligibility criteria and requisite conditions are as under:-

Sr. No.	Name of Post	No. of Post	Pay Matrix/Pay Scale	Eligibility & Conditions for Transfer/Deputation
1.	Clerk	20	FPL-3 (21,700/-)	**(i)** 10+2 or its equivalent; **(ii)** two years experience as Clerk in any State Government or Government of India, and **(iii)** Hindi or Sanskrit as one of the subject in Matric or Hindi as one of the subject in Higher Education. Note.- To get annual increment or further promotion, SETC in both the parts shall have to be qualified after joining service as Clerk, if already not qualified.

1. **Employment Status:** The candidate must be working as a Clerk or equivalent post on a regular basis in any Department/Board/ Corporation / Authority of the Haryana
2. **Government. No Objection Certificate (NOC):** The selection of the employee shall be made only after the issuance of a No Objection Certificate (NOC) by their Parent Department.
3. **ACR/APAR Grading:** It is mandatory that the grading of the Annual Confidential Reports (ACR) of the employee for the last 10 years must be at least 70% **"Good"** or **"Very Good".** (In case an employee's total service period as Clerk is less than 05 years, the ACR grading for their total working tenure as Clerk will be considered).
4. **Integrity:** The integrity of the employee must be beyond doubt.
5. **Pending Inquiries:** No charge sheet / vigilance inquiry under Rule 7 or Rule 8 should be pending against the employee.
6. **Withheld Increment:** No order for withholding the annual increment of the employee in past years should be in force at present.
7. **SETC Qualification:** Passing the SETC Test is mandatory for the employee as per the instructions of the Haryana Government.

Note:-

1. **Tenure Period:** This deputation shall be for a period of 1 year or till the appointment of a Clerk in the department through direct recruitment, whichever is earlier.
2. **Pay & Allowances:** The official coming on deputation will be granted pay in Pay Matrix Level Rs. 21700/- (FPL-3) for the post of Clerk in the Fisheries Department.

It is, therefore, requested to send a panel of willing and eligible employees along with their bio-data and a summary of verified copies of ACRs for the last 10 years within 30 days from the date of issuance of this letter. Further, it is also requested that only those officials be recommended who can be easily relieved by the concerned department upon selection.

Sd/-
Deputy Director Fisheries-I (HQ)
for: Director Fisheries Department, Haryana, Panchkula

No. 50407/HR

UPSIDA — कार्यालय प्रधान महाप्रबन्धक, उ0प्र0 राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

ए-1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अन्तर्गत विकास/अनुरक्षण/उच्चीकरण कार्यों हेतु सरकारी विभागों/सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निकायों में पंजीकृत फर्मों/ ठेकेदारों से ई-निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलोड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है–

1. क्रमांक 1 से 4 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 23.10.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 30.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती हैं, जिन्हें दिनांक 30.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अल्पकालिक)
2. क्रमांक 5 से 6 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 27.10.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 04.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती हैं, जिन्हें दिनांक 04.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अल्पकालिक)

निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल शपथपत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा खोलने की तिथि से दो कार्यदिवस के अन्दर कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकेंगी। ई–निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:–

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की लागत (लाख में)
1	Mechanical Road Sweeping of All I.A. of CD-1 with Mechanical Road Sweeping Machine (03 Nos) and Operations in Compliance of CAQM Guideline.	333.27
2	Greening and End to End Paving by Interlocking Tile at Different Roads and Maintenance of Green Area / Lawn for One Year of I.A. Bulandshahar Road Distt. Ghaziabad	904.88
3	Greening and End to End Paving by Interlocking Tile for Dust Mitigation at Saur Urja Marg at I.A. Sahibabad Site-IV Distt. Ghaziabad.	827.04
4	Construction of Boundary wall at Surajpur Site-C Housing Distt. GB Nagar.	159.99
5	Maintenance and Upgradation of Parks in Residential Sector B-1, B-5/6, C-2, C-6, C-7, C-8 & C-9 in I.A. TDS City Ghaziabad.	359.37
6	Maintenance & Upgradation of Existing Drain in I.A. Sector A-1, A-2, A-3, A-4, A-5/6 at I.A. TDS City Ghaziabad	298.53

नोटः– निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जी0एस0टी0 अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: htts://beta.upsidamarketplace.com पर स्थित ई–लिंक एवं यूपीएलसी की website: http://etender.up.nic.in पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (सिविल) के श्री दीपक सोनकर मोबाइल नं0 9044197166 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

प्रधान महाप्रबन्धक, उ0प्र0रा0औ0वि0प्रा0, कानपुर

HARYANA WATER RESOURCES AUTHORITY

PUBLIC NOTICE

The Haryana Water Resources (Conservation, Regulation and Management) Authority (HWRA) has been established under the Haryana Water Resources (Conservation, Regulation and Management) Authority Act, 2020, with the mandate of conservation, regulation and management of water resources, including groundwater and surface water, in the State of Haryana. Therefore, all industrial, infrastructure and mining projects requiring extraction of groundwater are required to obtain permission/No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the Authority, as per the applicable provisions, guidelines and regulatory framework.

The HWRA has been regulating the development and management of groundwater through grant of permission/No Objection Certificates (NOCs) for extraction of groundwater by industries, infrastructure, mining and other projects.

With a view to facilitating compliance with HWRA Guidelines and addressing the concerns of various stakeholders, including the Industries, Infrastructure and Mining sectors, the Authority has decided to grant relaxation in late fees to facilitate the regularization of groundwater abstraction and encourage compliance with HWRA guidelines.

In view of the above, the Authority has decided to grant relaxation in late fees until 30.11.2026, in the public interest. With effect from 01.12.2026, late fees shall be charged as per the prevailing directions/ guidelines of HWRA.

All ground water users (except those falling under exempted categories) who are extracting groundwater are hereby directed to obtain the requisite No Objection Certificate (NOC) in accordance with the prevailing HWRA guidelines and submit their applications through the official online portal, **https://hwra.org.in.** Failure to obtain the requisite permission shall render the concerned project proponents liable to action in accordance with the applicable rules and regulations.

Sd/-
Chairperson
No. 50436/HR **Haryana Water Resources Authority**

RASHTRIYA CHEMICALS AND FERTILIZERS LIMITED

(A Government of India Undertaking)
Administrative Building, Chembur, Mumbai 400 074, Maharashtra, INDIA • Phone: 00 91 22 2552 2242 / 2753 / 2608 Fax: 00 91 22 2552 2320
CIN – L24110MH1978GOI020185

GLOBAL TENDER FOR EMPANELMENT OF REPUTED TRADERS FOR SUPPLY OF FERTILIZERS & FERTILIZER RAW MATERIALS BY ENTERING INTO MOU FOR NON-BINDING QUANTITY FOR A PERIOD OF ONE YEAR

Product	**FERTILIZERS & FERTILIZER RAW MATERIALS**
Reference No:	**DC / MR / EMP / RM FERTILIZERS: 21905**

Applications are invited for Empanelment of Reputed Traders for supply of Fertilizers & Fertilizer Raw materials by entering into an MOU for non-binding quantity for a period of one year.

Closing Date & Time: 14 NOVEMBER, 2026 up to 11:30 Hrs. IST

The complete details for Empanelment are available on RCF website: **www.rcfltd.com** in Trombay Tenders.

Website for Documents Submission:
https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app
CPP Tender ID: 2026_RCFL_931245_1

General Manager (Commercial)

Let us grow together

HARYANA ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION,

BAYS NO. 33-36, SECTOR-4, PANCHKULA-134112
PH. 0172-2572395, FAX: 2572359,
E-mail: dir-trf.herc@nic.in **website:** herc.org.in/herc.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice for public hearing on the petition(s) filed by UHBVNL and DHBVNL (Discoms) under Section 42 (4) of the Electricity Act 2003 and Regulations 22 of Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission (Terms and conditions for grant of connectivity and open access for intra-State transmission and distribution system) Regulations, 2012 and amendments thereof for determining the Additional Surcharge for first (1st) half of FY 2026-27 and approval for levying the same on the Open Access consumers till the issuance of the next Order in this regard. (HERC/Petition no 70 of 2026 and HERC/Petition no 75 of 2026)

DISCOMs have submitted petition(s) to determine the Additional Surcharge for the first (1st) half of FY 2026-27. The objective is to recover the fixed costs associated with power purchase commitments that remain stranded when consumers choose to draw power from sources other than the distribution licensees via Open Access.

General public/stakeholders are hereby invited to file their written comments/objections/suggestions on the above petition(s), which can be downloaded from the website of HERC **(https://herc.org.in/herc.gov.in),** free of cost. All interested parties may submit five copies of their comments/objections along with supporting documents, if any, to the Secretary, HERC, Bays No. 33-36, Sector-4, Panchkula-134112 along with an affidavit and soft copy of the same at email id: **secretary.herc@nic.in** and **dir-trf.herc@nic.in,** with a copy of the comments/objections to Managing Director, UHBVNL and DHBVNL **(Email: md@uhbvn.org.in, md@dhbvn.org.in)** on or before 09.11.2026. The objections should carry full name, complete postal address and phone number/email address, if any, of the person sending the objection. The Commission will afford an opportunity of hearing to the stakeholders filing written comments/ objections on or before the due date. The public hearing in respect of above case(s) shall be held on 14.12.2026 at 11.30 AM in the court room of the Commission, Panchkula.

Sd/-
Secretary
No. 50409/HRY **HERC, Panchkula**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	UHBVN	PROCUREMENT OF 500 MW SOLAR POWER WITH BATTERY ENERGY STORAGE SYSTEM (BESS) ON LONG TERM BASIS FROM GRID CONNECTED SOLAR PV POWER PROJECTS WITHIN THE STATE OF HARYANA	START TIME: 21.10.2026 AT 17:00 HRS LAST TIME: 17.11.2026 AT 15:00 HRS	RS. 13,27,200 /MW OF QUANTUM OFFERED.	www.uhbvn.org.in RfS no.126/CE/HPPC/LTPIII/ 500 MW/SOLAR & BESS dated 21.10.2026	9023797477 cehppc@uhbvn.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in — No. 50445/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	GMDA GURUGRAM	GURUGRAM TOWN - ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR SUPPLY, ERECTION, TESTING AND COMMISSIONING OF D.G. SET OF CAPACITY 1050 KVA AND 750 KVA AT 100 MLD STP DHANWAPUR, GURUGRAM AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO.' (INCLUDING 1 YEAR DEFECT LIABILITY PERIOD FREE OF COST) + 1 WORKS	16.10.2026 27.10.2026	3,77,13,888/-	https://www.gmda.gov.in	9773972700 xen4infra2.gmda@gmda.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in — No. 50415/HRY

Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr
E-Procurement Short Term Inviting Tender

No. 10425/96M/E-Tender/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 **Dated. 12.10.2026**

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate short term bid online through **http://etender.up.nic.in** from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Building Work Category as applied from Date **24.10.2026 to 31.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon** as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated **31.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M.** If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Construction work for expansion within the premises of the Provincial Division Office, PWD, Bulandshahr.	53.70	4.69	06 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+ 2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B, C (Building work)
2	Construction of a boundary wall and a watchman's room at the Inspection House, Bhoor in District, Bulandshahr.	106.00	7.30	09 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300+2000+18% G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 =2714.00	Executive Engineer P.D, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Superintending Engineer, BSR Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Building work)

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. Contractor should be registered in Building work in PWD.
4. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
   Details of e-tender uploaded on **http://etender.up.nic.in** shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on **http://etender.up.nic.in**
6. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
7. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**.

Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD,
Bulandshahar

UPID-258868 Dt. 21/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr circle, PWD Bulandshahr

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता 47वॉ० (वि०/यॉ०) वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद

ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट निविदा सूचना (अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा)

पत्रांक 1372/3WE(MBD)-47/2026 **दिनांकः–13.10.2026**

1. महामहिम राज्यपाल महोदय् उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, 47वां (वि०/यॉ०) वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद द्वारा निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार ऑनलाइन निविदायें वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in एवं प्रहरी **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari** के माध्यम से कॉलम 11 के अनुसार विद्युत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से प्रतिशत दरों के आधार पर अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदादाता को परामर्श दिया जाता है कि निविदा की नियम व शर्तों का भली भांति अध्ययन कर लें।
2. कार्य का विवरणः–

क्र सं	जनपद	कार्य का नाम	अनुमा नित लागत (रू0 लाख में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रू0 लाख में)	कार्य को पूर्ण करने की अवधि	निविदा शुल्क (रू0 में)	अधिशासी अभियन्ता का पता	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का पता	मुख्य अभियन्ता का पता	निविदा हेतु पात्रता
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	रामपुर	जनपद रामपुर में रामपुर कैमरी मार्ग किमी0 2 से राजकीय पॉलीटैक्निक कॉलेज तक मार्ग के चौड़ीकरण एवं सुदृढ़ीकरण में पोल शिफ्टिंग का कार्य।	56.03 (GST Extra)	4.81	6 माह (वर्षा काल सहित)	(300 + 18 प्रतिशत जी0एस0टी0) + 2000 (अधिष्ठान) कुल योग–2354.00	अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत/ यॉन्त्रिक खण्ड, लो0नि0वि0, मुरादाबाद।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, 47 वॉ वि0/यॉ0 वृत्त, लो0नि0वि0 मुरादाबाद।	मुख्य अभियन्ता, वि0/यॉ0, लो0नि0वि0, लखनऊ	लो0नि0वि0 में विद्युत कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत ए श्रेणी के ठेकेदार एवं 11KV HT, 33 KV HT, LT लाईनों के पोल शिफ्टिंग करने का कार्य अनुभव।
2	रामपुर	जनपद रामपुर में रामपुर बड़ाखास सिमरा हरदुआ हरदासपुर नवदिया भैसोड़ी (अन्य जिला मार्ग) क चैनेज 0.000 से चैनेज 6.000 तक (लम्बाई 6.000 किमी0) पर पोल शिफ्टिंग का कार्य। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	27.17 (GST Extra)	2.72	6 माह (वर्षा काल सहित)	(300 + 18 प्रतिशत जी0एस0टी0) + 2000 (अधिष्ठान) कुल योग–2354.00	अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत/ यॉन्त्रिक खण्ड, लो0नि0वि0, मुरादाबाद।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, 47 वॉ वि0/यॉ0 वृत्त, लो0नि0वि0 मुरादाबाद।	मुख्य अभियन्ता, वि0/यॉ0, लो0नि0वि0, लखनऊ	
3	रामपुर	जनपद रामपुर में भमौरा शाहबाद बिलारी मार्ग से रौण्डा झोण्डा चौराहा (चैनेज 0.000से 11.960 किमी0) तक मार्ग के चौड़ीकरण एवं सुदृढ़ीकरण में पोल शिफ्टिंग का कार्य। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	162.00 (GST Extra)	10.1	12 माह (वर्षा काल सहित)	(300 + 18 प्रतिशत जी0एस0टी0) + 2000 (अधिष्ठान) कुल योग–2354.00	अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विद्युत/ यॉन्त्रिक खण्ड, लो0नि0वि0, मुरादाबाद।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, 47 वॉ वि0/यॉ0 वृत्त, लो0नि0वि0 मुरादाबाद।	मुख्य अभियन्ता, वि0/यॉ0, लो0नि0वि0, लखनऊ	

निविदा प्रपत्र विभागीय वेबसाईट **http://etender.up.nic.in** एवं प्रहरी **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari** के माध्यम से दिनांक 24.10.2026 प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 02.11.2026 अपरान्ह 12:00 बजे तक उपलब्ध रहेगी। प्राप्त निविदा की तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 02.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 03:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। इच्छुक एवं सम्बन्धित ठेकेदार विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु उपरोक्त वेब साईड पर लॉगिन करें।

शासनादेश संख्या 1/2016/3070/78–2–2018/2071 (22) दिनॉक 03.01.2018 में निहित व्यवस्थानुसार निविदा की तकनीकी बिड खोलने के उपरान्त निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख व्यक्तिगत रूप से विभाग/कार्यालय में प्रस्तुत किये जाने हैं। निविदादाता द्वारा मूल अभिलेख प्रस्तुत न किये जाने की दशा में निहित प्राविधानों के अनुरूप कार्यवाही की जायेगी।

(मनीष सोनकर)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता वि०/यॉ० खण्ड,
लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद।

UPID-258955 Date: 21/10/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(संदीप कुमार सक्सेना)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता 47वॉं (वि०/यॉ०) वृत,
लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद

Govt. of Bihar

Public Health Engineering Department

Public Health Engineering Division, Aurangabad
SHORT RE-TENDER NIT No-02R2/2026-27/O&M-PHED
National Competitive Bidding
(Through e-procurement mode on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1	Designation and Address of Advertiser	Executive Engineer, P. H. Division, Aurangabad.
2	Date of issue of Tender Notice	15.10.2026
3	Period of sale (downloading) of tender Bid Document	25.10.2026 to 31.10.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs. through www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
4	Date, time & place of pre-bid meeting	26.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer of concerned P. H. Division
5	Last date and time of receipt (uploading) of tender	31.10.2026 up to 16:00Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
6	Date and time of opening of technical bid	31.10.2026 at 16:30 Hrs on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7	Date and time of opening of financial bid	To be informed later after the approval of technical bid.

8. Details of works:

Group No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest Money (in Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document (non-refundable) in Rs.	BSEDC Bid Processing Fee (in Rs.)	Completion Period (in months)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
01	Comprehensive operation and maintenance, routine repairs and Special repairs of i.) Rural Piped Water Supply Scheme (PWS-10 Schemes), ii.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in quality affected wards (WLS_Quality-70 Schemes) and iii.) Ward level Piped Water Supply Schemes in non quality affected wards(WLS_Non Quality-359 Schemes) based on item rates; constructed by the Public Health Engineering Department including payment to the pump operators, electricity bills for five years.	3926.55059	49.27	10000.00	As per Eproc2	60 Month

9. The bidder shall submit his bid/tender on e-Procurement platform at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

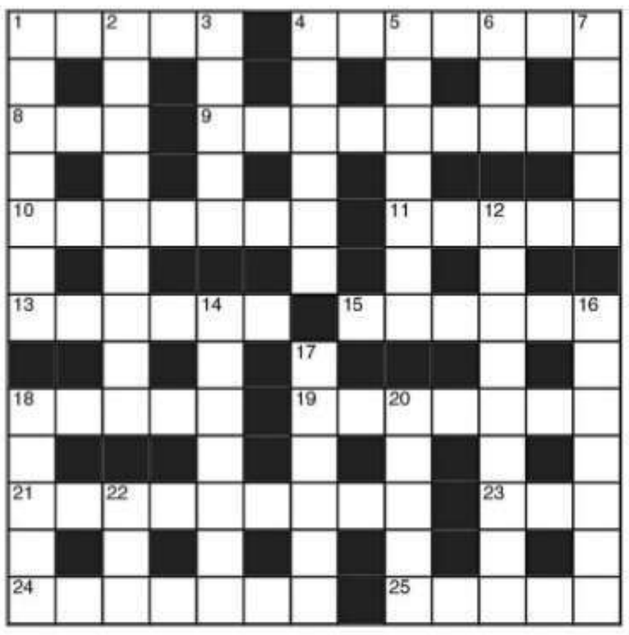
For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

Executive Engineer
Public Health Division, Aurangabad

PR. No. 013878 (PHED) 2026-27

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

CROSSWORD 6127



ACROSS

1 One with a consuming desire to chop up a tree (5)
4 Loot might be so piled (7)
8 Wood used in model-making (3)
9 Chided for having a bun perhaps (9)
10 Underworld boss dispatched for making protest (7)
11 Fruit crop (5)
13 Outmoded love is destined for failure (6)
15 Suitable voice for a trio? (6)
18 Influenced utterly to get a soft leather (5)
19 Put some notes in order? (7)
21 Hardly the type to make a good lookout (9)
23 Natural product of arctic environment (3)
24 Beat fellow to the line (7)
25 Just correct (5)

DOWN

1 Chaps caught in foul deed are corrected (7)
2 Last monument in Arizona? (9)
3 Incite audible quarrels (5)
4 One of those coming out scoffed at argument (6)
5 Clear off unruly campers (7)
6 Not even out of the ordinary (3)
7 Youth has the French spoon (5)
12 Stiff — but relaxing (9)
14 This is irritating for sightseers naturally (7)
16 Mountain's name always is in French (7)
17 Take notice. Tom is welcome inside (6)
18 Relocation is needed for some workers (5)
20 Moving arm up and down (5)
22 Some shade from the sun (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6126 ACROSS: 1 Usherettes, 8 Wrong, 9 Confine, 10 Too true, 11 Irene, 12 Dative, 14 Anthem, 17 Adder, 19 Mission, 21 Artwork, 22 Races, 23 Distribute DOWN: 2 Stop out, 3 Eager, 4 Etcher, 5 Tension, 6 Shine, 7 Determines, 8 Withdrawal, 13 Various, 15 Haircut, 16 Smoker, 18 Dated, 20 Scrub

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The power to mould the future of the Republic will be in the hands of the ___ of future generations. - Joseph Pulitzer (11)

MOLAR

EMOLNT

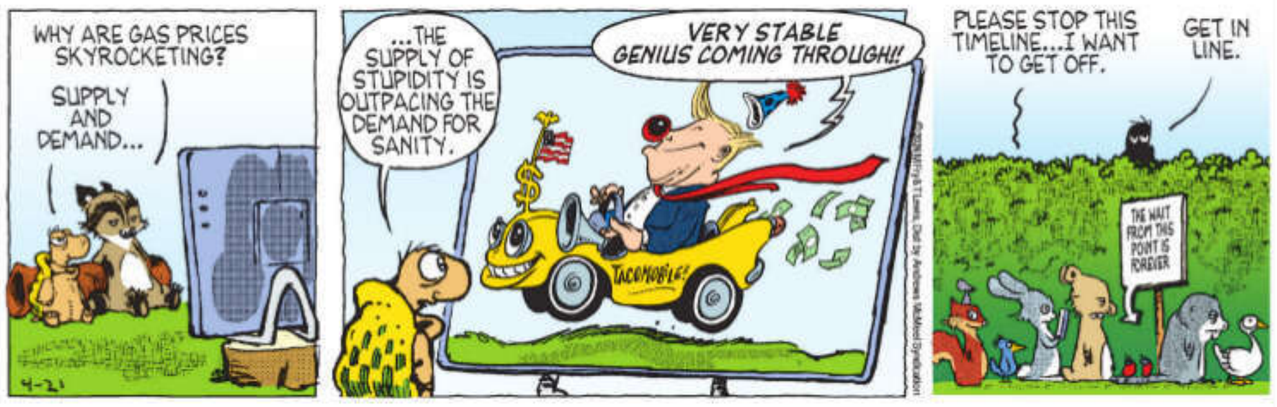
MSSAI

AFLRJU

SOLUTIONS: Moral, Amiss, Molten, Jarful
ANSWER: The power to mould the future of the Republic will be in the hands of the **journalists** of future generations. - Joseph Pulitzer

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6480

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

							6	
7		5			2			
1	9			8			3	
		8		3	4	6		
	5						1	
		9	1	7		2		
	8			5			9	4
			4			8		1
	2							

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6479

8	1	2	4	7	9	3	5	6
6	7	4	2	5	3	8	1	9
3	9	5	6	8	1	7	4	2
2	5	9	7	3	8	4	6	1
7	4	3	5	1	6	2	9	8
1	8	6	9	4	2	5	3	7
9	2	8	3	6	4	1	7	5
4	6	7	1	2	5	9	8	3
5	3	1	8	9	7	6	2	4

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a passionate, powerful day. Romance is blessed. It's a great day to socialise. It's also an excellent day for financial discussions about shared property and debt. Tonight: You win.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): You will need more rest. Relations with partners, spouses and close friends will be warm and mutually rewarding. Partners from the past are cropping up in person or online. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): A work-related romance might begin. It's just a fleeting flirtation that makes your heart skip a beat. Co-workers are supportive now because you're willing to dig in and work hands-on with projects. You're busy for the next four weeks. Tonight: Be friendly

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): It's a romantic day. Make plans to socialise with your sweetheart. If you're single, then enjoy good times with someone. Sports events and fun times with kids will appeal. Tonight: You're admired.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Your focus now shifts to home and family . You might be more involved with family discussions and home repairs. Today you want to do something different. Tonight: Learn something.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Fasten your seatbelts, because the pace of your days will accelerate in the next four weeks. You've got places to go, things to do and people to see. You might read, write and study more as well. Tonight: Check your finances.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Your focus on money, cash flow, earnings and your own possessions will be stronger in the next four weeks. Checks in the mail might be late because there will be hiccups and delays. It was ever thus. Tonight: Be cooperative.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today the Moon moves into your sign. This happens once a year and gives you a chance to recharge your batteries for the rest of the year. Get out there. Shop for wardrobe goodies. Look good, because people from your past are popping up. Tonight: Get better organised.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Your personal year is coming to an end. Meanwhile, today is an affectionate, romantic day. Make a special date with someone. Tonight: Socialise.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your popularity will increase in the next four weeks. You might hang out with younger people more than usual. A friendship might turn romantic. People from your past will be popping up as well. It's a good time to think about future goals. Tonight: Relax at home.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): The Sun will be at the top of your chart. This happens once a year, and it symbolizes that you are being thrust in a flattering spotlight! Use this window of time to demand the advantage and make your pitch. Tonight: Interesting discussions.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Your desire to travel, learn, study and expand your world will be stronger than usual in the next four weeks. Get out and do something different. Visit new shops, new parks and new places. Tonight: Check your belongings.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Amit Kumar, S/o. Sh. Dharmbir Singh, R/o.: H. No. 19C, Gali No.8, Block-A, Gopal Nagar, Najafgarh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.285/2016 U/S 448/451/467/468/380/506/34/IPC** registered at **P.S BHD Nagar, Dwarka District, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Amit Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Amit Kumar** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Amit Kumar, accused of FIR No.285/2016 U/S 448/451/467/468/380/506/34/IPC, P.S. BHD Nagar, Dwarka District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026.**

By Order, Apoorv Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
South West, Court No.06, Ground Floor
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/15100/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Irfan, S/o:** Afsar, **R/o:** C/418, Gali No. 6 OLD Seemapuri Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 133/2023, Dt. 19.03.2023, CR No. 2603/2023 U/S: 379/34 IPC, PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Irfan,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Irfan,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Irfan,** of **FIR No. 133/2023, Dt. 19.03.2023, CR No. 2603/2023 U/S: 379/34 IPC, PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.01.2027**

By Order
P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
(East) Room No. 03, 2nd Floor
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/15049/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Harsh S/o Amar, R/o:** K-432, Gali No. 4, Goutam Vihar, Usmanpur, Welcome, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 653/2024, U/S: 25 A Act, PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Harsh,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Harsh,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Harsh** of **FIR No. 653/2024, U/S: 25 A Act, PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.12.2026.**

By Order
Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, 1st Floor Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14112/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Aamir@Saleem S/o Shamshad, R/o:** D-128, New Seelampur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 181/2026, U/S: 25 A Act, PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Aamir@Saleem,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Aamir@Saleem,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Aamir@Saleem** of **FIR No. 181/2026, U/S: 25 A Act, PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026.**

By Order
Rangat Ghirra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, 1st Floor Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14115/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Abhinav @ Kanhaiya S/o Nagender Shah R/o H. No. C-3/1, Shakurbasti Railway Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 338/2024 U/s 25/54/59 A. Act PS: Keshavpuram, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Abhinav @ Kanhaiya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Abhinav @ Kanhaiya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Abhinav @ Kanhaiya** accused of **FIR No. 338/2024 U/s 25/54/59 A. Act PS: Keshavpuram, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.02.2027.**

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
JMFC-04, Room No. 112
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14912/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Yoginder Kumar Gupta, Director M/s J.D.U. Trading Pvt. Ltd., R/o. C-69-70, Okhla Industrial Area Phase-I, New Delhi-110020 Also at: 336/4, Govind Puri, New Delhi-110019** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR/Case No. 46081/2016 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S Chittranjan Park, South District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Yoginder Kumar Gupta** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Yoginder Kumar Gupta** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yoginder Kumar Gupta,** accused of **FIR/Case No. 46081/2016 U/S 138 NI Act, P.S Chittranjan Park, South District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026.**

By Order, Sidhant Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06 (NI Act).
Room No. 29, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi.

DP/15180/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna, S/o. Deshraj, R/o.: H.No.1034, 5th Floor, Block-J, Jahangir Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.272/2026 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS** registered at **P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, North West District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sumit @ Babu @ Chikna,** accused of **FIR No. 272/2026 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS, P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, North West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.12.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Tapasya Agarwal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (North)
Court No.117, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15132/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Shakib S/o: Aas Mohamad, R/o:** H. No.: 236, Gali No.: 8, Kardam Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 67/2017, U/S: 380/411 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shakib,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shakib,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Shakib** of **FIR No. 67/2017, U/S: 380/411 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026.**

By Order
Rangat Ghirra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, 1st Floor Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14119/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **(1) Dalip Tomar, Proprietor of M/s Bhawna Enterprises C/o Ms. Kamyawati Tomar, (2) Anita W/o Dalip Tomar R/o RZ-669/31, Street No. 19, Sadh Nagar-II, Palam, New Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No./Ct. Case No. **1941, 1942/2022 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Hari Nagar, Distt. West, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **(1) Dalip Tomar (2) Anita** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **(1) Dalip Tomar (2) Anita** are absconded (or themselves concealing have to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **(1) Dalip Tomar (2) Anita** of FIR No./ Ct. Case No. **1941, 1942/2022 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Hari Nagar, Distt. West, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **30.11.2026** at **10:00 AM.**

By Order
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Metropolitan Magistrate-08 (West)
Room No. 30, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14921/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Om Prakash, S/o: Jagdish Sharma, R/o: H.No. A-31, Adhyapak Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 594/2014 & Cr. Case 6258/2018, U/s: 420/467/468/471/34 IPC, Police Station Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Om Prakash** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Om Prakash** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Om Prakash** of **Police Station Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg
Ld. JMFC-03, West, Room No. 292,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/15190/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sanjida Malik @ Sangeeta** W/o Mohd. Asif R/o H. No. F-169, Gali No. 3, Dilshad Masjid, Old Mustafabad, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 289/2018 u/s 448/380/411/174A/34 IPC at P.S. Gokalpuri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sanjida Malik @ Sangeeta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sanjida Malik @ Sangeeta** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sanjida Malik @ Sangeeta** accused of FIR No. 289/2018 u/s 448/380/411/174A/34 IPC at P.S. Gokalpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or befoe **04.12.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Isra Zaidi,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04, (North-East)
Room No. 64, 4th Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/15157/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Avtar Singh** S/o Deedar Singh R/o WZ-398, Rishi Nagar Rani Bagh, Outer Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 04444/2021 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Rani Bagh, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Avtar Singh** cannot be found and whereas it ha been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Avtar Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Avtar Singh** accused of FIR No. 04444/2021 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Rani Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.12.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, (North West)
Room No. 101,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/15077/OD/2026

S Africa level series with win over Australia in second Test

Reuters
October 22

SOUTH AFRICA bowled out Australia for 295 to win by an innings and 31 runs in the last session of the second Test at St George's Park in Gqeberha on Thursday to level the three-match series, winning a race against looming bad weather.

The hosts' pace trio of Wiaan Mulder, Kagiso Rabada and Marco Jansen took the last four wickets required as Australia's resistance crumbled after a century from Travis Head and a doggedly defiant Test high 40 by nightwatchman Scott Boland. Mulder, who earlier dismissed Head, then bowled Boland and castled Australia captain Pat Cummins to forge a breakthrough, with Rabada dismissing Mitchell Starc and Jansen finishing off the innings with Josh Hazlewood caught in the slips.

A result in the Test seemed far-fetched when most of the first two days' play was washed out and South Africa, who were 110-6 when the sun came out on the morning of the third day, looked in early trouble as Australia aimed to capitalise on their success in the first Test.

But a brilliant 179 runs from skipper Temba Bavuma led a fightback whichsaw South Africa declare on 425-9 and then turn the Test on its head by bowling Australia out for 99 and putting them in to bat again. Head and Boland had resumed on 156-4 in the second innings after rain returned and wiped out the morning session and Head, who was 87 overnight, went on to score 121 before chopping onto his stumps a rising delivery from Mulder.

It was Head's 13th Test century but only his second outside Australia and his departure offered the home bowlers hope again after almost 90 minutes of frustrating attack without success at the start of the day's action.

"We were scrambling a bit, not sure about the weather and Australia made us work hard for those last six wickets," said Bavuma.

Steve Smith, who battled with a neck problem in the first innings on Wednesday, made three as he came in at No. 7.

The former captain was tempted into pulling a delivery from Rabada, bowling with the second new ball, but only got a top edge to Matthew Breetzke, who juggled it at midwicket before holding the catch.

Boland, who batted for 166 balls as he put a high price on his wicket, went soon after tea when he was bowled through the gate and then Cummins (4) played down the wrong line and was also clean bowled in Mulder's next over.

When Rabada came back for a fresh spell, he immediately bowled Starc (11), leaving one wicket to get which Jansen snagged as Hazlewood showed no sign of sticking around and nicked behind first ball.

BRIEF SCORES: South Africa 425/9 decl (Bavuma 179, Jansen 85, Harmer 82; Boland 5-81) beat **Australia** 99 (Jansen 5/33) and 295 (Head 121; Rabada 4/77, Mulder 3/64) by an innings and 31 runs

NEW ZEALAND VS INDIA: 1ST T20I

Batsmen begin with a bang in NZ

Sanju at the top and Dhir at No.7 deliver with big hits as visitors chase down 226

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 22



Sanju Samson was the highest scorer for India, with 67 in 33 balls, in the win over New Zealand at Hagley Oval, Christchurch. CREIMAS

A WOBBLING top-edged six from Naman Dhir's hurried pull was not the most poetic end to a semi-thriller, but India would care less about the stroke that wrapped up their four-wicket win over New Zealand at the Hagley Oval. Barely two days after landing in the far-flung country, shaking off their jet lag, squeezing just a practice session, they overhauled a target of 226, weathering treacherous passages in the game.

The victory was established on the muscle and depth of their batsmen, a theme by now run-of-the-mill. The most destructive openers in the game Abhishek Sharma and Sanju Samson shellacked 93 runs in merely 5.5 overs, Shreyas Iyer exhibited his nervelessness with a firefighting 42 and Dhir produced a calm unbeaten 42 that enforced his clutch-moment credentials. Sanju offered the impetus in the opening act, Shreyas controlled the middle game, and Dhir killed the match with an unfussy endgame.

The chase did not produce a riot of emotion, as the drama slow-burned without wicked twists and turns. Apart from a stutter in the middle, the pursuit was smooth. The fear of the overseas seamers was misplaced. Rather, it was the humbler spinners that troubled them.The trio of Matt Henry, Adam Milne and Lockie Ferguson found swing with the new ball, but were wasteful. Henry beat Sanju with an away-swinger and cut him into half with a nip-backer. Milne twice found clunky edges off Abhishek Sharma. Intermittently, the odd ball continued to swing, but Henry and Co turned uncharacteristically shoddy. Their lengths went awry, the lines askew.

The third over bowled by Ferguson captured their malfunction. He began with a wild wide down the leg-side, then appeased Sanju with a full ball outside the off-stump that was bunted over cover for a four, courtesy a collision between two fielders sliding to abort the boundary. He adjusted the length to middle and off, but Sanju pasted him over long-on. Five more wides followed; the over bled 22 runs and injected India the belief that the target was achievable.

The home bowlers slipped into terrific panic, manifesting an unusual indiscipline that Sanju and Abhishek ruthlessly took full toll on. After the early twitchiness, Sanju essayed gorgeous strokes, especially in the classicist's arc between extra-cover and long-on. He swivel-pulled the returning Henry and top-edged the next ball for a six. By the fifth over, India had already shaved off nearly one third of the target (82 for 0).

There were times Abhishek struggled for timing, especially when reaching for the balls outside the stump. He barely shuffles across his stumps. The feet remain crease-bound when he reaches for the ball. But whenever the ball strayed into his body, especially when pitched short, he unfurled his brutal pull shot. He played the support act role to perfection, carving 29 off 12 balls before the familiar nemesis, the off-spinner from over the stumps, foxed him a shade of extra turn. The 93-run stand ended on the penultimate ball off the power-play.

India's highest successful chases in T20Is

Target	Opponent	Venue	Year
226	New Zealand	Christchurch	2026
209	Australia	Visakhapatnam	2023
209	New Zealand	Raipur	2026
208	West Indies	Hyderabad	2019
207	Sri Lanka	Mohali	2009

Applying brakes

The plot flipped. Smooth-sailing India hit turbulence. The instigators were familiar yet unsuspecting. Michael Bracewell, the off-spinner and Mitchell Santner, the left-arm spinner, are the sort India's batsmen have encountered abundantly and without much ado in domestic cricket. Neither possess a bagful of variations to ambush them.

Sanju merrily heaved Bracewell over long-on, before he slapped him over mid-off. But they chipped away with routine but effective ways, like change of pace, angles, flight and trajectory. Some of Bracewell's deliveries skidded on; some others gripped and bounced off the surface. Santner was masterful at shuffling his pace. Both piled on dots, starved India's batsmen of boundaries, built pressure and induced mistakes. Santner made Sanju cut a widish ball harder than he usually does. He dribbled the ball onto the stumps, after Tilak had eked out only a single from four balls.

Swiftly, India fell apart, losing a scratchy Tilak and a hasty Ishan Kishan in the space of six balls to Bracewell and Santner. The spin pair seemed to have bolted the rampaging horse. All India managed in the tormented phase was seven runs in 17 balls. First-game blues seemed to clutch them.

But a determined Iyer and enterprising Dhir, his stocks soaring, put on 43 decisive runs to ensure that India did not fall wayside. Iyer departed with India 26 runs adrift of the finishing line. But Dhir seized the moment to reinforce his value.

A bigger worry for Iyer would be his team's error-strewn bowling — his counterpart Mitchell Santner could relate with his plight. Not even the metronomic Bhuvneshwar Kumar was spared of the blushes on his return. The power-wielding New Zealand batsmen, Glenn Phillips the most buccaneering, consigned him to 49 runs in four overs. He was India's most expensive bowler, despite a vintage first-over wherein he swung the ball impishly, on an evening of profligacy. Every Indian bowler conceded more than ten runs an over, none had the spunk to define the game, and withered at the slightest hint of aggression from New Zealand's batsmen.

It was not imprecise execution that would haunt them, but the lack of ideas. Be it Phillips, the strapping Bevon Jacobs, or the rampaging Finn Allen, India's bowlers watched blankly as they tore them apart.

The batsmen atoned for their mistakes, as the Kiwi bowlers paid a tribute act to their Indian brethren. But the tour is long and hard, and they cannot afford to come unstuck.

BRIEF SCORES: New Zealand 225/4 in 20 overs (Phillips 82 not out, Allen 45) lost to **India 230/6 in 19.4 overs (Samson 67, Dhir 42 not out, Iyer 42; Bracewell 2/37) by 5 wickets**

SL trump Brook's fastest double ton to chase 430 vs Eng

Associated Press
Rawalpindi, October 22



Harry Brook scored 202. AP

SRI LANKA trumped Harry Brook's fastest ever double century with the second highest successful run chase in ODI history and handed England a second successive defeat in the tri-series on Thursday.

Brook's 116-ball 202 propelled England to its fourth highest ODI score of 429-4 before it ran into Sri Lanka's super counterpunch to lose by two wickets.

Needing six runs off Josh Tongue's final two balls, Janith Liyanage lofted the fast bowler over long-off for a winning six to reach 430-8 and earn Sri Lanka their most memorable ODI victory since winning the 1996 World Cup.

Sri Lanka's astonishing run-chase was only second behind South Africa's 438-9 when it beat Australia by one wicket at Johannesburg in 2006.

"Incredible game of cricket, both teams were exceptional," Brook said. "Sri Lanka just outplayed us. They played exceptional cricket to knock off 400."

Fastest double centuries in ODIs

PLAYER	TEAM	BALLS FACED	OPPONENT	YEAR
Harry Brook	England	**114**	Sri Lanka	2026
Shubman Gill	India	**117**	West Indies	2026
Ishan Kishan	India	**126**	Bangladesh	2022
Glenn Maxwell	Australia	**128**	Afghanistan	2023
Pathum Nissanka	Sri Lanka	**136**	Afghanistan	2024

Avishka Fernando, recalled for the tri-series since last playing an ODI in January 2025, and Pavan Rathnayake set up the strong chase with a 166-run third-wicket stand after Sri Lanka lost two wickets inside the first five overs of the run chase.

Fernando missed out on a century but his 97-run knock off 83 balls kept Sri Lanka well in the game. Dasun Shanaka, also returning to the ODI fold after more than two years, then added another electrifying 133 runs with Rathnayake off just 79 balls.

Rathnayake completed his second ODI century and made 130 off 106 balls with 15 fours and three sixes as he brought down the target to 107 runs off the final 58 balls before holing out to long-on.

But Shanaka, who twice successfully overturned decisions against him through television reviews, continued toying with England's fast bowlers and smashed eight sixes and six boundaries.

With eight needed of the final over, Tongue uprooted the middle stumps of Wellalage and Eshan Malinga off successive balls but Asitha Fernando denied the fast bowler a hat trick and gave the strike back to Liyanage to finish off the game.

BRIEF SCORES: England 429/4 (Brook 202, Root 69) lost to **Sri Lanka** 430/8 (Rathnayake 130, Avishka Fernando 97, Shanaka 97) by two wickets

Dhir: Finisher from Faridkot, minus emotional frills

Sandip G
New Delhi, October 22



T20I captain Shreyas Iyer congratulates Naman Dhir. AP

NAMAN DHIR watched his winning stroke travel beyond the advertisement board, turned back, punched his partner's gloves, offered a silent prayer and retreated to the dug-out, without the feverish excitement of someone celebrating his first noteworthy moment in international cricket. It was as though he had waged several such battles; that such pursuits hold only a cold, momentary thrill. Only two balls remained when he wrapped up the match chasing New Zealand's 225, but Dhir's poise ensured the audience never really searched for their nails or hair.

These are traits of some famous finishers, ice in their veins and calculators in their pocket. MS Dhoni occasionally flashed the boy-next-door smile; Michael Bevan smirked at times. Both seldom poured emotions on the field, or saved them for the locker room revelries. Dhir is far from reaching the stratified air Dhoni and Bevan inhabit, or to be touted as Hardik Pandya's heir, but he has the requisites, both physical skills and mental fortitude, to blossom into a finisher-cum-spin-bowling all-rounder.

The prelude to his unconquered 42 off 15 balls, came in Bengaluru against West Indies, a six-ball 24 that was all flashes and slashes. But the challenges in Christchurch were different. When he strode in, India required 59 off 33 balls. It was not an unforgivably steep ascent, but this was only the fifth time he was batting in a T20I, facing a band of bowlers who had slit open a window of hope. The surface still had bounce and pace to intimidate a first-timer from the subcontinent. Among the remaining batsmen, only Nitish Kumar Reddy was competent.

A shot of indiscretion or a moment of fear risks a potential shove to the back-burner. His stock is abundant in the country. Every domestic team or IPL franchise has a spinner who can bat. He had to grab the opportunity. He did.

The 26-year-old had suffered setbacks in the past. Opportunities came sparse for the cricketer from Faridkot in Punjab, son of an employee at a chemist shop. He once brooded over quitting the game and relocating to Canada, where his sister studied. Friends and relatives taunted him for wasting his life on a cricket field. But his father told him to give cricket one more season before forsaking it. He listened.

The year, 2022, changed his life and trajectory. Punjab picked him for the Ranji Trophy, and a year later he was on Mumbai Indians' payroll. Tragedies continued to strike, he lost his grandfather, a pillar of support first. And later lost childhood coach Gagan Sidhu, who was only 36.

But this was a different battle, physical and mental, rather than emotional. His mindset was clear: Waste no time and club the ball around. Just the second ball, he tried, and failed, to time a wide one from medium pacer Nathan Smith. Shreyas Iyer gestured to him to relax, implying that he would shoulder the heavy-lifting duties. Dhir nodded but didn't listen.

Enter Mitchell Santner, the Kiwi captain and the game's most potent bowler. On the first he clumped him over extra cover for a brace. The signs were evident. That he would swing for the fence. The next ball was a wide. The ball after, he bludgeoned him over the cow cordon, a slog-sweep of savage beauty.

Santner had flung this one quicker, but the length was ideal for him to crouch and swipe it. He has fast hands and a scathing bat-swing, from which he generates considerable power. He waited for Santner to err on the shorter side next ball, which he did and Dhir briskly cut him for a four.

Grasping situation

The counsel from Iyer stopped. He knew Dhir had grasped the situation's demands. The pressure on Iyer dropped, as boundaries kept flying off Dhir's blade. Nathan Smith tried to bounce him out, but he swatted him for a four. He didn't middle every single ball, edges flew towards the fence. But he remained unflustered, and navigated India home after Iyer's departure. As much as the strokes, his temperament impressed Iyer. "The calm and composed nature he showed tonight, it was magnificent," he gushed.

Strangely, he didn't bowl. But in the West Indies series, he had demonstrated his efficacy, bagging five wickets, the second most by an Indian bowler. His partnership-breaking gifts were noticeable, as was his knack of getting a wicket the ball after being hit for a six. He considers himself as a batsman who could bowl, but his second skill could be invaluable for the country. There could be better spinners who can bat, like Washington Sundar and Axar Patel, but there are not many natural hitters who could bowl spin. He can be brutal against both spinners and pacers, as he has displayed in the IPL.

The bowling is still finding its missing pieces. But a permanent space could open up if Axar's toils continue and Washington remains injury-prone. He has a better range of hitting the seamers than Shivam Dube as well. He is overeager to bowl, and Iyer praises his enthusiasm to bowl at difficult junctures.

But the true calling could be a finisher's— deadeye sniper batting down the order to wrap up the game or applying the final flourish, without excessive outpouring of emotions.

BADMINTON: FRENCH OPEN

'I'm shivering, it's overwhelming': Ashmita after ousting World No.2 Yamaguchi

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, October 22



An emotional Ashmita Chaliha reacts after beating Akane Yamaguchi in Paris on Thursday. BWF/BADMINTON PHOTO

BEFORE HER match against Akane Yamaguchi, Ashmita Chaliha's father Dhruba Jyoti had helped ease her pressure. "Just play your own match. Make fewer errors, keep the shuttle inside the lines," he had said. This was when she had spoken of running into the World No.2 - a win-machine who only loses to An Se-young.

But Thursday was going to be Ashmita's day. Playing freely, like the opponent's reputation mattered not a jot. With sweet timing that made some of her retrieves seem outrageous, Ashmita defeated Yamaguchi 21-19, 21-18 at the French Open. "I'm shivering. It's very overwhelming. It's my biggest win and I'm still trying to digest it. It will take a day," she would tell BWF in Paris after entering her first-ever quarterfinalists of a Super 750.

Just last week, Ashmita was hammered by Yamaguchi, 21-18, 21-10. "I played her last week in Denmark. I knew I had to play her here as well. I didn't have many hopes or expectations," she said, adding, "But I was looking forward to the match. She is a legend. I thought I'll just give my best. Everything else will follow."

The 27-year-old has had one consistent year, being the opposite of what she was once known for, frittering her talent with reckless errors. But on Thursday, she kept them to the bare minimum, and played one of her cleanest matches in a year when she returned from a knee surgery and went on to win the Korea Masters.

The win makes Ashmita the first Indian after PV Sindhu to defeat any Top 2 player in the last few years. Ashmita was World No.94 when 2026 began and is now 36th.

The talented Assamese left-hander's smashes sang their sweet tune and Yamaguchi was made to run around before a well-timed smash hit the floor to end the opening game.

The key to the win were her tosses and clears to Yamaguchi's far back corner forehand - something that she knew would be retrieved, but they drew the champ back and kept her pinned there, thus opening up other areas of the court.

It was masterfully done, because it is never easy to draw Yamaguchi into an endless loop. She possesses far too many strokes. But Ashmita did well to stick to the strategy.

The leftie also has more than a handful of winners of her own in stroke options. And though the general plan was to engage the retriever in long rallies and stake out patiently for an opportunity to attack, she has some delectable strokes like a racquet- twirling drop to the front court, when Yamaguchi was stranded far back.

Ashmita had led for most of the opening game, though the 16-18 rally held the potential to break her. It went easily upwards of 40 crunching strokes but she never looked rattled or disoriented in her returns. The point went to Yamaguchi, who would equalise at 18-18, but Ashmita didn't give up.

Moving well

A beautiful drop brought her a step closer, and she moved so well in front and back retrieves that Yamaguchi would've sensed the relentless quality in her limbs. What had changed from Odense to Paris was how Ashmita dealt with Yamaguchi's drops. "Her deceptive drop is very effective and it's very difficult for me. But I was ready. This is my first Super 750 quarters and I'm super proud of how I played. In this tournament, I have been a little more patient than I had been earlier," she told BWF.

Ashmita missed Durga Puja in Guwahati, but morphed into a many-limbed figure on the court controlling the match from mid- court and throwing her rangy reach at shuttles whizzing well past her in brilliant retrieves. It was, however, her seamless, no-holds-barred southpaw punches that got Yamaguchi into perpetual trouble. The Indian's defence was good enough for the Japanese to go for the lines and spray smashes wide.

"I made it," - she told her mother Geetali soon after, though she was taken aback by the media mobbing her, wanting to know more about her. "She was in shock," Geetali said, adding, "She said 'I did it but I only can't believe it. I am in shock,'" she would narrate.

Geetali credits Coach Park Tae Sang at Guwahati for giving Ashmita the confidence. "Win or lose, he counsels her well," the mother says. "Overall, she is more confident and making fewer errors."

On the day, she had fellow shuttler Isharani Baruah sit for her match, and while the two chatted tactics, it was clear Ashmita was studiously sticking to a pre-decided plan. "Coach Park has brought about drastic improvements because his counselling is so good. Earlier she used to fear top players. No more. She just plays her own game," Geetali would say.

This was also one of the first times she had played top-level meets - Arctic Open in Finland, Denmark last week and now French - in back-to-back-to-back weeks. Having fallen out of the Top 200 after she tore her knee meniscus, Ashmita could well get into the Top 30 now.

Coach Park has declared the team's intent to aim at 2028 Olympics qualification, and Ashmita's attacking game has all the ingredients to challenge the top players. "She works very hard," Park has said earlier.

After charges of sexual misconduct, para swimmer sent back home

Express News Service
New Delhi, October 22

INDIAN PARA swimmer Shams Alam was sent back from the Asian Para Games after allegations of sexual misconduct levelled by a female hotel staff member in Aichi, Nagoya, Japan. The 40-year-old swimmer, who competes in men's 100m butterfly S5 and 50m breaststroke S4, was detained by local police and sent back to India on the first available flight, sources close to the matter confirmed.

On Thursday, the Paralympic Committee of India, in a press release, said that it is considering stringent punishment such as a lifetime ban on the athlete for his behaviour.

"The Paralympic Committee of India maintains a zero-tolerance policy towards any form of sexual misconduct or behaviour that violates the dignity, safety and rights of others," it stated. "In the present matter, the Chef de Mission (CDM) has recommended the strictest disciplinary action, including a lifetime ban against the athlete concerned. The athlete has been sent back to India from Japan. Further action will be taken by the competent authorities in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures after the conclusion of the Asian Para Games," it added.

The press release also stated that the body had conducted multiple workshops before the continental showpiece for the athletes related to traveling in Japan. "...participation in international sporting events carries a responsibility to uphold the values of respect, integrity and accountability. Any alleged misconduct will be dealt with seriously, in accordance with the established disciplinary framework and principles of due process," the PCI stated.

PARA ASIAN GAMES

Ex-CoBRA commando wins gold, 4 years after losing foot in blast

Para archers Toman and Sheetal clinch compound mixed team title at Aichi- Nagoya

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 22





(L) Toman Kumar Taram with his archery partner Sheetal Devi. (R) Toman in the CRPF. PSI/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

MOMENTS AFTER he won the mixed team gold with archer Sheetal Devi at the Para Asian Games in Nagoya on Thursday, Toman Kumar Taram sent a photo of himself, holding the medal and the national flag, to the WhatsApp group of the CRPF's 209th CoBRA (Commando Battalion for Resolute Action) unit.

Toman, 31, was a CoBRA commando until February 2022, when he lost his left foot in an IED (improvised explosive device) blast during an anti-Maoist operation in Lohardaga, Jharkhand. He is now a constable with the CRPF.

En route to their gold, Toman and Sheetal, an armless archer, set a world record of 1,402 points during the qualification round, before registering a 151-148 win over Indonesia's Teodora Audi Ayudia Ferelly and Ken Swagumilang. The title was yet another feather in the cap for two of India's most gritty para athletes — Sheetal was diagnosed with phocomelia, a congenital disorder that resulted in her arms being underdeveloped; Toman overcame the trauma of losing his foot, and bounced back to win medals for India.

"It has been more than four years since I lost my foot in the operations as a 209 CoBRA commando. When I lost my foot, I was dejected and depressed... But as I recovered, thanks to the support of my family and colleagues, I regained my confidence," Toman told *The Indian Express* from Nagoya.

Months after he was injured, Toman lost his friend, constable Rajesh Kumar, in another anti-Maoist operation. "I want to dedicate this medal to Rajesh and my other CRPF colleagues," said Toman, who hails from Ahibaran Nawagaon village in Chhattisgarh.

While he joined the CRPF about a decade ago, Toman recalled that he had just got engaged when the IED blast happened in February 2022.

"We were in the fourth day of the anti-Maoist operations. Our unit had chased a group on a hilltop near Lohardaga. They were outnumbered, but I then stepped on an IED, and my left foot was blown off. I had taken part in many anti-Maoist operations, and we were always watchful about IEDs. But this was unfortunate. I was taken in a helicopter to Ranchi, where I underwent an operation. I spent more than a month there. At that time, CRPF officers motivated me a lot," Toman said.

Toman was later shifted to the National Centre of Divyang Empowerment (NCDE) in Hyderabad, where he got a prosthetic foot. It was there that he met the CRPF's archery coach, Pankaj Singh, which proved to be a turning point in his life.

"At the NCDE, we train soldiers who have been injured. Toman started with my bow, but he did not feel motivated. Some days later, I took him to a local competition, and he saw children competing. He asked me how they could shoot with such power. I told him that you have to train hard, but you have the potential to be a good archer. Initially, we had to work on his balance with the bow as he used a prosthetic left foot," Singh said.

Toman made his India debut in 2025, when he paired with Sheetal to win the mixed team bronze at the Para World Championships in Gwangju, Korea. He also won an individual gold at the same event.

"My coach, Pankaj Singh, made me train and compete among able-bodied archers. That made me believe that I am no less than anybody else. Winning the World Championships last year was very motivating. Today's gold gives me confidence that I can win many more medals," Toman said.

Thursday's gold came with its set of challenges. "There were high winds, and I could not control my balance but I found a way. I have always seen Sheetal as an inspiration, and watching her shoot motivates me," Toman said.

Toman's wife Renuka Bai and two-year-old daughter Pravya are waiting for his return to celebrate his recent medal. "Today is a wonderful day for the family. When Toman lost his foot in the IED blast, my father and I spent more than a month in Ranchi, along with his mother. There was no question of calling off the engagement. Seeing him win gold medals is a special feeling ," Renuka told *The Indian Express*.

MEDAL TALLY

Place	Country	G	S	B	Total
1	CHN	150	79	85	314
2	JPN	40	46	50	136
3	UZB	38	41	41	120
4	**IND**	**21**	**26**	**41**	**88**
5	KOR	21	23	26	70

SQUASH: SILICON VALLEY OPEN

Anahat gets the GOAT: Beats 8-time world champ Nour El Sherbini

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, October 22



Anahat Singh (R) beat Nour El Sherbini 11-8, 11-8, 11-7. PSA

IN NOUR El Sherbini, Anahat Singh on Thursday faced a woman regarded by many as squash's greatest of all time. Yet, going into the match, India head coach Harinder Pal Sandhu believed the teenager "definitely does have a shot" against the legend.

An obvious reason for confidence was the junior world champion's recent performances and a propensity to punch above her ranking. Another one was El Sherbeni's patchy form: she had lost four of her last seven matches on tour and didn't look quite like herself this season.

As it turned out, Anahat proved Harinder right emphatically. Undaunted by her opponent's reputation and her own reverence, the Indian unleashed the killer instinct that has made her one of the sport's most exciting talents. The eight-time world champ stood vanquished 11-8, 11-8, 11-7 in the Silicon Valley Open Round of 16.

For Anahat, who shares the same coach with El Sherbeni — former world No.1 Gregory Gaultier — it was an "unreal" feeling. "I didn't expect it to go like this. I thought I'd take a little while to settle in and just understand how to play her. But the gameplan ended up working pretty well for me today," she said after her straight-game win at Redwood City, California.

At the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, Anahat had knocked out the sixth-ranked Japanese Satomi Watanabe en route to a historic singles silver. At the time, she had called it the biggest win of her career. It is a testament to her rapid rise that Anahat has had to revise her assessment less than a month later.

Fondly describing what El Sherbeni means to her, Anahat said courtside, "I grew up watching every single match of hers. I admire her so much. She is one of the best squash players that the world has ever seen. Just getting the chance to share a court with her is an honour in itself. This win means the world."

The match was nearly as one-sided as the scoreline indicates. Trailing 5-6 in Game 1, Anahat elevated her stroke-making, finding kill shots at will. She won five of the next six points to reach three game balls. After narrowly missing a forehand crosscourt putaway, the Indian executed an inch-perfect backhand to convert her second game ball.

No let-up

Anahat started the next game even more ruthlessly, punishing anything remotely loose from the top seed to race to a 9-1 lead. That is when the world No. 3 rallied and Anahat got a little trigger-happy with her shot selection. A run of seven straight points for El Sherbeni cut the deficit to one before the 18-year-old unfurled another crosscourt winner. A 'no-let' decision later, she had pocketed Game 2 too.

Anahat had let slip a two-game advantage in the Asiad team semis, but was not about to allow a repeat against the Egyptian stalwart, known for her big comebacks. "I didn't want to let it go even for a second," she would say later.

The teen played it safe and solid in Game 3 until an opportunity presented itself at 9-7. Anahat lunged to push El Sherbeni to the back corner and slammed the weak response low on the forehand. Three match balls awaited her. Anahat pounced on the first one with a trademark angular drop.

She looked back towards Harinder in evident disbelief. After years of watching 'The Warrior Princess' in awe, she had beaten her in their first meeting. The result underlined Anahat's potential leading up to squash's introduction to the Olympics programme in 2028. Cyrus Poncha, secretary-general of the Squash Rackets Federation of India, was cautiously optimistic about her growth trajectory ahead of the Los Angeles Games.

"She is continuously chipping away at her ranking; she is now 15th in the world. Looking towards LA, we could see her by then being a top-10 player and even going higher," Poncha told *The Indian Express*.

He singled out Anahat's "fearless attitude". "She does not let pressure get to her. Even during her first Commonwealth Games at the age of 14, she said, 'I just played, I didn't think of the occasion'," Poncha recalled.

The teenager's triumphs at the global stage are making Indians sit up and take notice, he says. "She is making the sport popular. There's more coverage of squash. (One would) hope that means more players start taking up our sport."

How Sheetal turned doubles loss into 2 golds

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, October 22



Sheetal Devi rests next to her medal haul. INSTAGRAM

SHEETAL DEVI was trailing 55-59 in the final of the compound individual at the Asian Para Games in Japan when she hit six consecutive tens, four of them inner tens. She won 142-139 against Singapore's Alim Nur Syahidah, the archer who finished second to her in the final at Hangzhou, and took her fourth Asian Para Games gold.

It was her second gold of Thursday. Earlier in the day, Devi, the 19-year-old Jammu and Kashmir archer and Paris Paralympics bronze medallist, had won the compound mixed title with Toman Kumar Taram. The day before, she and Payal Nag had lost the women's doubles final. She wanted that title this time. After the loss, she spoke to her coach Gaurav Sharma and spent time with her mother Shakti Devi, who is travelling with her.

"*Kal mata rani ki kripa se silver aya tha aur aaj do gold aye hain* (Yesterday, with Mata Rani's blessings, the silver came and today two gold medals have come). We work hard for this for the whole year and the results come on such days. People had expectations from me and yes, there was pressure also but I am glad that I could win the medals as per the expectations," Devi told *The Indian Express*.

She knows she has to compete in both para and able-bodied events in the next year

Wind and world record

Earlier this week, the world number one shot 704/720 in qualification, equalling the world record set by Turkey's Oznur Cure at the Paris Paralympics. With her mixed team partner's 698/720, it gave India a new mixed team world record. She also broke the individual match world record with a 149 in her 149-134 win over Hong Kong's Chan Yuen Wah.

"It was windy early in the morning during the mixed team final too, and later when the individual final happened. The wind was flowing at 3 o'clock direction. When Sheetal shot 26 in the second set, we had a talk that she should not hold the arrow too much and aim off towards 9 o'clock to counter the wind.

"But then winds were crossing too. So she also had to readjust. Sheetal had the game to make a comeback and she showed that," says national coach Gaurav Sharma.

Devi shot 102 tens, 55 of them inner tens, and only two eights in the knockouts, one of them in the final. Her coach says she trains for the inner tens. "Cure shot 29 inner tens as compared to Sheetal's 32 inner tens during the score of 704. During the practice sessions, we have some specialist sessions for shoot-outs, hitting a single shot and inner ten. The aim is to train the mind as well as the technique so that when we need an inner ten in crunch situations, they come, and come in succession. That's what we saw today in the final too," he adds.

Aim for LA Olympics

Since last year, Devi has also been competing in able-bodied events. At Patiala she trains with Parneet Kaur, the 2023 World Championships women's team gold medallist, and Sangampreet Singh Bisla, the 2021 World University Games champion. "Her belief has always been to think like an able-bodied archer. Training as well as competing in trials as well as NRT competitions reinforces that belief," says Sharma.

With compound mixed team archery making its debut at the LA Olympics, the coaches have a plan. They have worked on her grip and core strength, and changed her back and neck positions to reduce the stress on her back. She knows she has to compete in both para and able-bodied events in the next year.

"My message to her after every match is *harjeet se sikhna aur har haar se bhi sikhna hai* (Learn from every win and learn from every loss)," Sharma says.

Asian U20 sprint medallist killed in road mishap

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, October 22



Jayaram Donadpati was a Varsity World medallist. INSTAGRAM

"I AM still processing it. We were winning titles for Odisha just a few months ago and today he's not among us," an aghast Amiya Mallick, former 100m national record holder, said. He was talking about his teammate and sprinter Jayaram Donadpati, who died in a bike accident near Phulnakhara in Odisha's Cuttack district in the early hours of Thursday. Jayaram was travelling with another sprinter Malaya Barik, who also passed away.

Police said the accident occurred at around 10:30 pm while the two athletes were returning from Cuttack after visiting Durga Puja pandals.

Both of them were immediately rushed to the SCB medical college at Cuttack, where they were declared dead. Their bodies were handed over to their family members after post-mortem.

Twenty-year-old Barik, a 400m sprinter, represented Odisha at national meets.

Jayaram, 21, was a double Asian U20 and World University Games medallist in men's 4x100m relay and was part of the Odisha team that won the national 4x100m relay title back in June. Jayaram had run the second leg in the final as Odisha clocked 39.72s to win the crown with Amiya running the anchor leg. After the win, Jayaram — along with fellow teammates Lalu Prasad Bhoi and Sarun Payasingh — had bowed before Amiya as a mark of respect for the 33-year-old sprinter.

"In the next two years, he would have been a top talent for India," Amiya told *The Indian Express*.

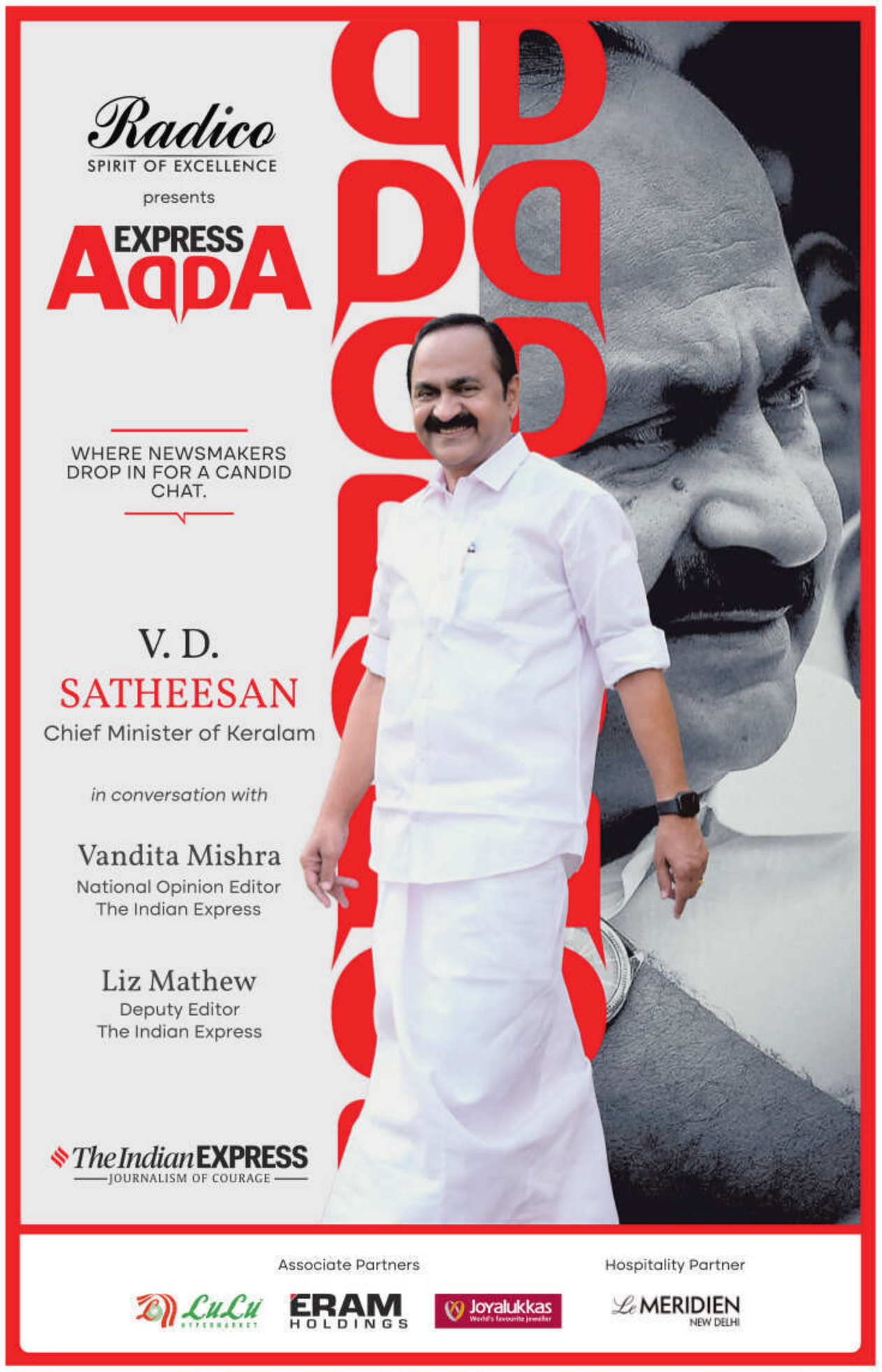
Jayaram caught everyone's eye at the 2023 Federation Cup in Ranchi where he clocked 10.40s to win the 100m bronze medal at the age of 18 behind Amiya, who finished first. "I had known him since 2022 but his bronze medal at the 2023 Federation Cup gave a glimpse of his talent. He was progressing very well," Amiya said.

It was a major feat for the youngster from Kalahandi district as he won a medal ahead of the likes of current 100m national record holder Gurindervir Singh and 200m national record holder Animesh Kujur. He used to train at the High Performance Center in Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar under coach Martin Owens.

"Jayaram was a lively kid who loved the sport. His dedication to the sport was very inspiring," Amiya said.

As per Amiya, India has lost a potential international-level sprinter. "He was young. At 21, he was clocking 10.40s and had he trained the way he was training for the next two years, there was a clear international-level sprinter in the future for India," Amiya said.

(With inputs from Sujit Bisoyi)



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